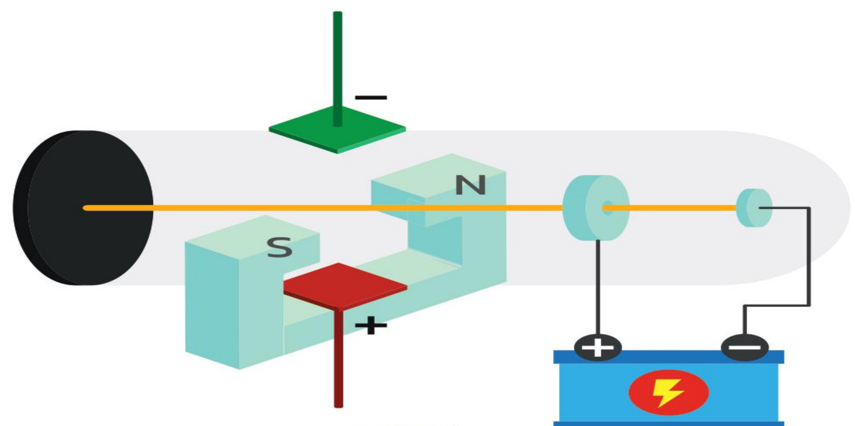
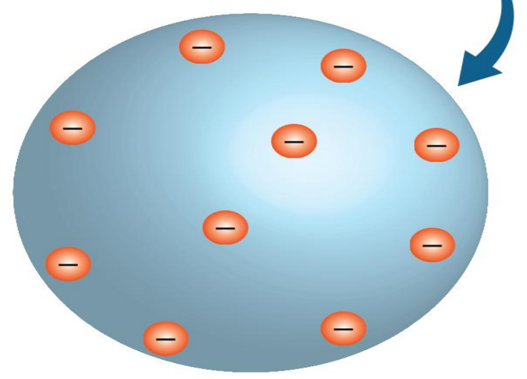
ATOMS



THOMSON'S ATOMIC MODEL

- Also known as pudding model
- Positive charge are uniformly distributed in the atom.
- Negative charge are embedded like seeds in watermelon.
- Overall atom is neutral



LIMITATIONS

- This model does not explain the presence of nucleus in the atom.
- This is not able to explain scattering of α - particles
- This is not able to explain the spectrum of atoms.

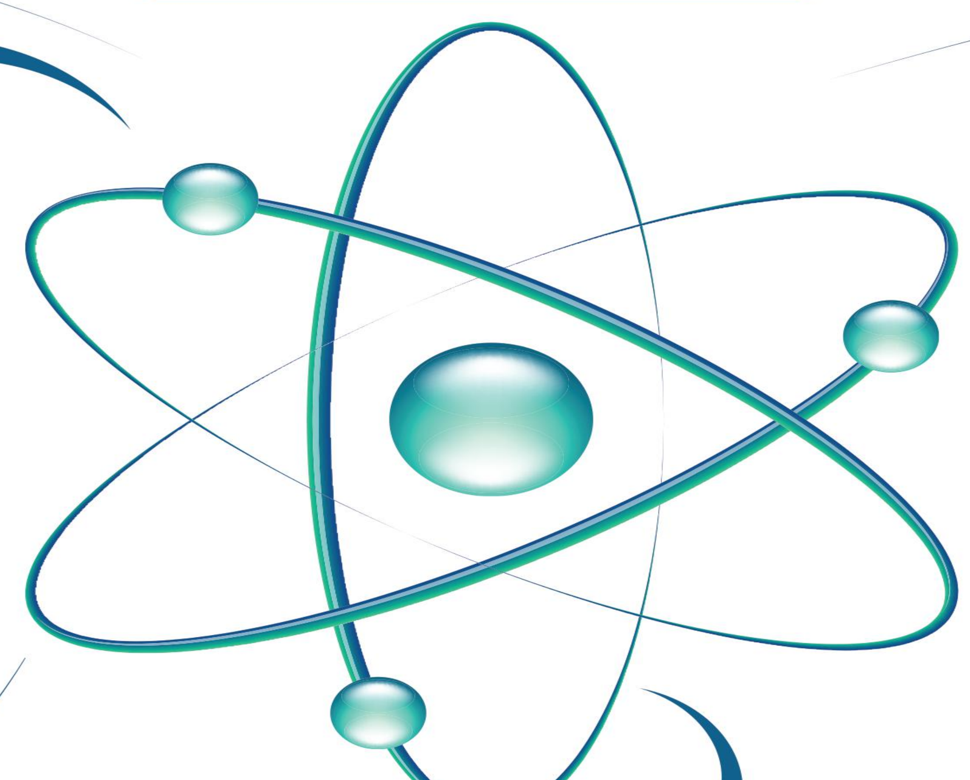
DISTANCE OF CLOSEST APPROACH

At closest approach. system only have electric potential energy.

$$K = U = \frac{1}{4\pi\varepsilon_o}\frac{(2e)(Ze)}{d}$$

$$\Rightarrow d = \frac{1}{4\pi\varepsilon_o}\frac{2ze^2}{K}$$

$$\Rightarrow d = \frac{1}{4\pi\varepsilon_o}\frac{2ze^2}{(\frac{1}{2}mv^2)}$$



BOHR'S MODEL

(i) Valid for only one - electron atom.
(ii) Electron is revolving around the nucleus in a stable orbit.
(iii) Attractive Coulomb force between electron and nucleus is equal to the centripetal force of electron

$$\frac{Ze^2}{4\pi\varepsilon_o r} = \frac{mv^2}{r}$$

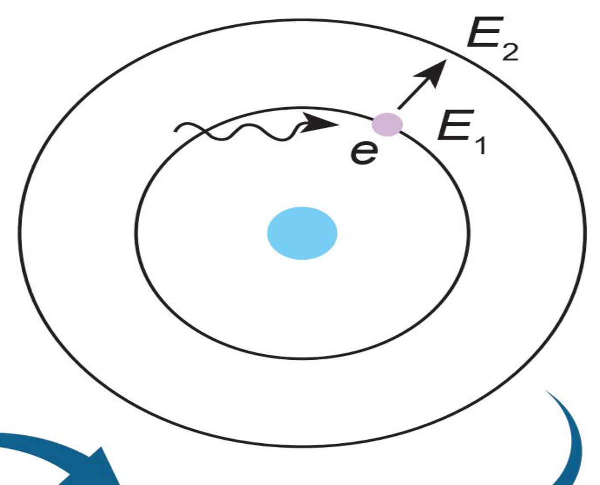
r = radius of orbit

LIMITATIONS

- This model not explain the stability of nucleus.
- This does not explain the line spectra of atom.

POSTULATES

- Electron in an atom could revolve in certain stable orbits with emission of radiant energy.
- $L = \frac{nh}{2\pi}$ L = angular momentum.
  h = Planck's constant = 6.6 × 10–34 Js
- $h\upsilon = E_i - E_f$
  Ei & Ef are the energies of initial & final states. Ei > Ef



EXCITATION ENERGY

$E_{excitation} = E_2 - E_1$

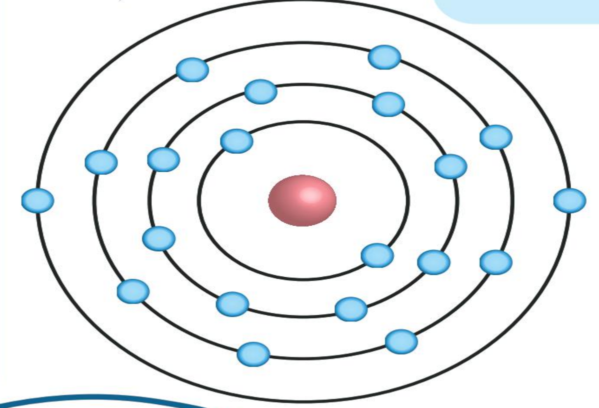
E_1 = energy of lower orbit

E_2 = energy of higher orbit

EXCITATION POTENTIAL

$$V_{excitation} = \frac{E_{excitation}}{e}$$

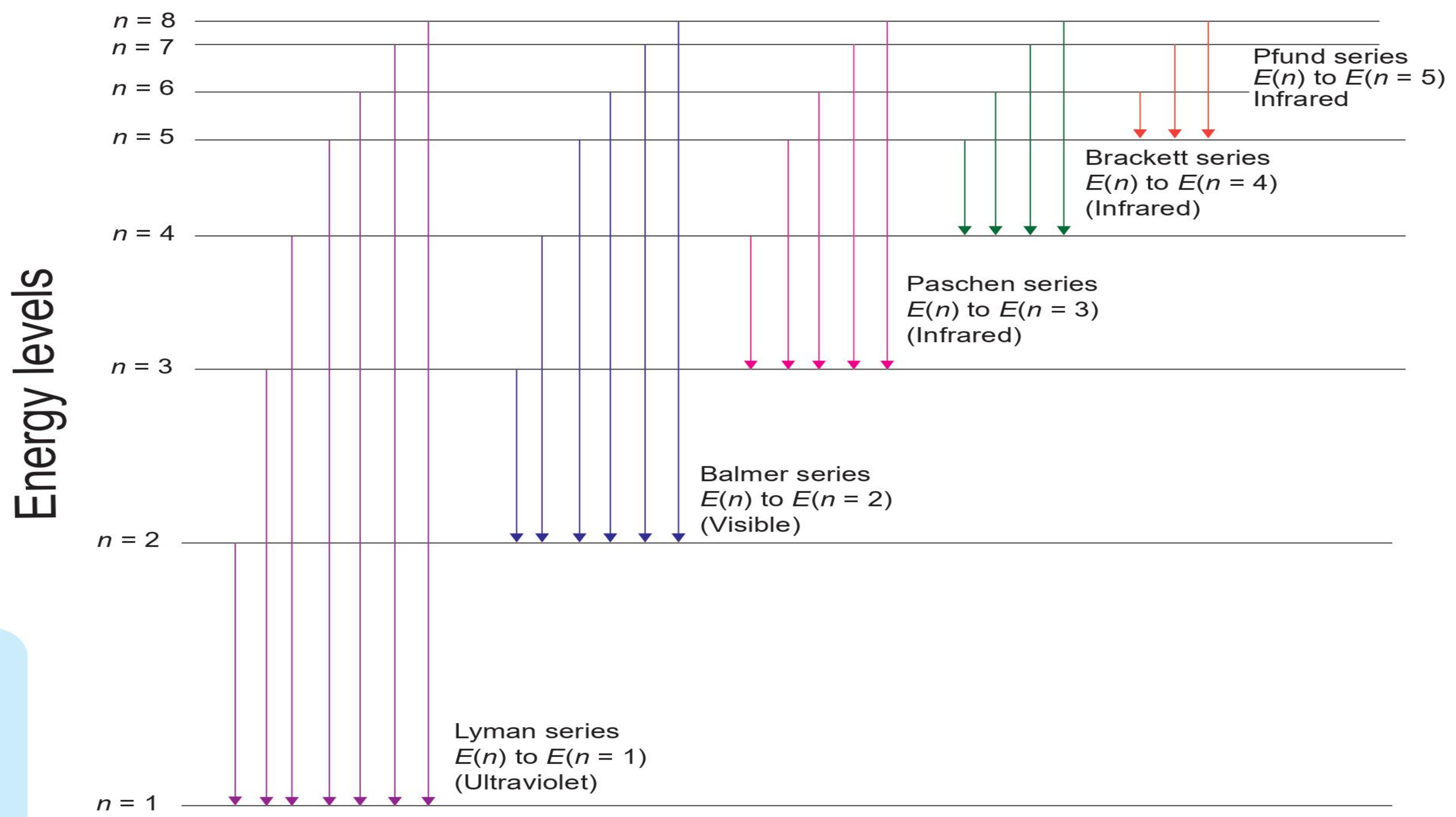
$$= \frac{E_2 - E_1}{e}\ \text{(volts)}$$



IONIZATION ENERGY

- Minimum energy required to remove the electron.
- $E_{ionization} = \frac{13.6\ z^2}{n^2}$ volts

LINE SPECTRA OF THE HYDROGEN ATOM



(1) The wave number or wavelength of the emitted photon when electron jumps from higher orbital state 'N_2' to lower orbital state 'N_1' is

$$\bar{\nu} = \frac{1}{\lambda} = \frac{En_2 - En_1}{hc} = R\left[\frac{1}{n_1^2} - \frac{1}{n_2^2}\right]$$

R = Rydberg is constant = $1.097 \times 10^7\ m^{-1}$

(2) Number of spectral lines when electron jump from

Nth orbit = $\frac{n(n-1)}{2}$

OUTCOMES

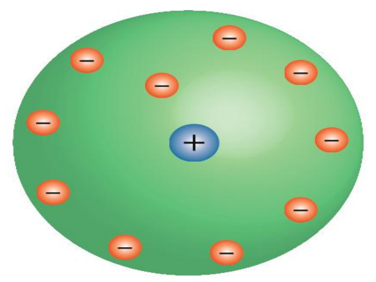
- Most of the α - particles went straight without any deviation.
- Same of α - particles were deflected by some angles.
- Very few α - particles were deflected by an angle 180°

CONCLUSIONS

- Positive charge was concentrated in small region of an atom is called nucleus
- Negative charge were revolving in circular orbit around the nucleus.

RUTHERFORD'S NUCLEAR MODEL OF AN ATOM

- α - particles were emitted by the radioactive element Bi^{214}_{83} & were bombarded on a thin gold foil.
- Scattered α - particles are collected on ZnS screen.



RADIUS OF NTH ORBIT

$$r_n = \frac{n^2h^2\varepsilon_o}{z\pi me^2} = \frac{0.53\,n^2}{z}\,\mathring{A}$$

$$r_n \propto \frac{n^2}{z},\ r_n \propto \frac{1}{m}$$

ORBITAL FREQUENCY IN NTH ORBIT

$$f_n = \frac{v}{2\pi r} = \frac{e^4z^2}{4\varepsilon_2^o n^3h^3}$$

$$f_n \propto \frac{Z^2}{n^3}$$

TOTAL ENERGY IN NTH ORBIT

- $E_N = K_N + U_N = \frac{-me^4z^2}{8\varepsilon_0^2h^2n^2}$
- $E_N = \frac{-13.6z^2}{n^2}$ eV
- $E_N \propto \frac{z^2}{n^2},\ E_n \propto m$

IONIZATION POTENTIAL

- $V_{ionization} = \frac{E_{ionization}}{e}$

$$= \frac{13.6\ z^2}{n^2}\ \text{volts}$$

VELOCITY OF ELECTRON IN NTH ORBIT

$$v_n = \frac{ze^2}{2nh\varepsilon_o} = 2.19 \times 10^6\ (\frac{z}{n})\ m/s$$

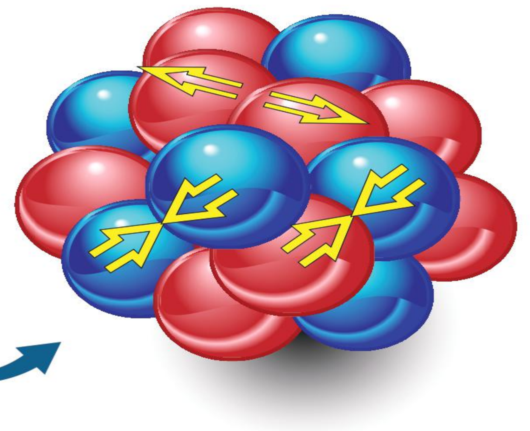
POTENTIAL AND KINETIC ENERGY IN NTH ORBIT

$U_N = \frac{-1}{4\pi\varepsilon_o}\frac{Ze^2}{rn} = \frac{me^4z^2}{4\varepsilon_o^2h^2n^2}$

$K_N = \frac{1}{2}mv^2 = \frac{me^4z^2}{8\varepsilon_o^2h^2n^2}$

BINDING ENERGY

- Minimum energy required to bound the electron from nucleus.
- B.E. = – $E_{ionization} = \frac{-13.6\ z^2}{n^2}$ eV



ATOMS

CHAPTER TWELVE
CLASS - XII

MANISH JOSHI

D.A.V. LOHAGHAT

September 1, 2025

Learning Objectives:

- Introduction
- Alpha-particle scattering experiment;
- Rutherford's model of atom;
- Bohr model of hydrogen atom, Expression for radius of nth possible orbit, velocity and energy of electron in nth orbit,
- Hydrogen line spectra (qualitative treatment only).

INTRODUCTION TO ATOMS

Atomic Hypothesis

- By the 19th century, enough evidence supported the **atomic hypothesis of matter**.

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- In 1897, **J. J. Thomson** discovered negatively charged constituents, called **electrons**, identical for all atoms.
- Atoms are overall **electrically neutral** $\Rightarrow$ must contain **positive charge** too.
- The key question: How are **positive charges and electrons** arranged inside the atom?

THOMSON'S MODEL (1898)

Plum Pudding Model

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- Proposed by **J. J. Thomson** in 1898.
- Atom as a **uniformly distributed positive sphere**.
- Electrons embedded like **seeds in a watermelon**.
- Known as the **plum pudding model**.
- **Limitation:** Later experiments showed actual distribution of charges was very different.

SPECTRAL STUDIES

Discrete Spectra

- **Condensed matter** emits a **continuous spectrum**.

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- **Rarefied gases** (heated or excited) emit radiation of **discrete wavelengths only**.

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- Each element has a **unique spectrum**.

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- Each element has a **unique spectrum**.
- Example: **Hydrogen spectrum** $\Rightarrow$ fixed set of lines, always same relative positions.
- **J. J. Balmer (1885)** gave empirical formula for wavelengths of hydrogen spectrum.

RUTHERFORD'S WORK

Nuclear Model of Atom

- **Ernest Rutherford (1906–1911)** studied α-particle scattering.

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- Electrons revolve around nucleus like **planets around Sun**.
- This is the **planetary or nuclear model**.

LIMITATIONS OF RUTHERFORD'S MODEL

Unanswered Questions

- Why are atoms **stable**? (Classical theory predicts electrons should spiral into nucleus.)

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Unanswered Questions

- Why are atoms **stable**? (Classical theory predicts electrons should spiral into nucleus.)
- Why do atoms emit **only discrete line spectra**, not a continuous one?
- These limitations motivated the need for a new model $\Rightarrow$ **Bohr's Model**.

ALPHA-PARTICLE SCATTERING AND RUTHERFORD'S NUCLEAR MODEL OF ATOM

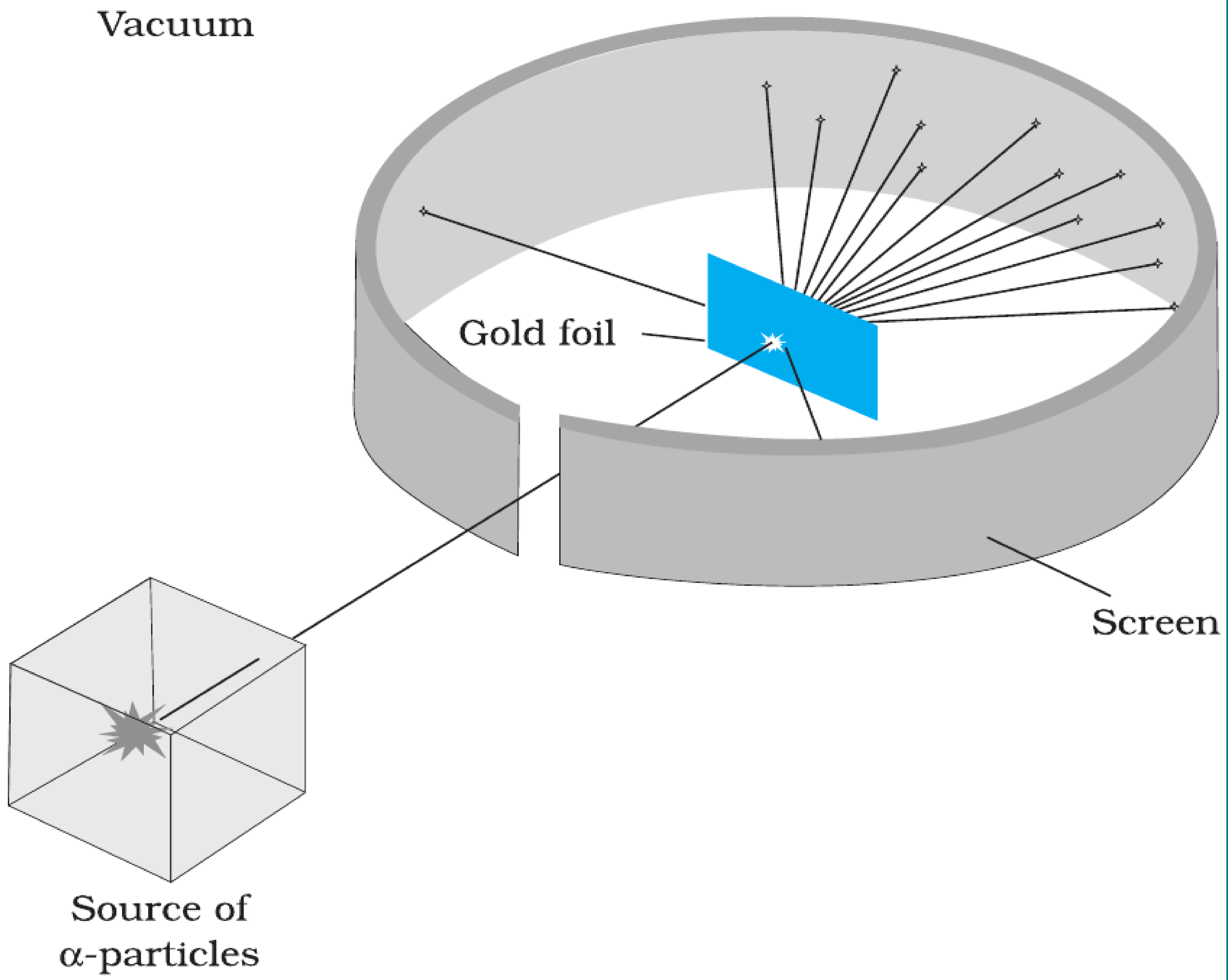


FIGURE 12.1 Geiger-Marsden scattering experiment. The entire apparatus is placed in a vacuum chamber (not shown in this figure).

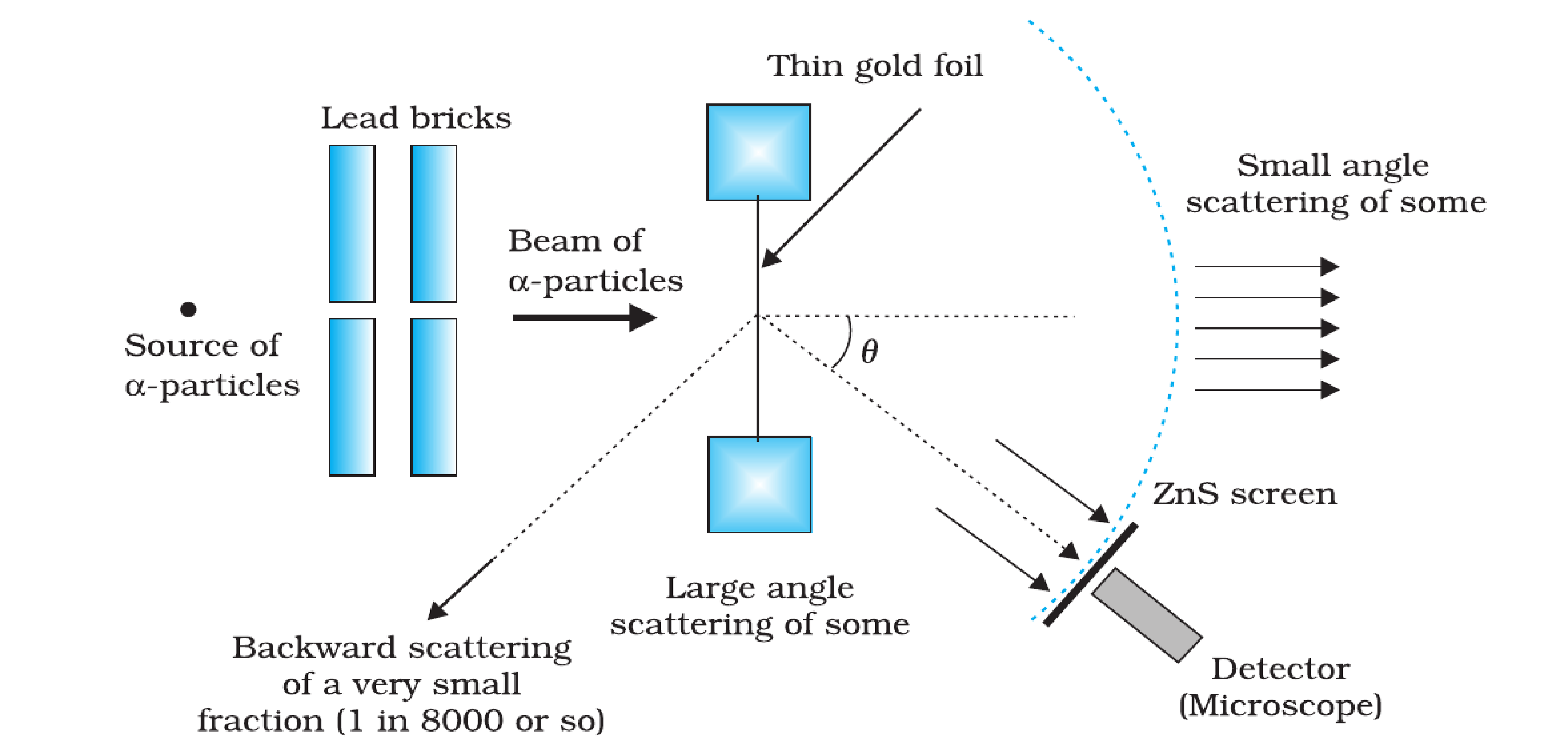
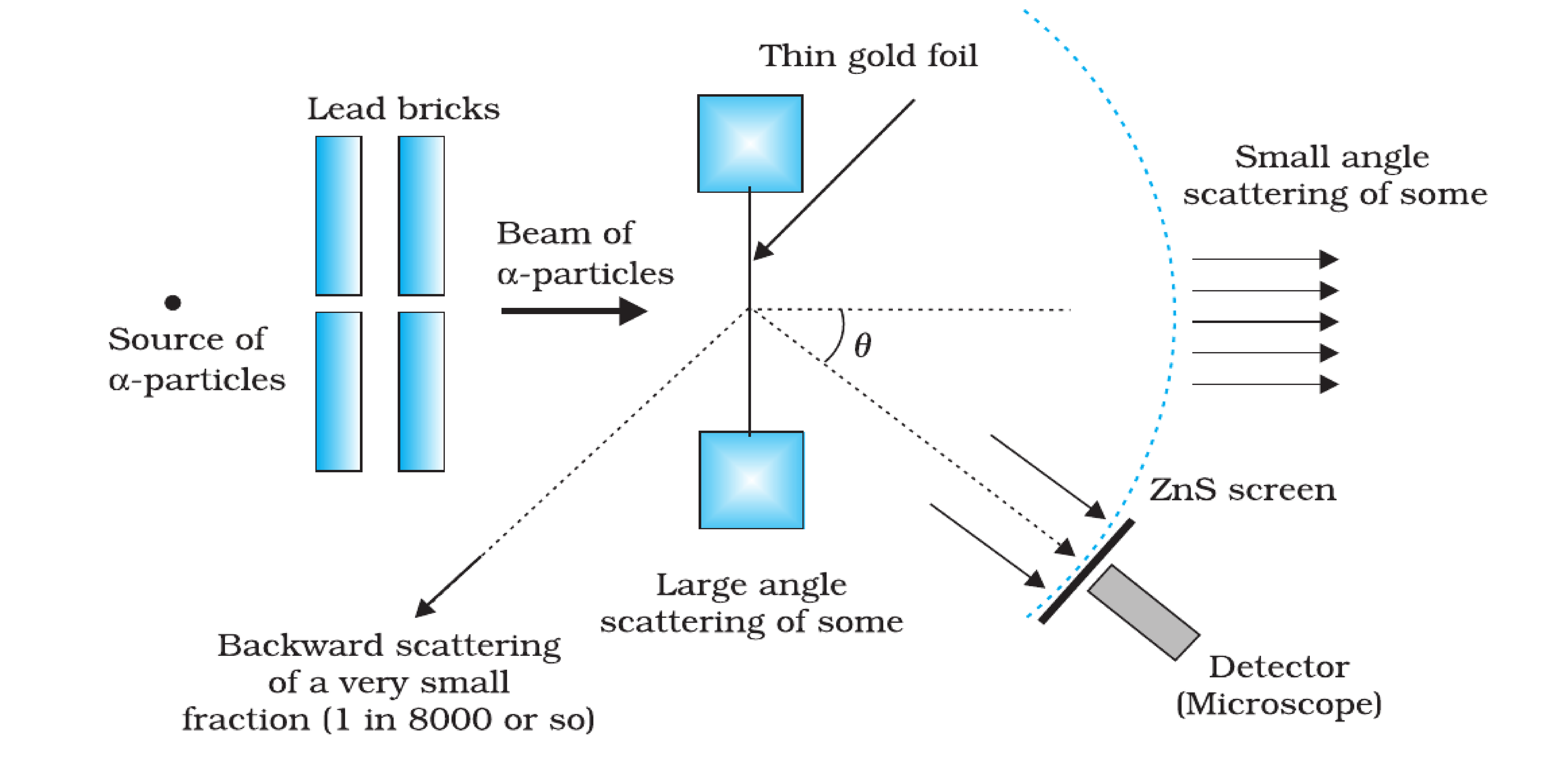


FIGURE 12.2 Schematic arrangement of the Geiger-Marsden experiment.

GEIGER–MARSDEN EXPERIMENT (1911)



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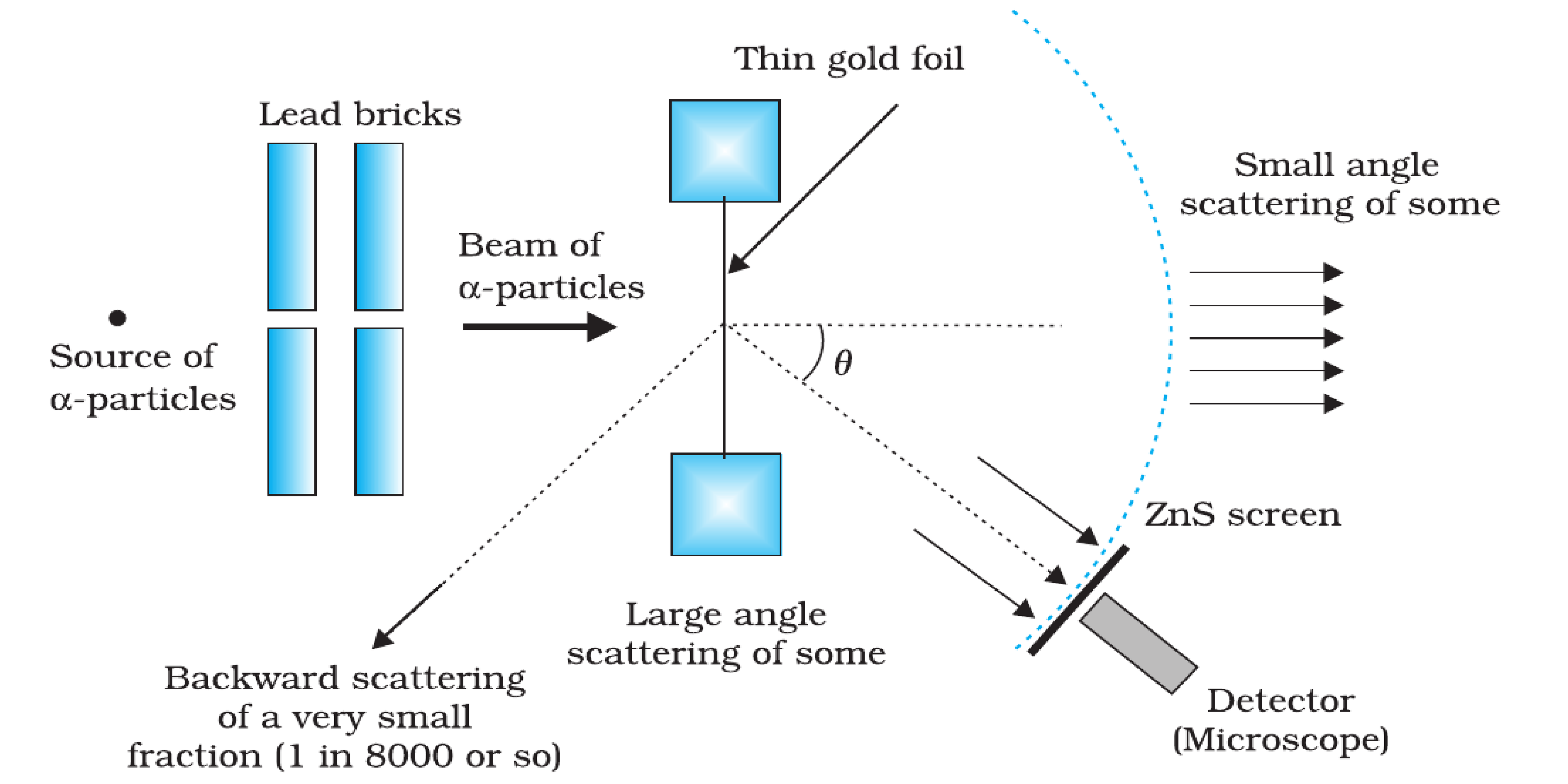

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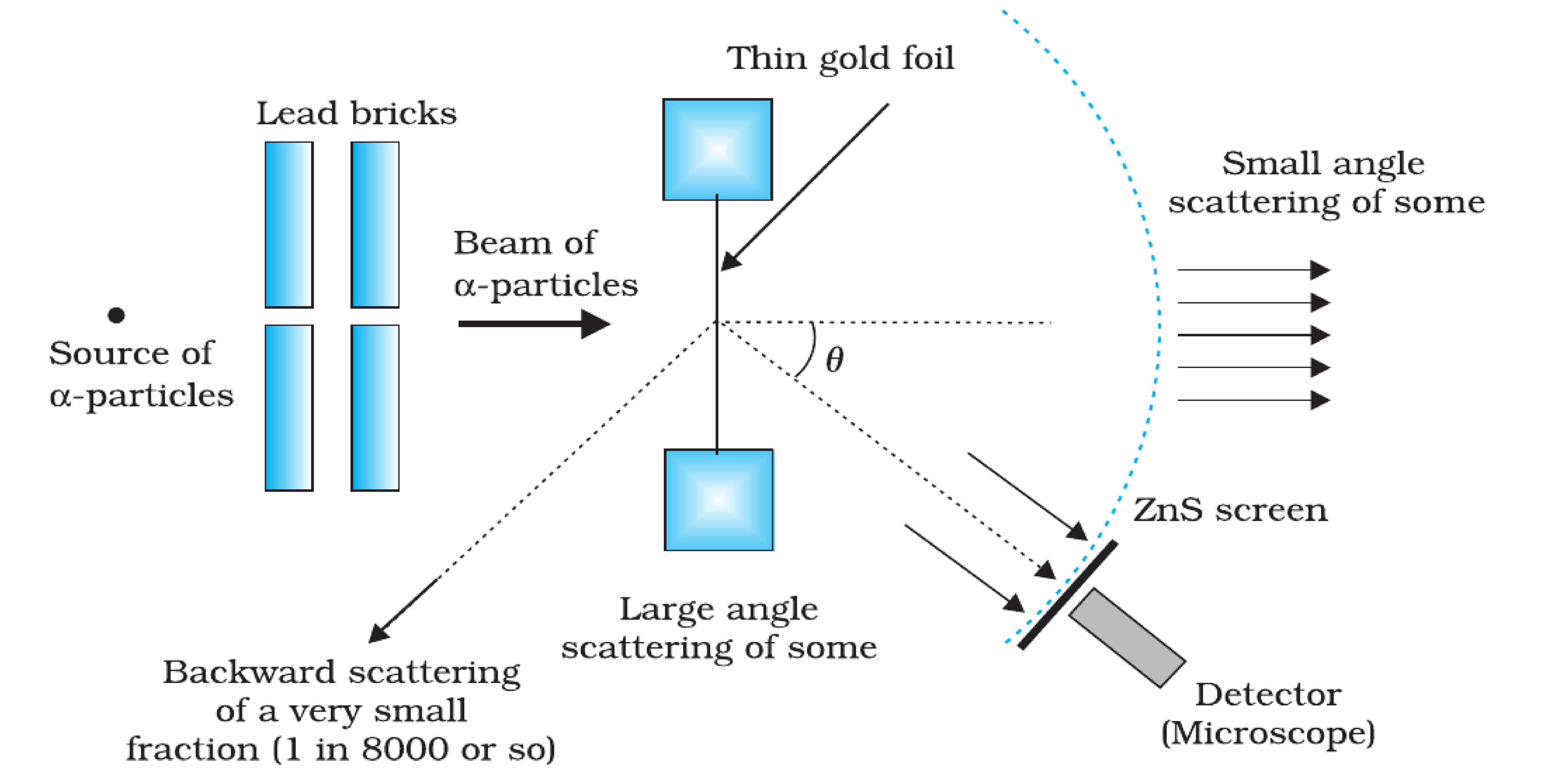

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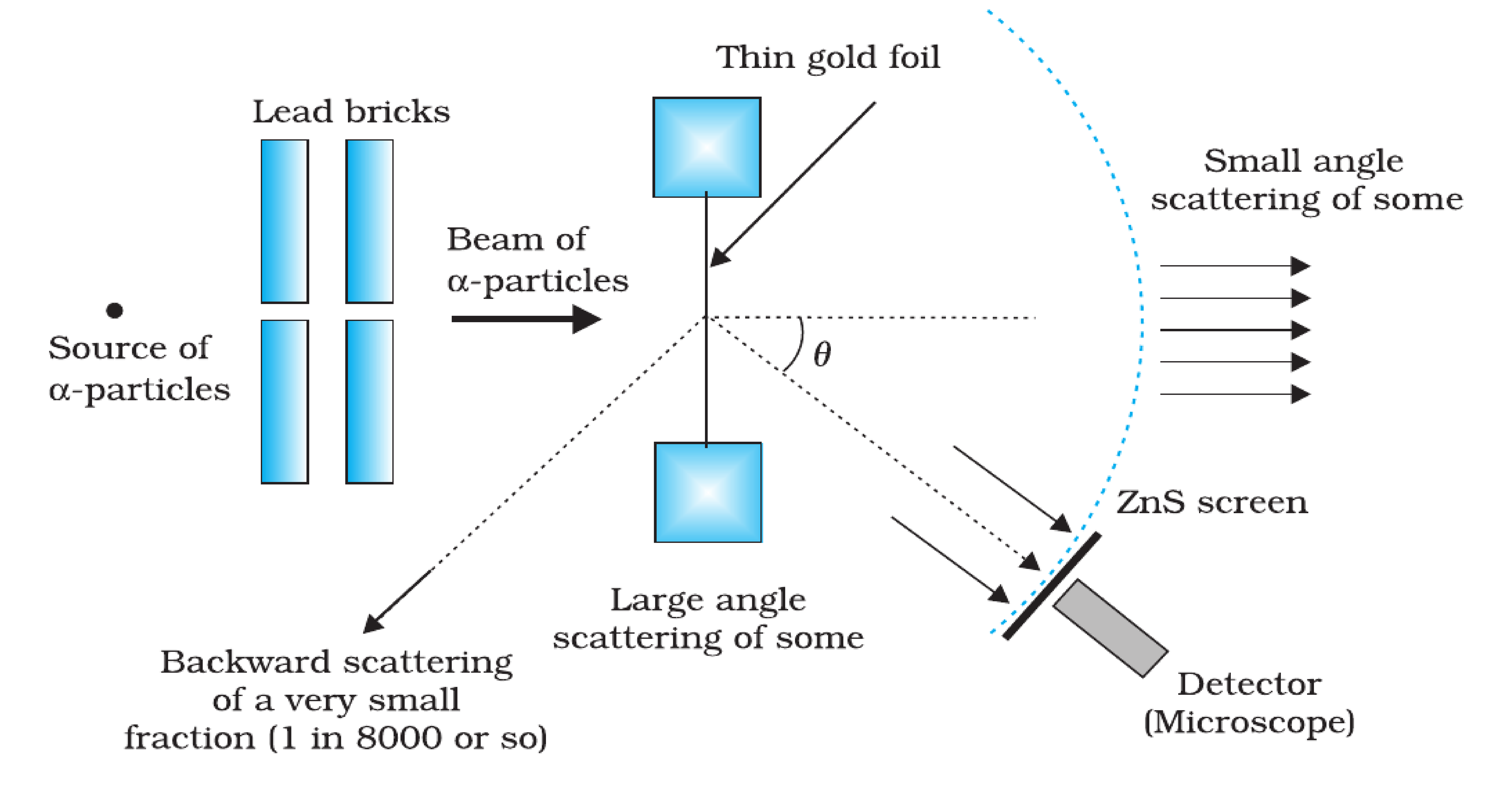

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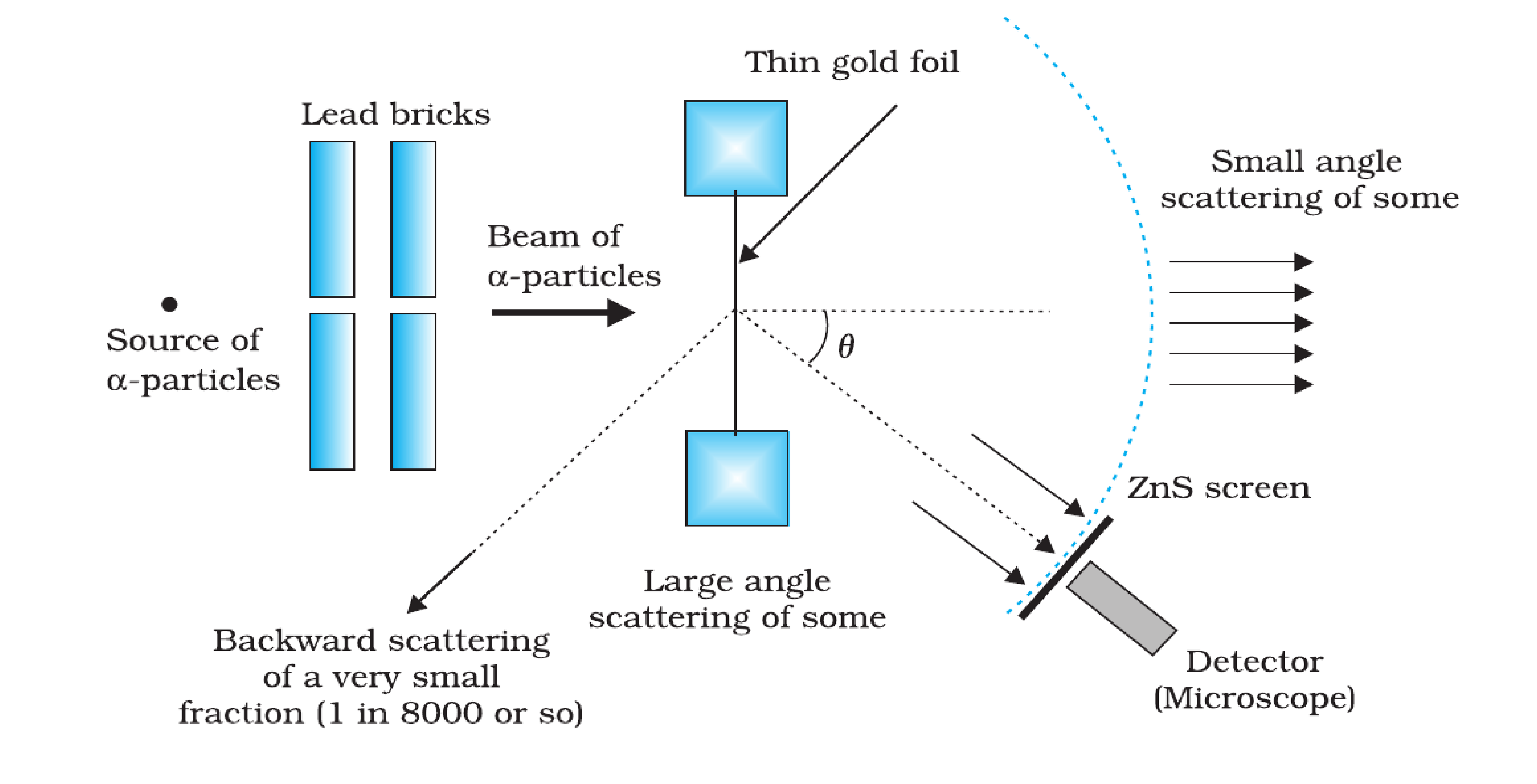

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- Entire setup kept in a **vacuum chamber**.

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Key Experimental Findings

- $\sim$99% α-particles passed through without any deflection.

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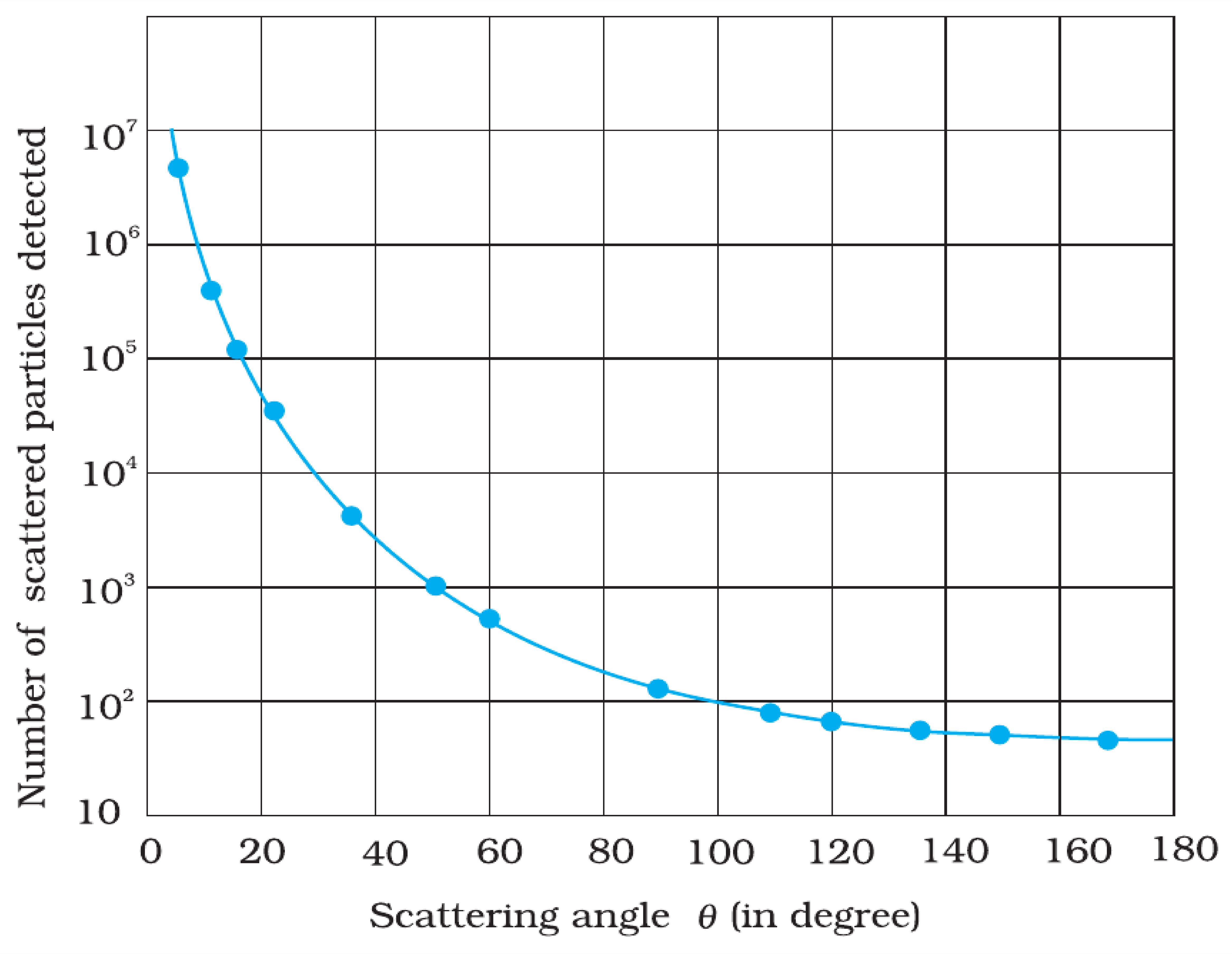
- About **0.14%** deflected by small angles ($> 1°$).
- About **1 in 8000** deflected at large angles ($> 90°$), some even bounced back.
- Such large deflections were **impossible to explain** with Thomson's model of atom.

GRAPHICAL RESULTS



Scattering Curve

- Plot: **Number of scattered α-particles vs. scattering angle θ.**

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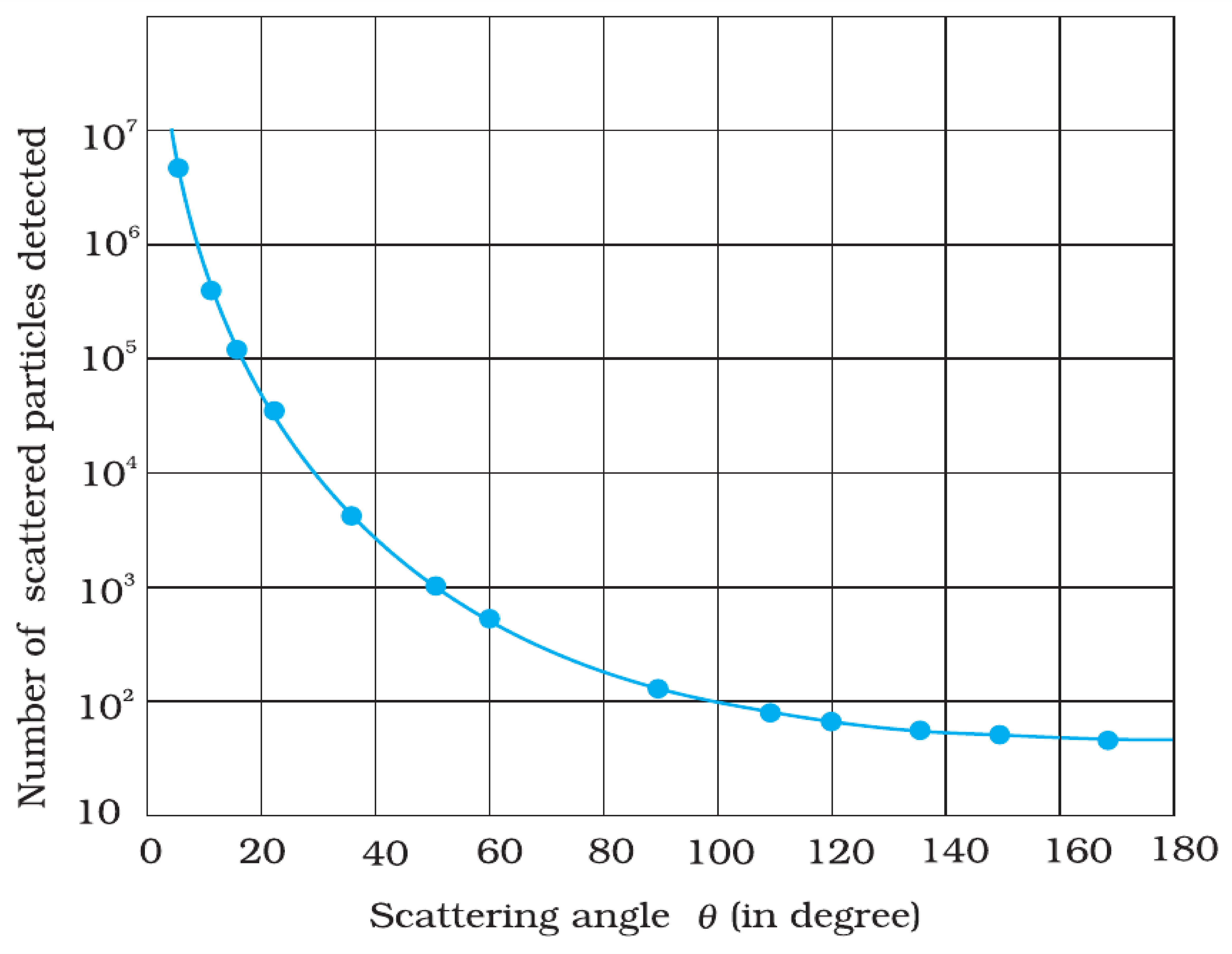

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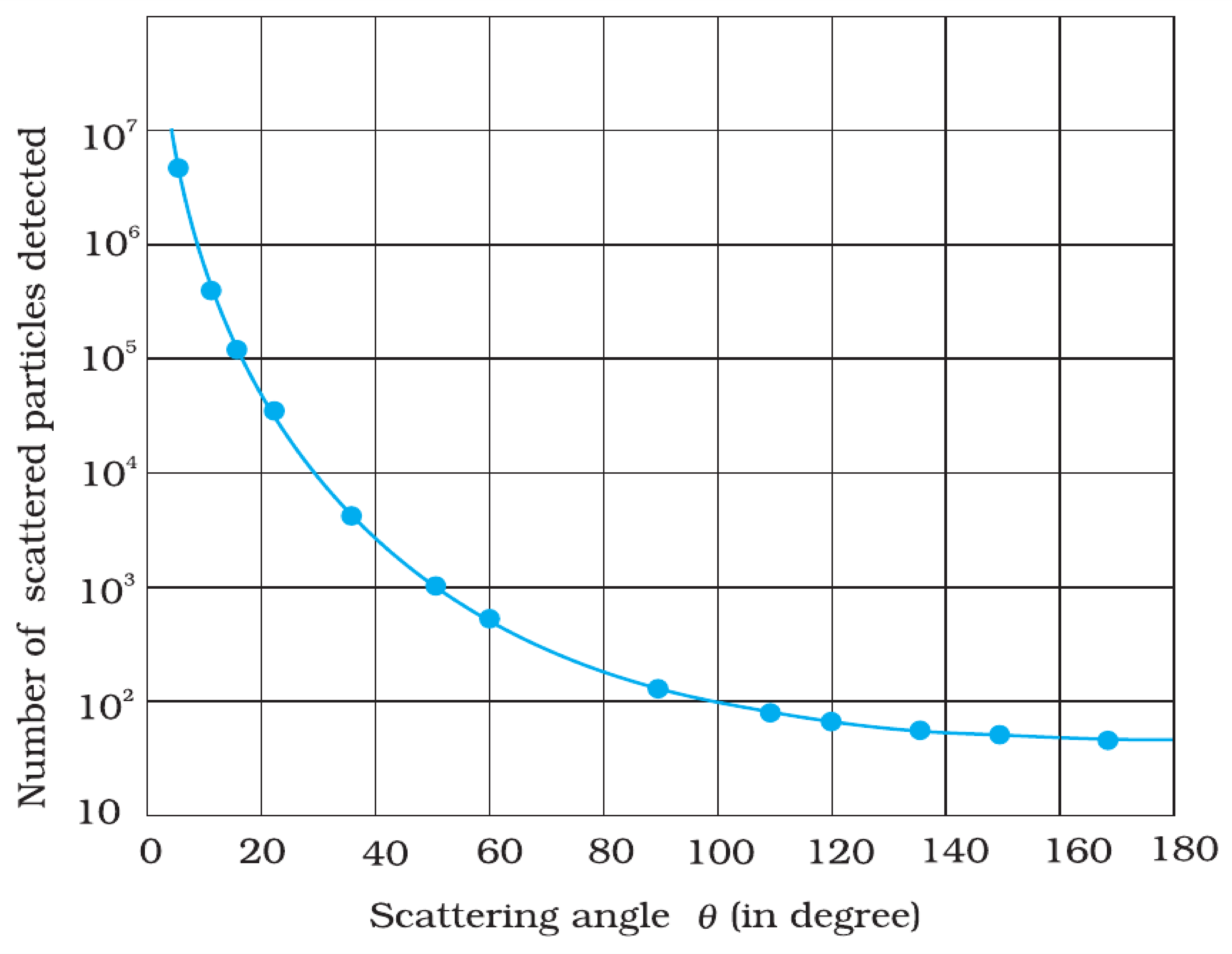

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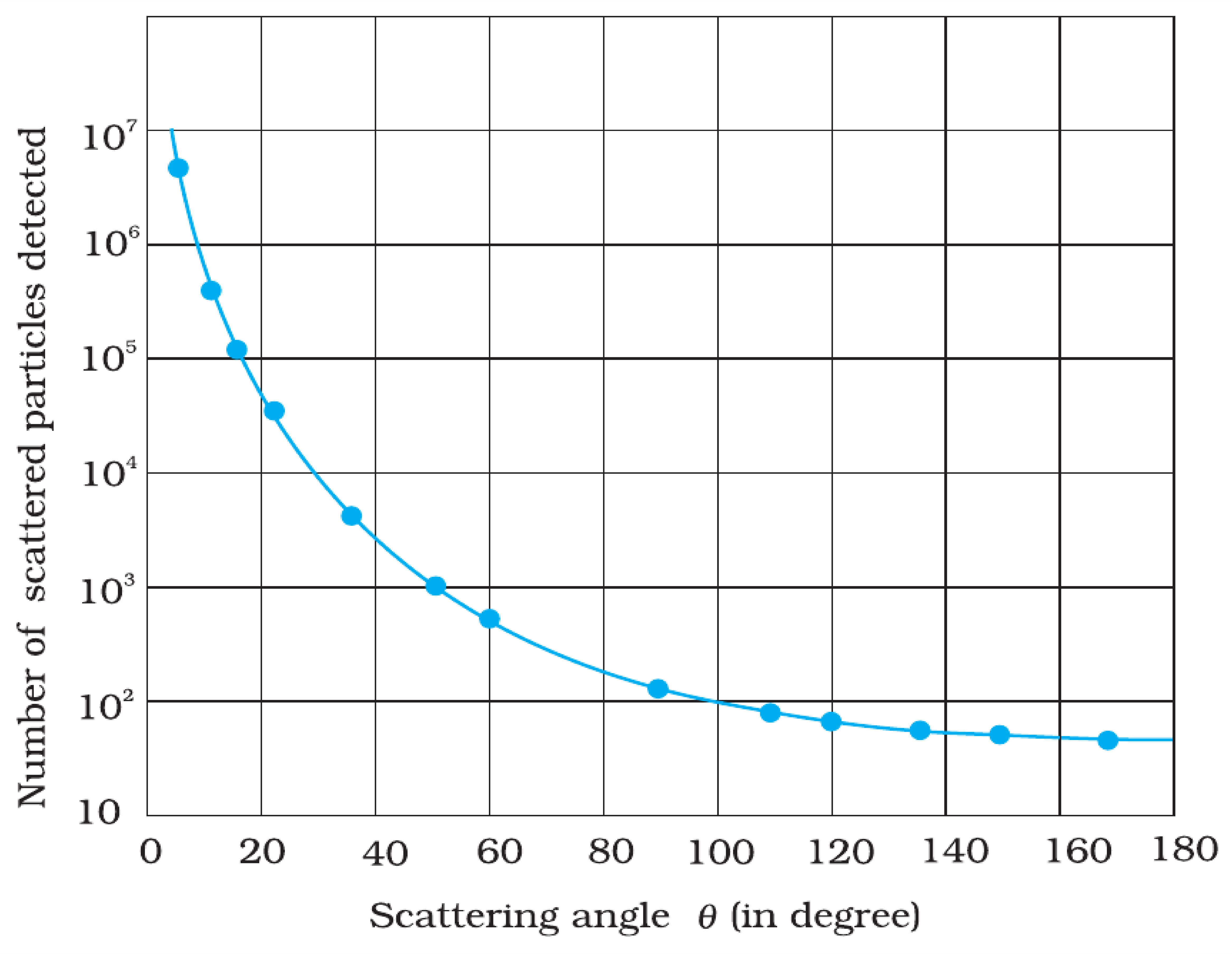

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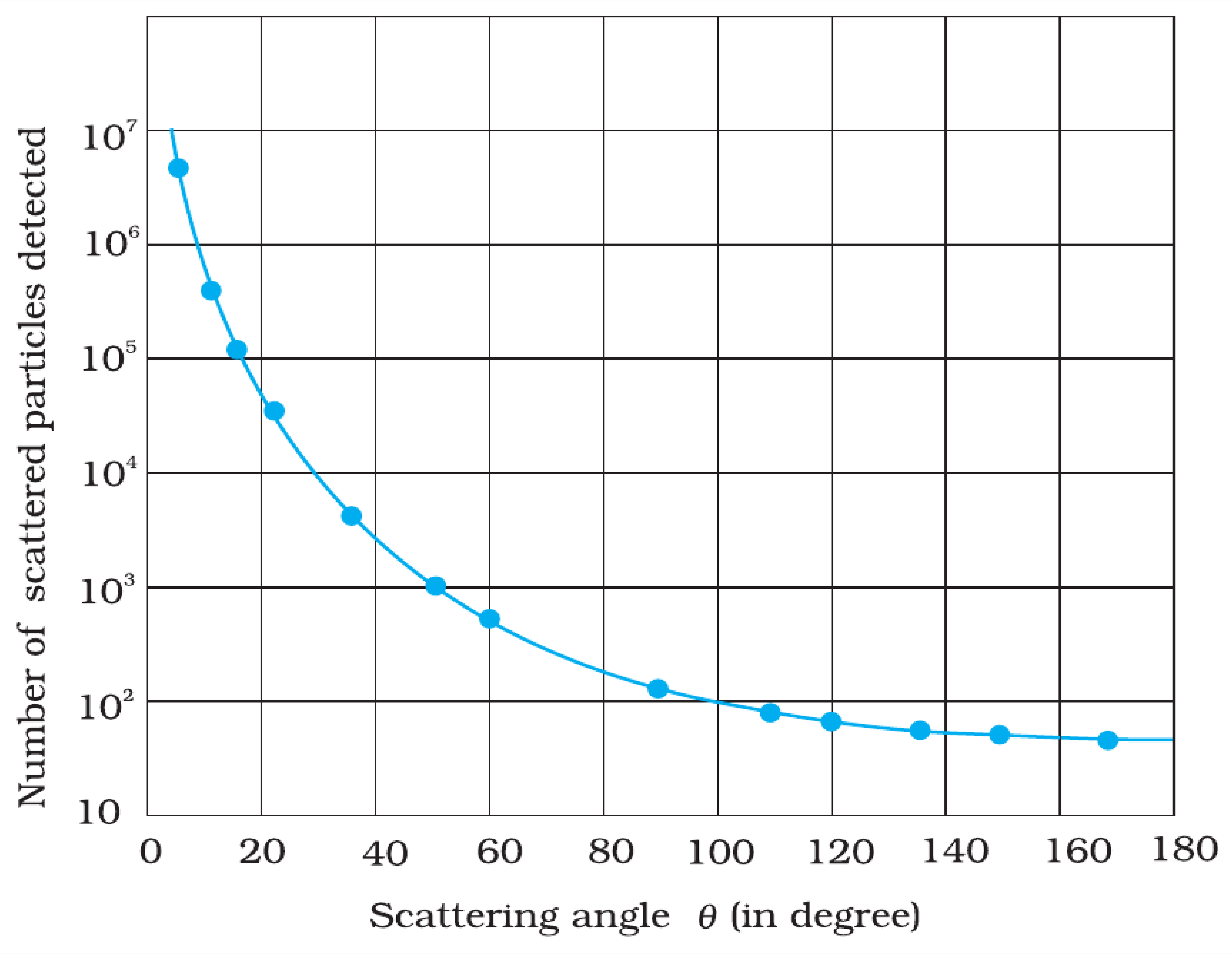

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- This confirmed: **positive charge is concentrated in a small, dense nucleus**.

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Features of the Model

- Atom has a tiny, dense, **positively charged nucleus** at the centre.

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- Nearly all the **mass of atom** is concentrated in the nucleus.
- Electrons revolve around nucleus like **planets around the Sun**.
- Most of the atom is **empty space** $\Rightarrow$ explains why most α-particles passed through undeflected.

COULOMB FORCE ON α-PARTICLES

Force Expression

- Each α-particle carries charge $+2e$, nucleus of atomic number Z has charge $+Ze$.

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- Becomes very large when r is very small $\Rightarrow$ responsible for large-angle deflections.

TRAJECTORY OF α-PARTICLES

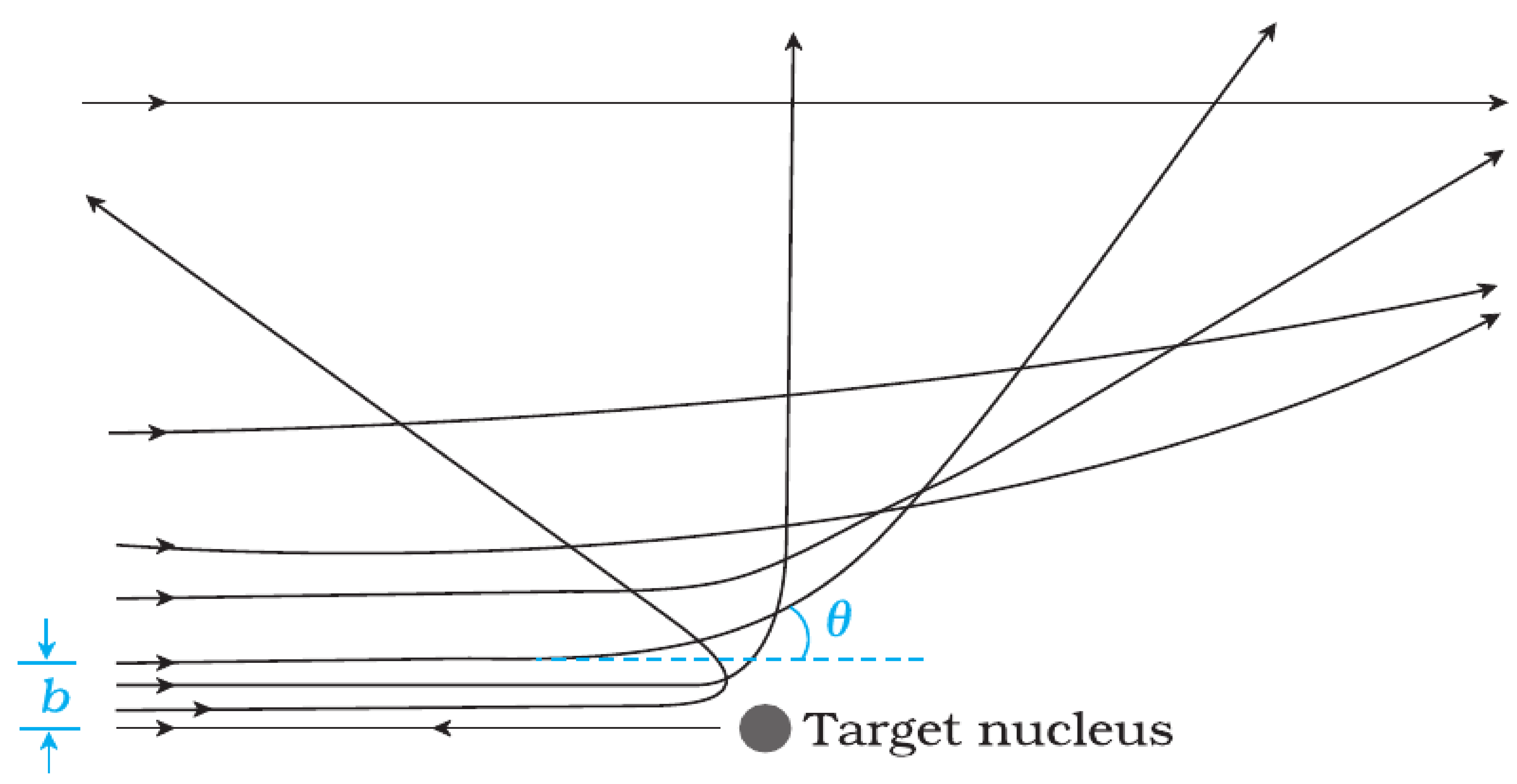

FIGURE 12.4 Trajectory of α-particles in the coulomb field of a target nucleus. The impact parameter, b and scattering angle θ are also depicted.

Deflected Paths

- Far from nucleus: force negligible, path is straight line.

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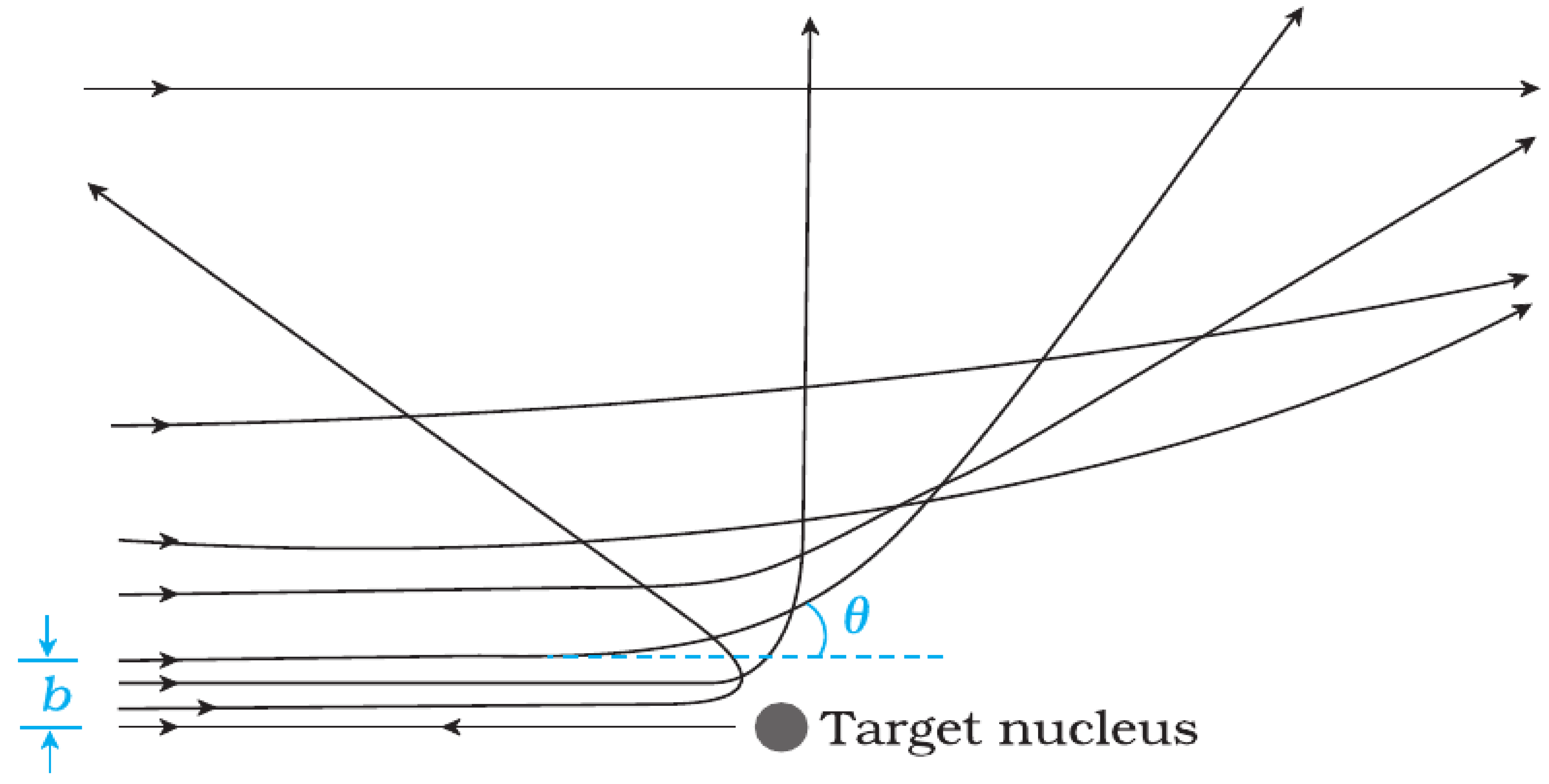

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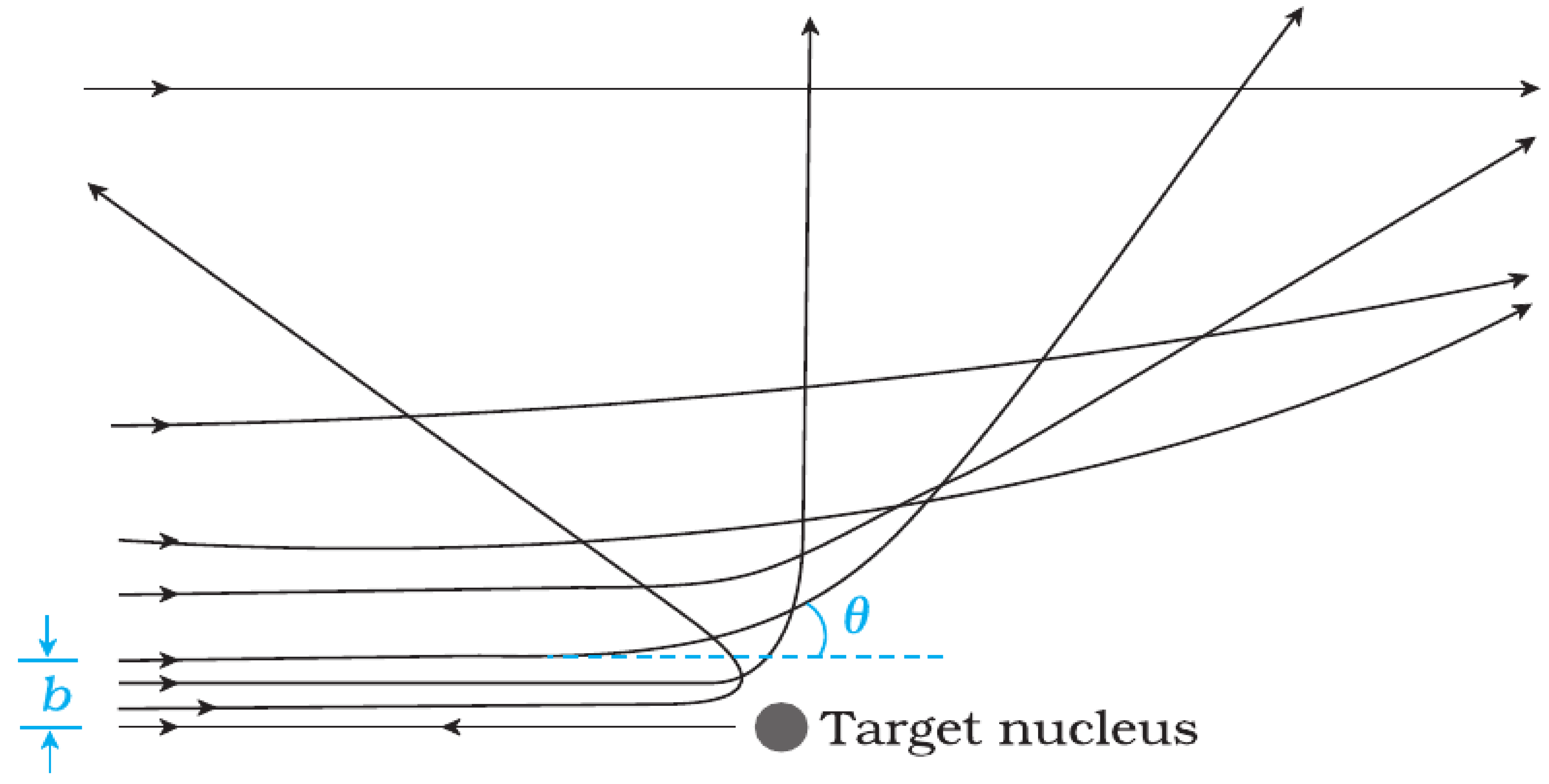

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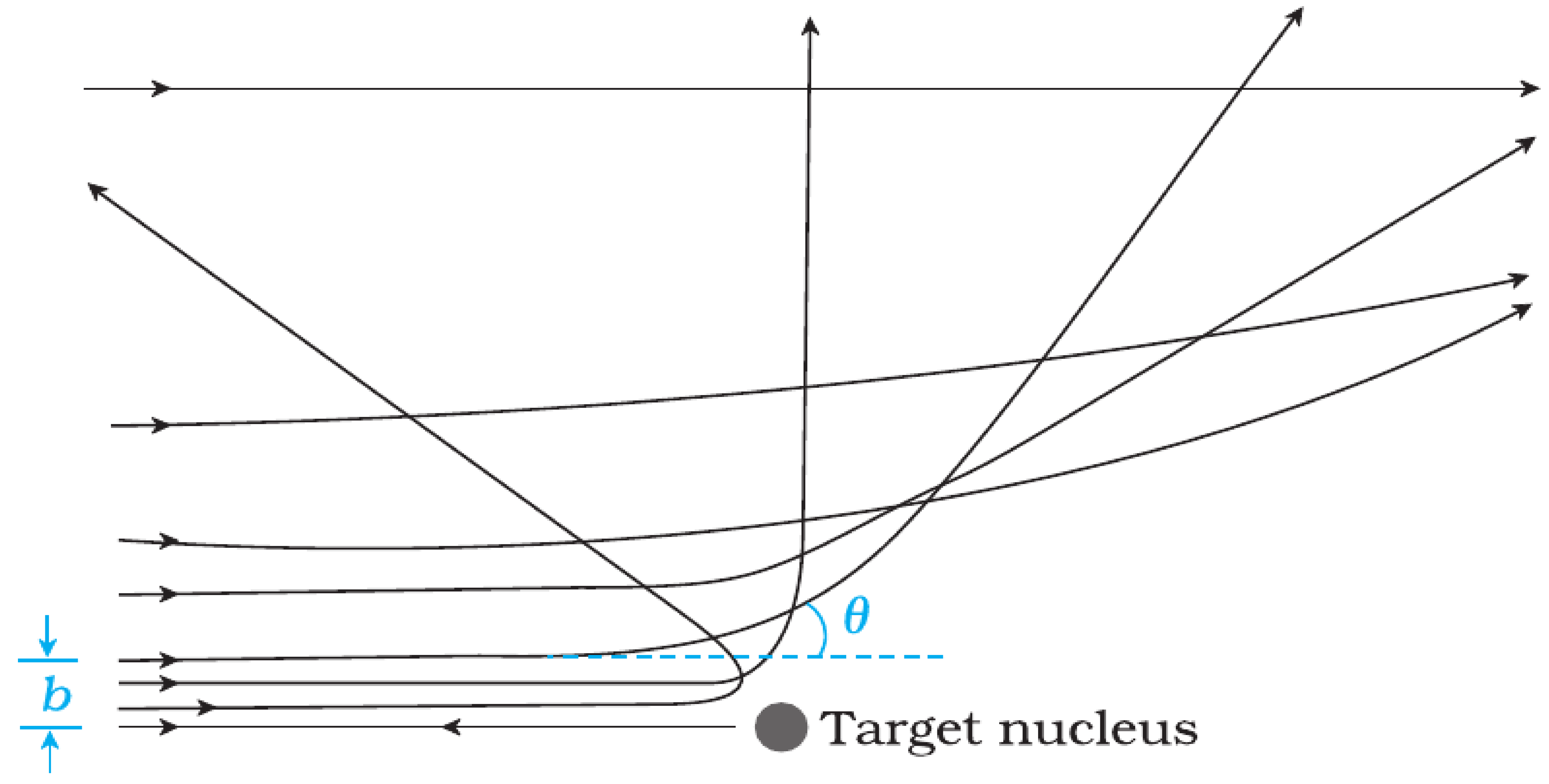

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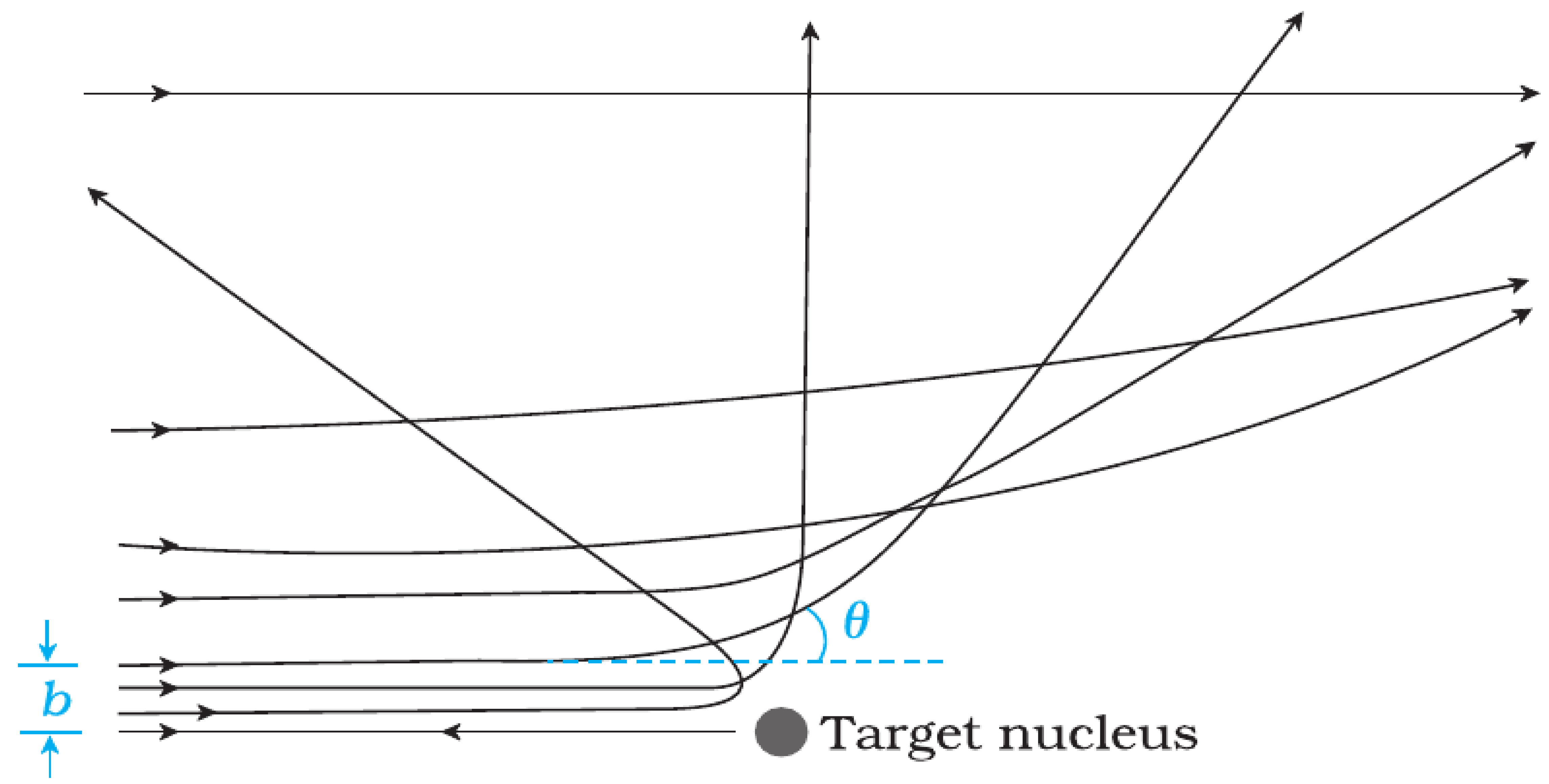
- **Large deflections/backscattering:** very small distance of approach.

IMPACT PARAMETER (b)



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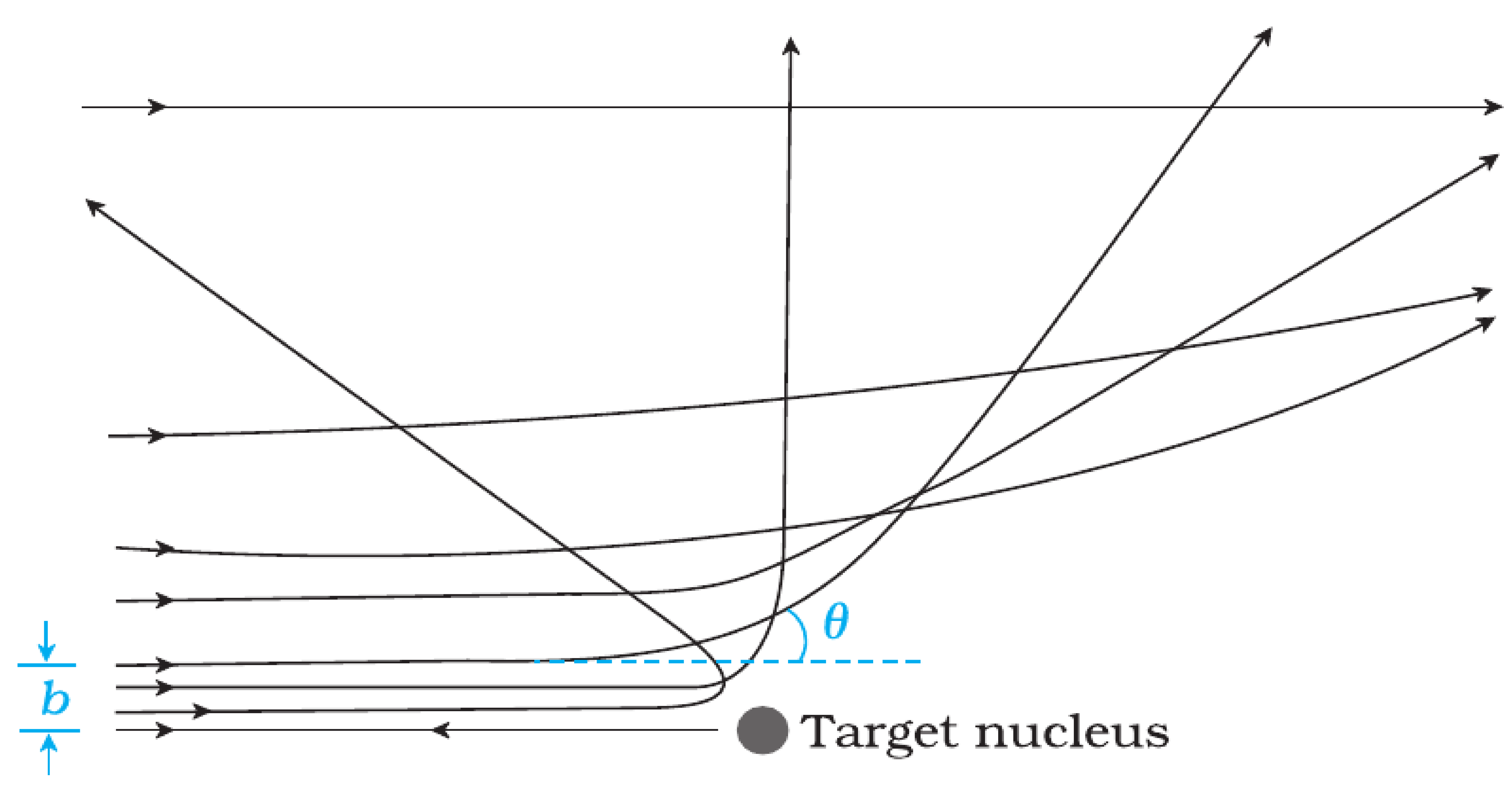

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Definition & Role

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- Determines closeness of approach:

IMPACT PARAMETER (b)

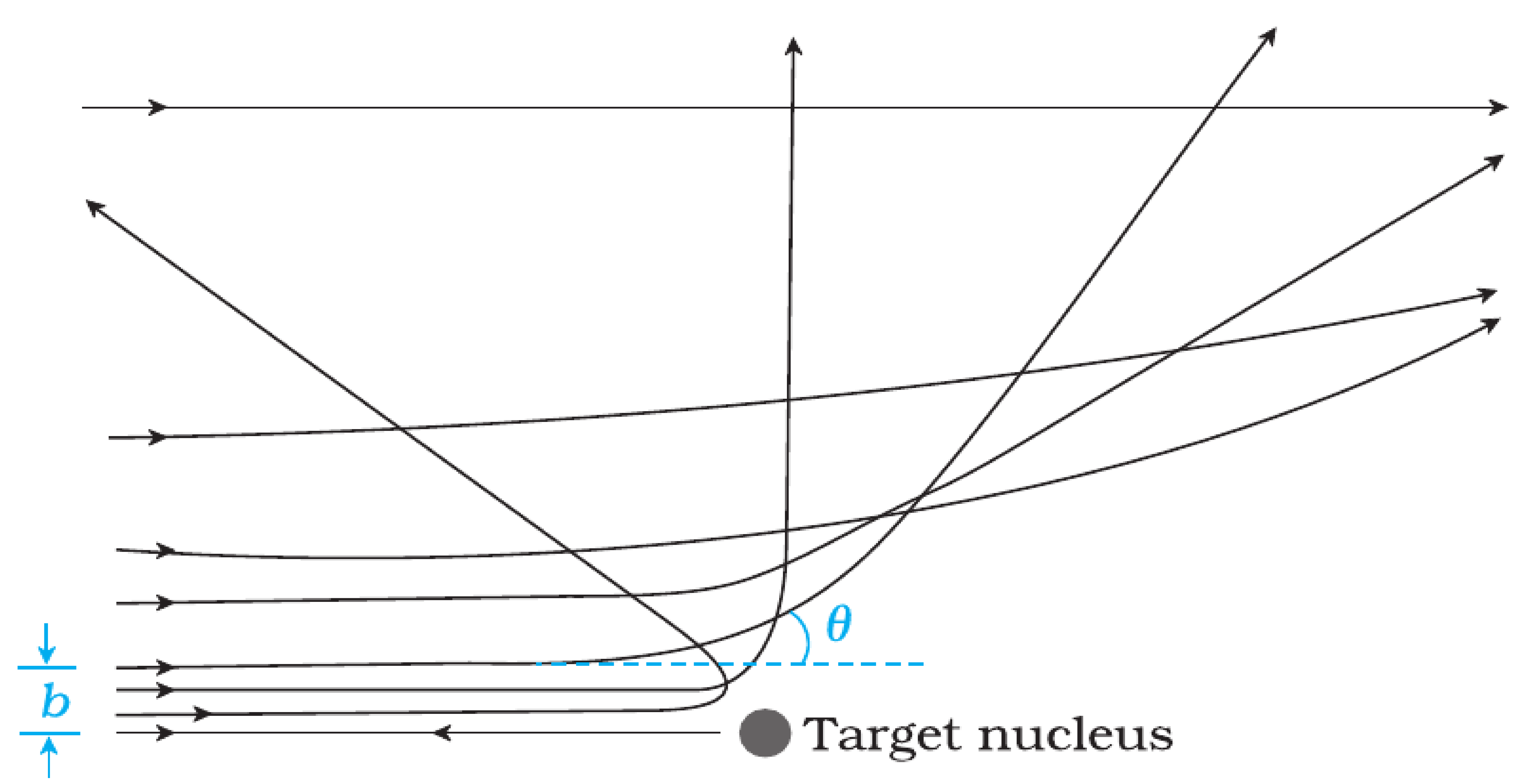

FIGURE 12.4 Trajectory of α-particles in the coulomb field of a target nucleus. The impact parameter, b and scattering angle θ are also depicted.

Definition & Role

- **Impact parameter b:** perpendicular distance between initial velocity vector of α-particle (undeflected path) and nucleus centre.
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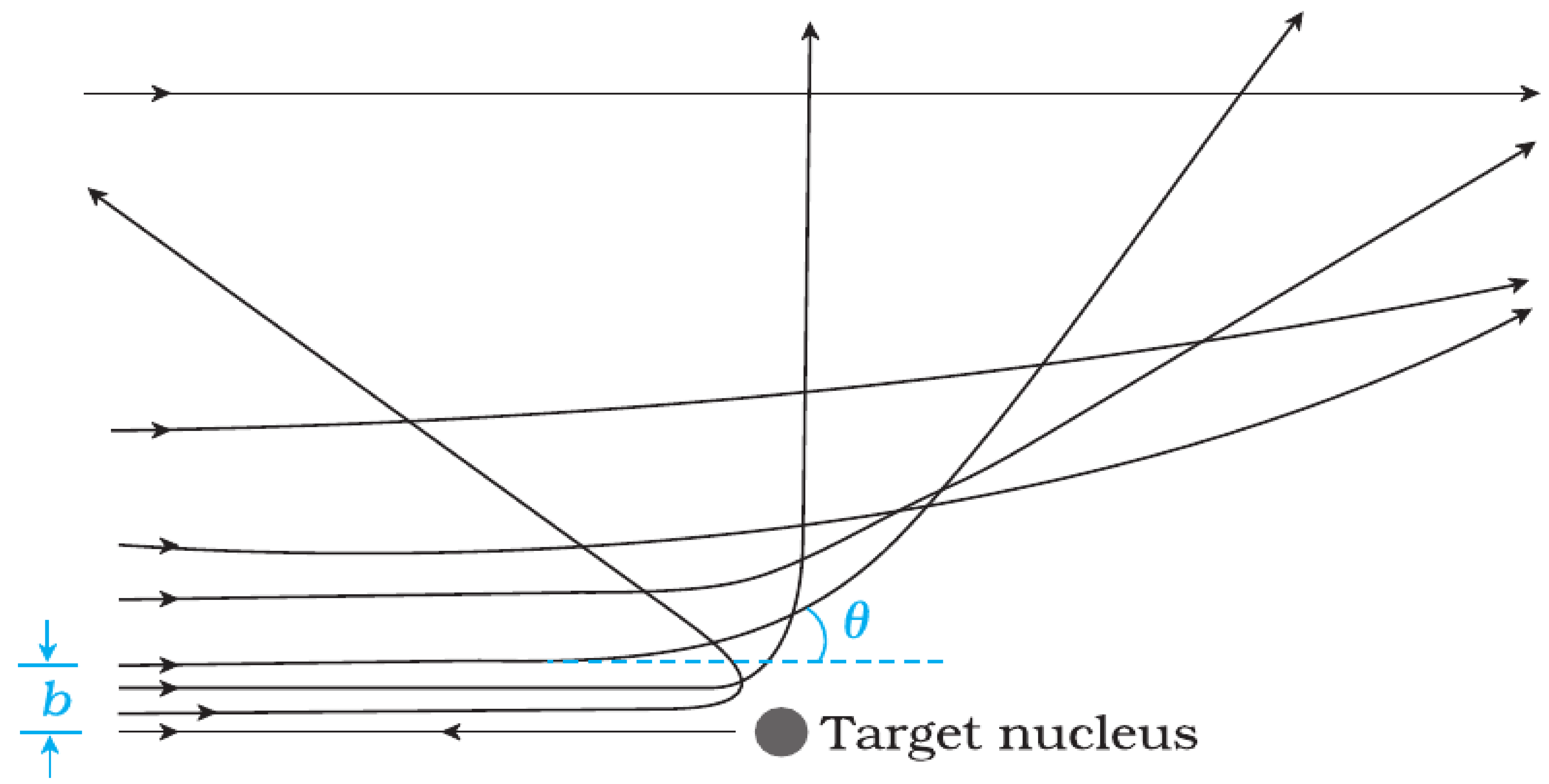

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RELATION BETWEEN b AND SCATTERING ANGLE θ

Mathematical Relation

- Rutherford derived the following relation:

$$\theta = 2\tan^{-1}\left(\frac{Ze^2}{4\pi\epsilon_0\, mv^2\, b}\right)$$

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DISTANCE OF CLOSEST APPROACH ($r_{\min}$)

Concept

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- Therefore,

$$r_{\text{min}} = \frac{1}{4\pi\epsilon_0}\frac{2Ze^2}{\frac{1}{2}mv^2}$$

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- Provides an **upper estimate of nuclear size**.
- For gold nucleus ($Z = 79$) with 5.5 MeV α-particles, $r_{\min} \sim 3.2 \times 10^{-14}$ m.
- Since actual nuclear radius is smaller, the experiment proved that **nucleus is extremely small compared to atom**.

Example 12.1 In the Rutherford's nuclear model of the atom, the nucleus (radius about 10^{-15} m) is analogous to the sun about which the electron move in orbit (radius $\approx 10^{-10}$ m) like the earth orbits around the sun. If the dimensions of the solar system had the same proportions as those of the atom, would the earth be closer to or farther away from the sun than actually it is? The radius of earth's orbit is about 1.5×10^{11} m. The radius of sun is taken as 7×10^{8} m.

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Solution The ratio of the radius of electron's orbit to the radius of nucleus is $(10^{-10}\text{ m})/(10^{-15}\text{ m}) = 10^5$, that is, the radius of the electron's orbit is 10^5 times larger than the radius of nucleus. If the radius of the earth's orbit around the sun were 10^5 times larger than the radius of the sun, the radius of the earth's orbit would be $10^5 \times 7 \times 10^8$ m = 7×10^{13} m. This is more than 100 times greater than the actual orbital radius of earth. Thus, the earth would be much farther away from the sun.

It implies that an atom contains a much greater fraction of empty space than our solar system does.

Example 12.2 In a Geiger-Marsden experiment, what is the distance of closest approach to the nucleus of a 7.7 MeV α-particle before it comes momentarily to rest and reverses its direction?

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$$K = \frac{1}{4\pi\varepsilon_0}\frac{(2e)(Ze)}{d} = \frac{2Ze^2}{4\pi\varepsilon_0 d}$$

Thus the distance of closest approach d is given by

$$d = \frac{2Ze^2}{4\pi\varepsilon_0 K}$$

The maximum kinetic energy found in α-particles of natural origin is 7.7 MeV or 1.2×10^{-12} J. Since $1/4\pi\varepsilon_0 = 9.0 \times 10^9$ N m^2/C^2. Therefore with $e = 1.6 \times 10^{-19}$ C, we have,

$$d = \frac{(2)(9.0\times10^9\,\mathrm{Nm}^2/C^2)(1.6\times10^{-19}\,C)^2 Z}{1.2\times10^{-12}\,\mathrm{J}}$$

$$= 3.84 \times 10^{-16}\ Z\ \mathrm{m}$$

The atomic number of foil material gold is $Z = 79$, so that

d (Au) = 3.0×10^{-14} m = 30 fm. (1 fm (i.e. fermi) = 10^{-15} m.)

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Kinetic, Potential Energies and Total Energies

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- Kinetic energy:

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Example 12.3 It is found experimentally that 13.6 eV energy is required to separate a hydrogen atom into a proton and an electron. Compute the orbital radius and the velocity of the electron in a hydrogen atom.

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Solution Total energy of the electron in hydrogen atom is –13.6 eV = $-13.6 \times 1.6 \times 10^{-19}$ J = -2.2×10^{-18} J. Thus from Eq. (12.4), we have

$$E = -\frac{e^2}{8\pi\varepsilon_0 r} = -2.2 \times 10^{-18} \text{ J}$$

This gives the orbital radius

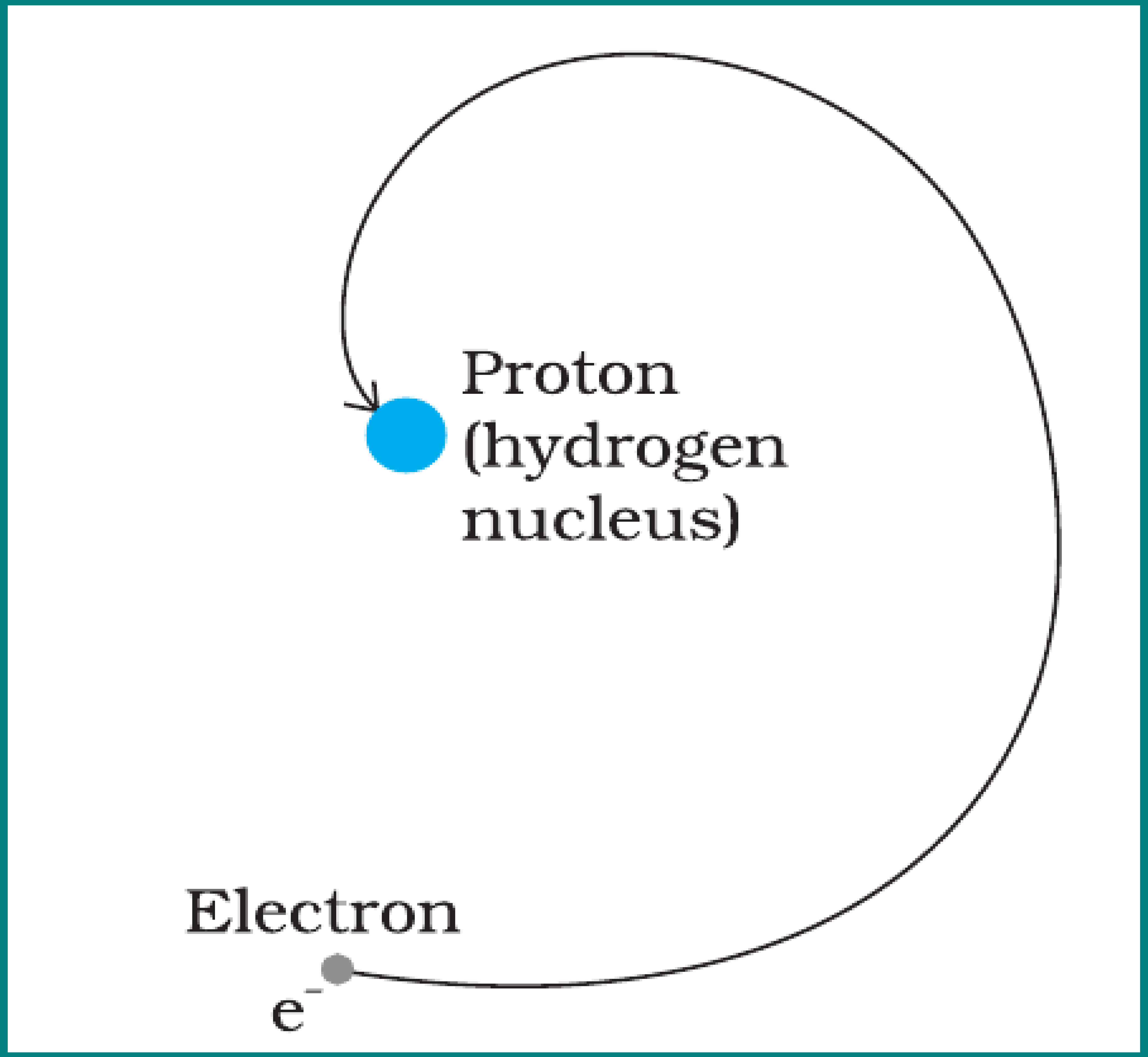
$$r = -\frac{e^2}{8\pi\varepsilon_0 E} = -\frac{(9 \times 10^9 \text{ N m}^2/\text{C}^2)(1.6 \times 10^{-19}\text{C})^2}{(2)(-2.2 \times 10^{-18} \text{ J})}$$

$$= 5.3 \times 10^{-11} \text{ m.}$$

The velocity of the revolving electron can be computed from Eq. (12.3) with $m = 9.1 \times 10^{-31}$ kg,

$$v = \frac{e}{\sqrt{4\pi\varepsilon_0 mr}} = 2.2 \times 10^6 \text{ m/s.}$$

LIMITATIONS OF RUTHERFORD’S MODEL



(1) Instability of Atom

- In Rutherford’s model, the electron revolves around the nucleus under Coulomb attraction.

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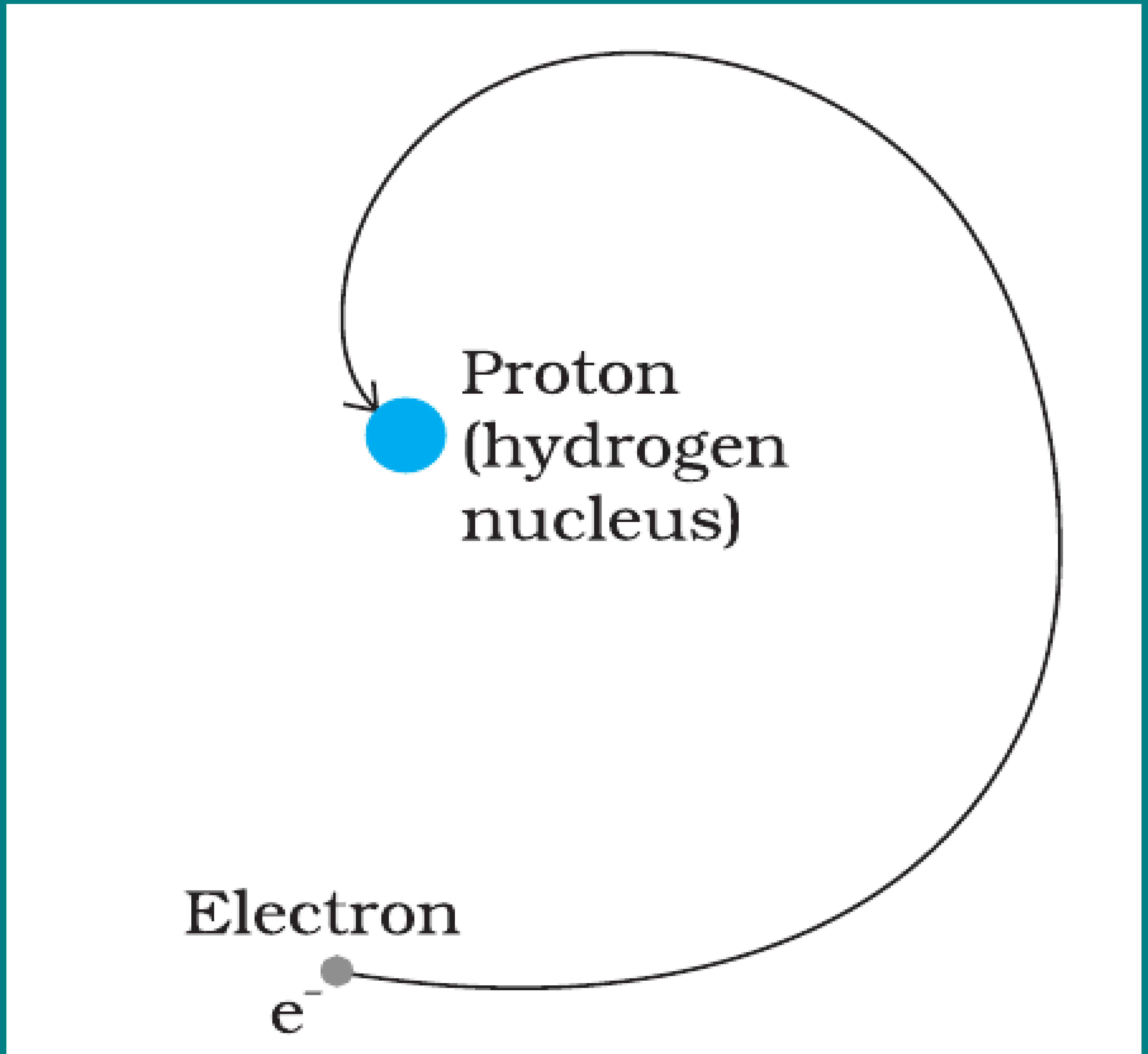

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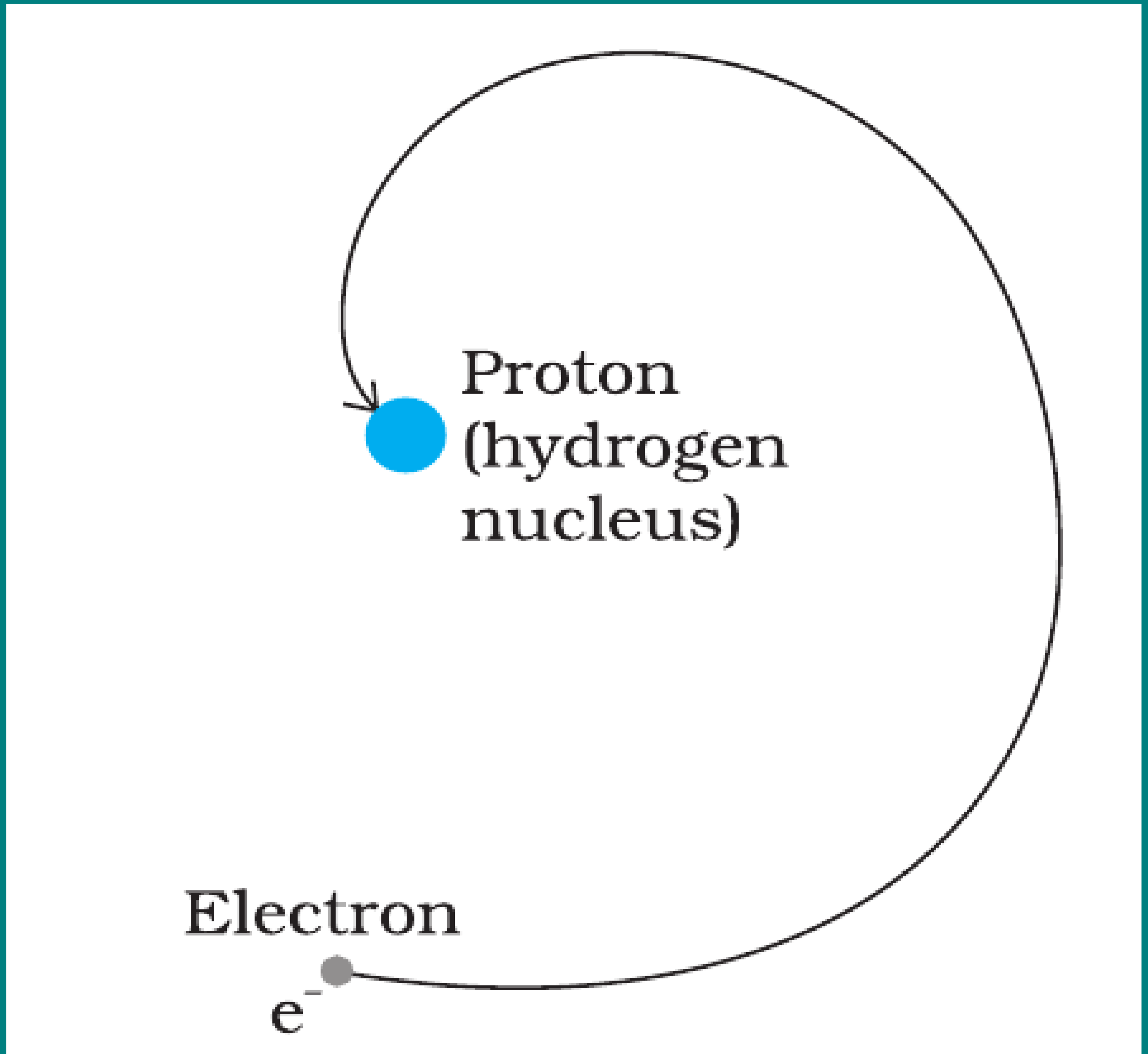

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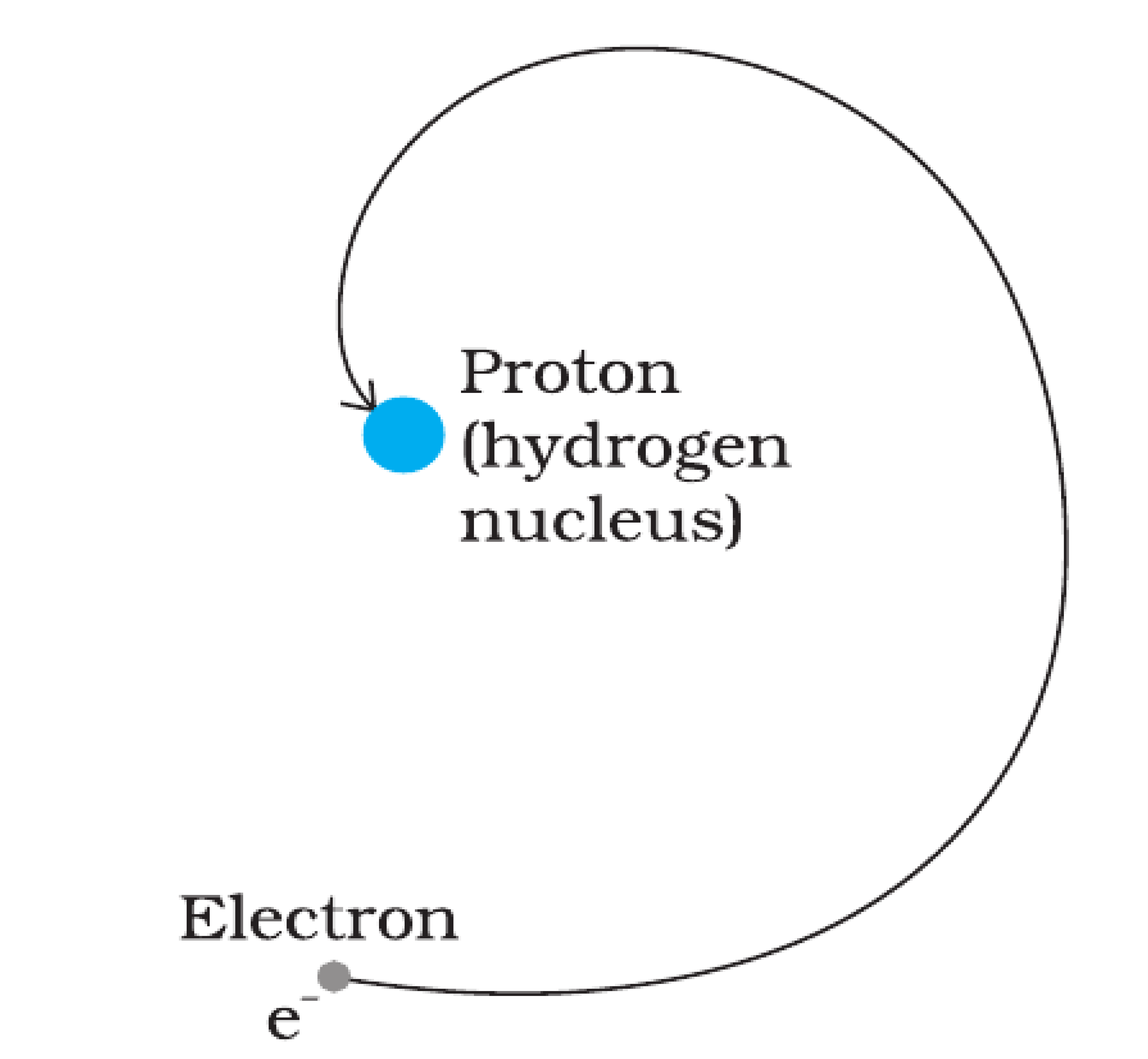

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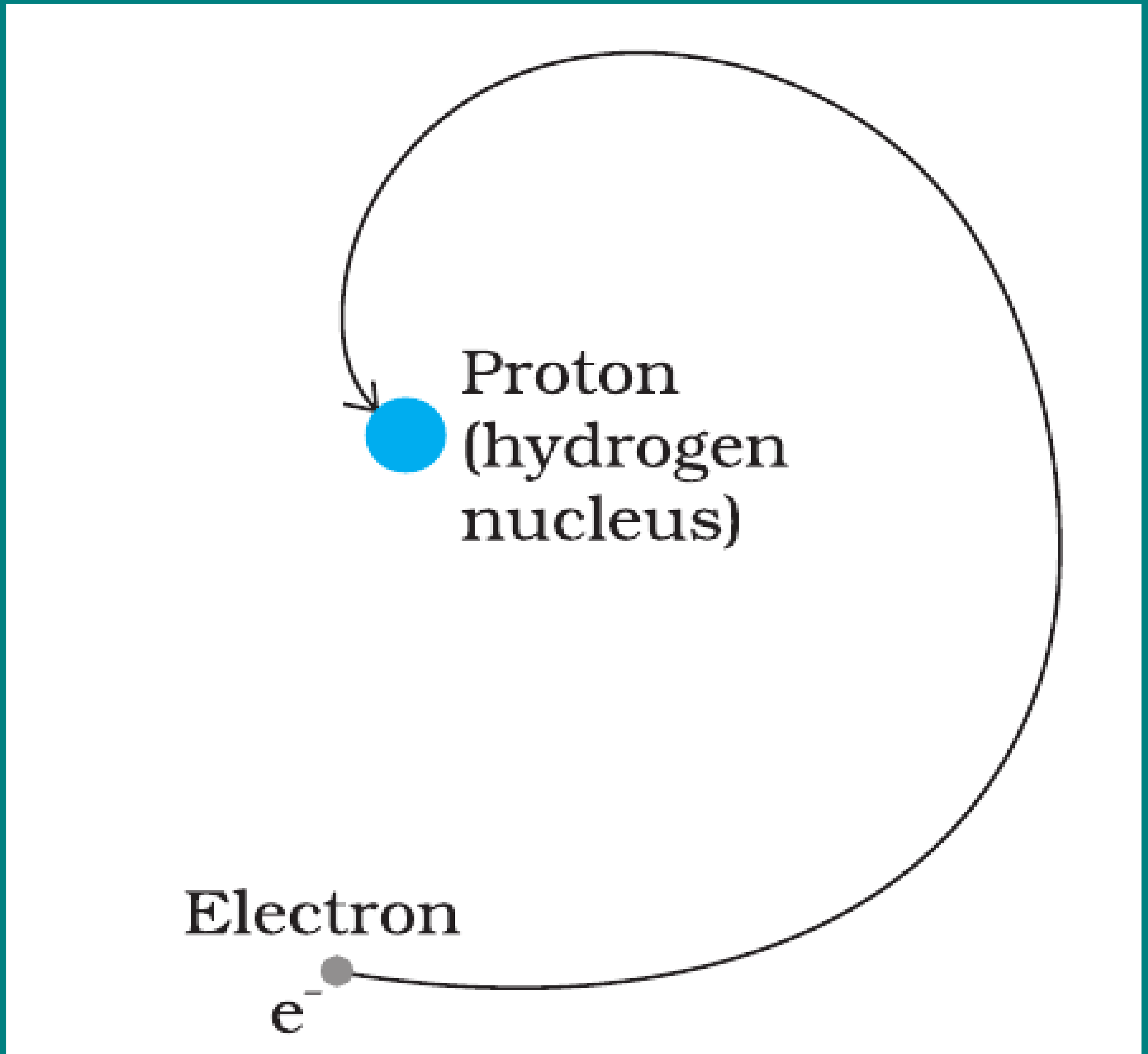

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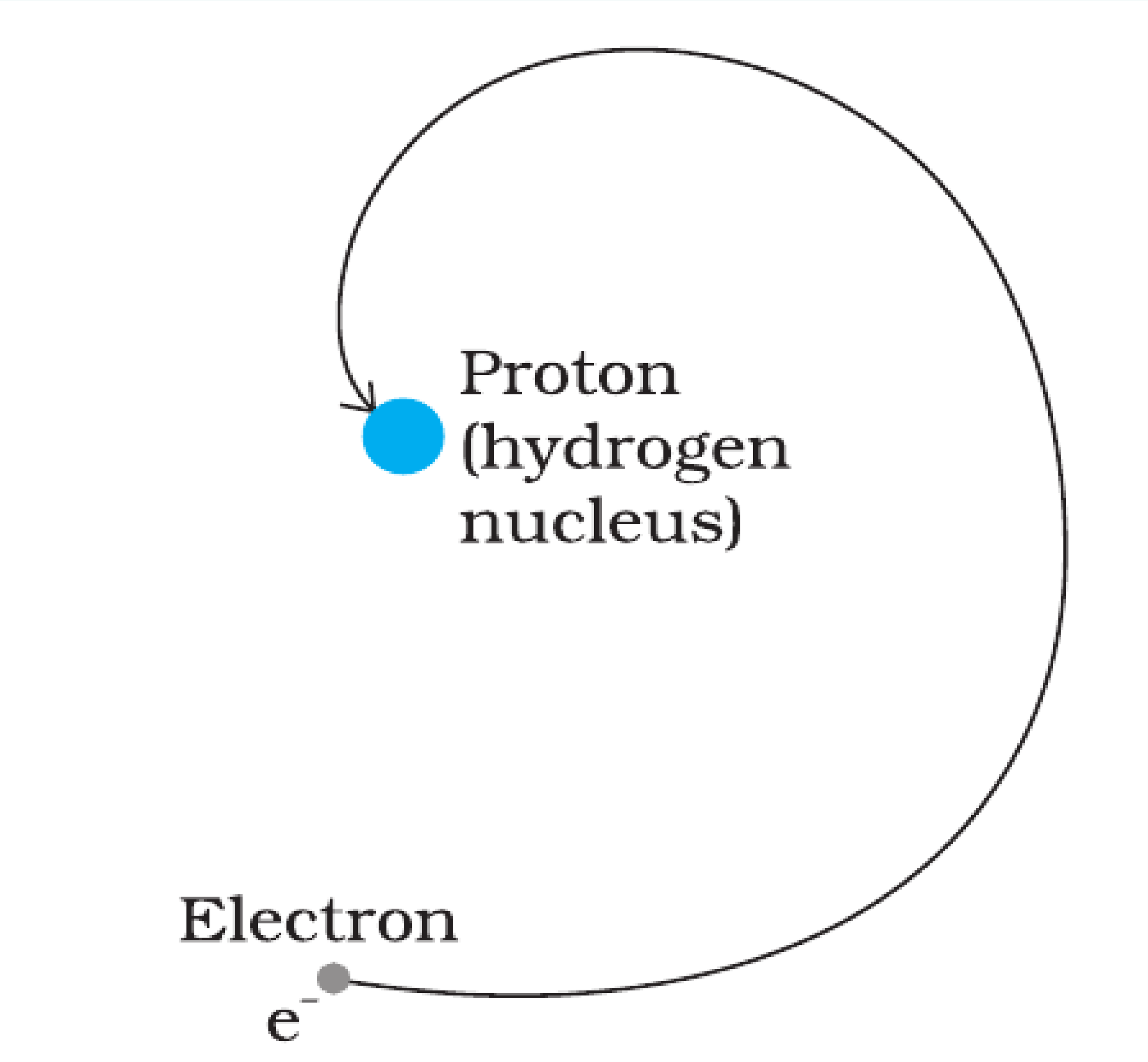

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- The **frequency of the electromagnetic wave**s emitted by the revolving electrons is **equal to the frequency of revolution**.

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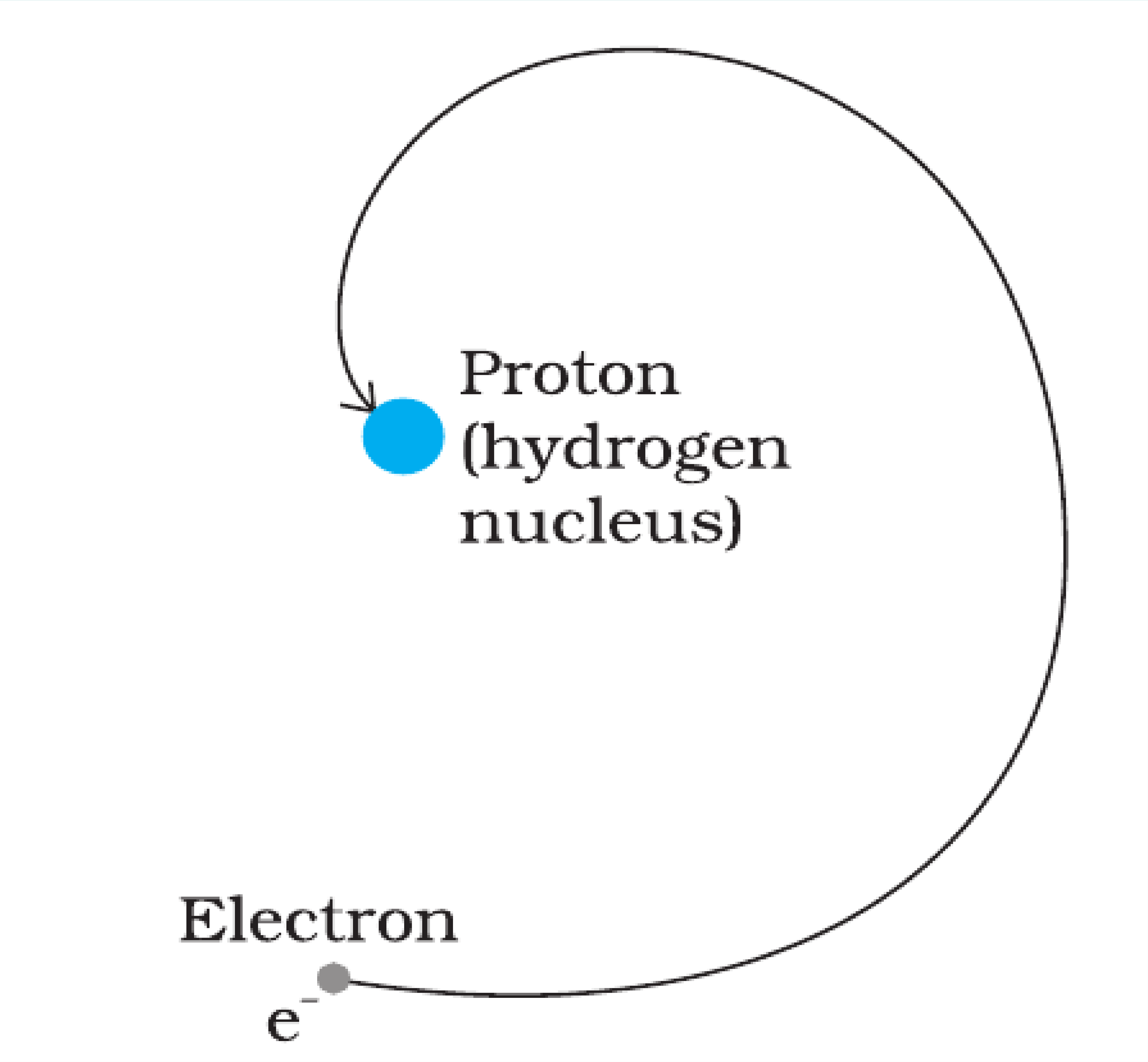

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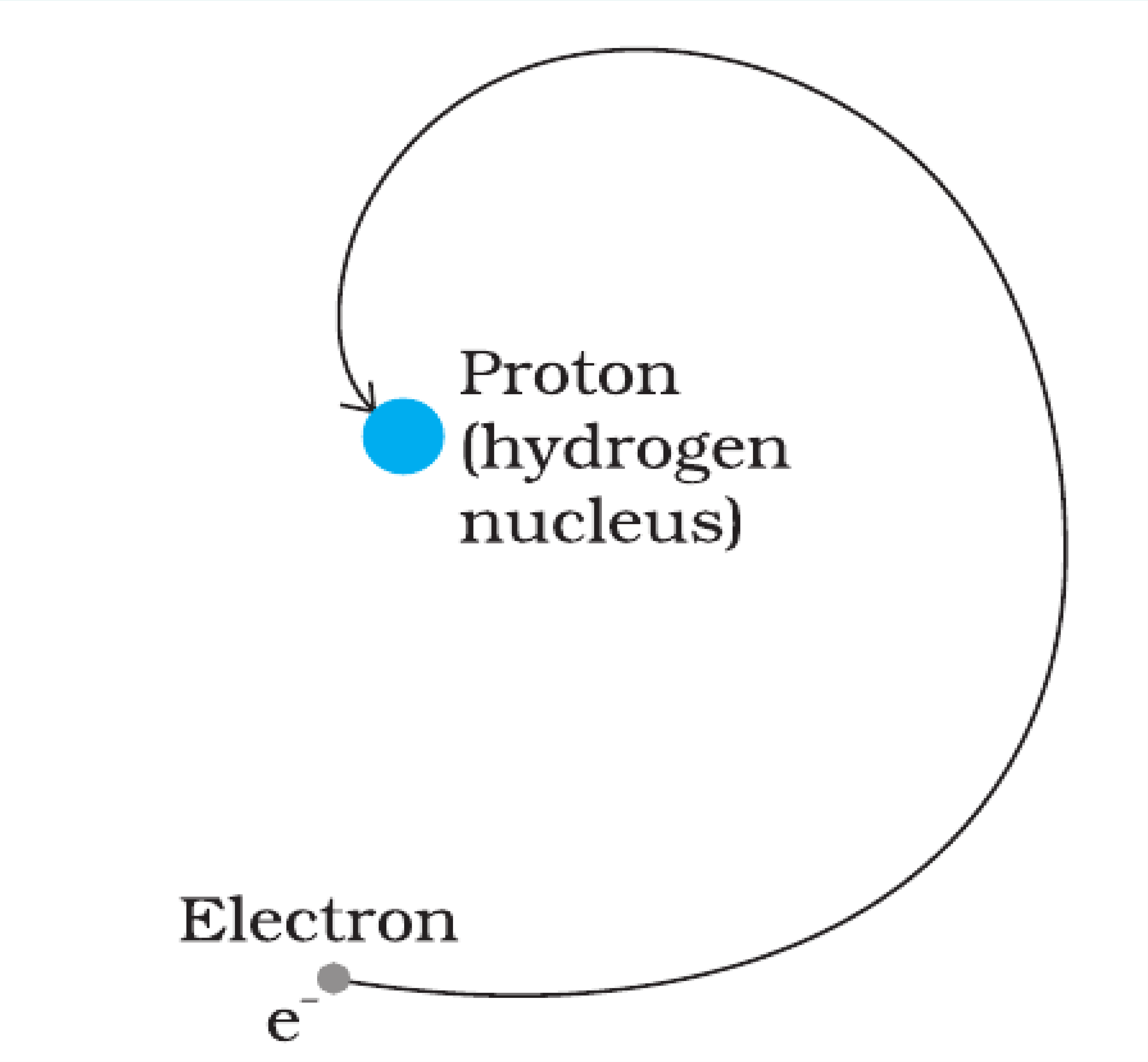

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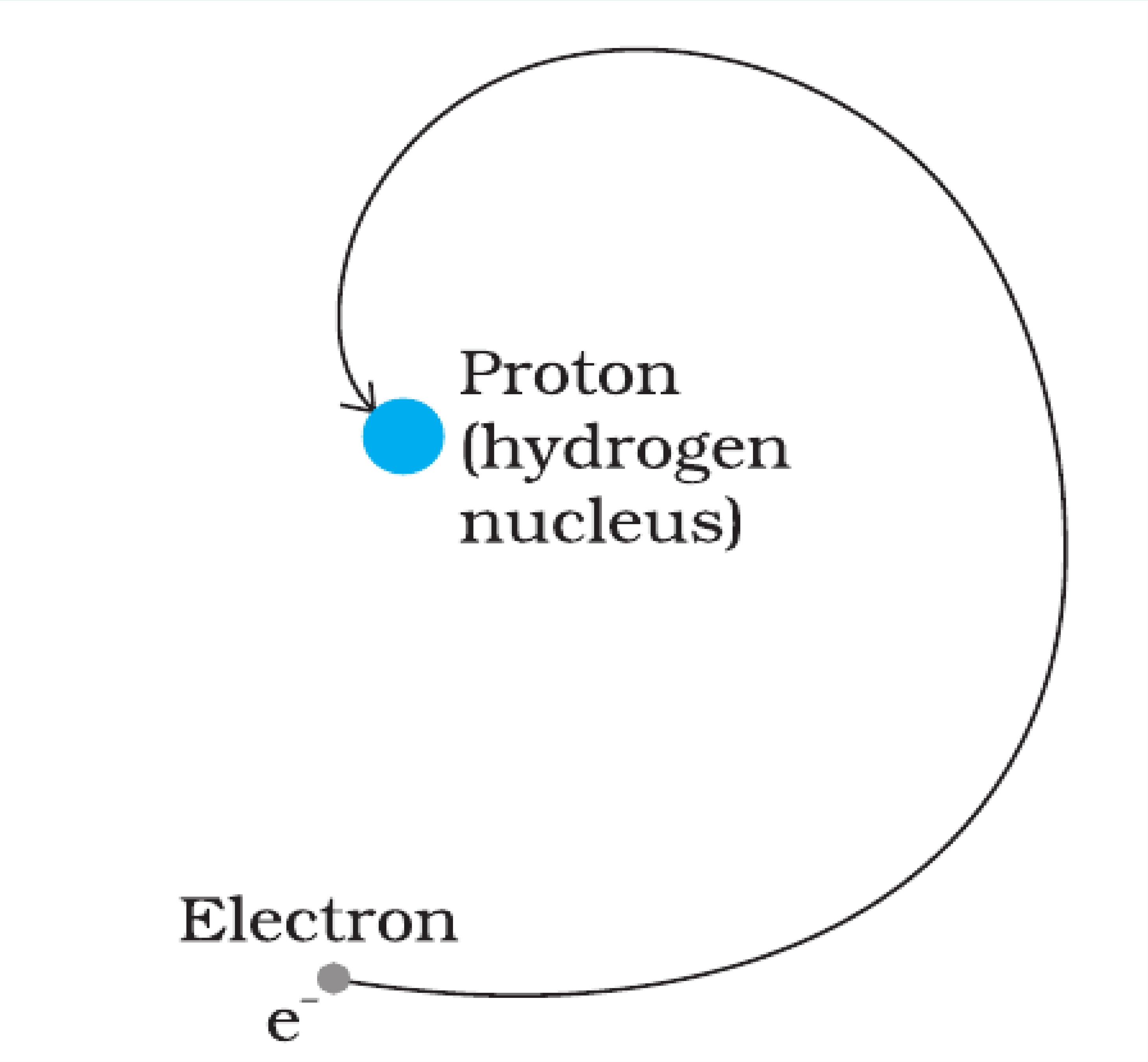

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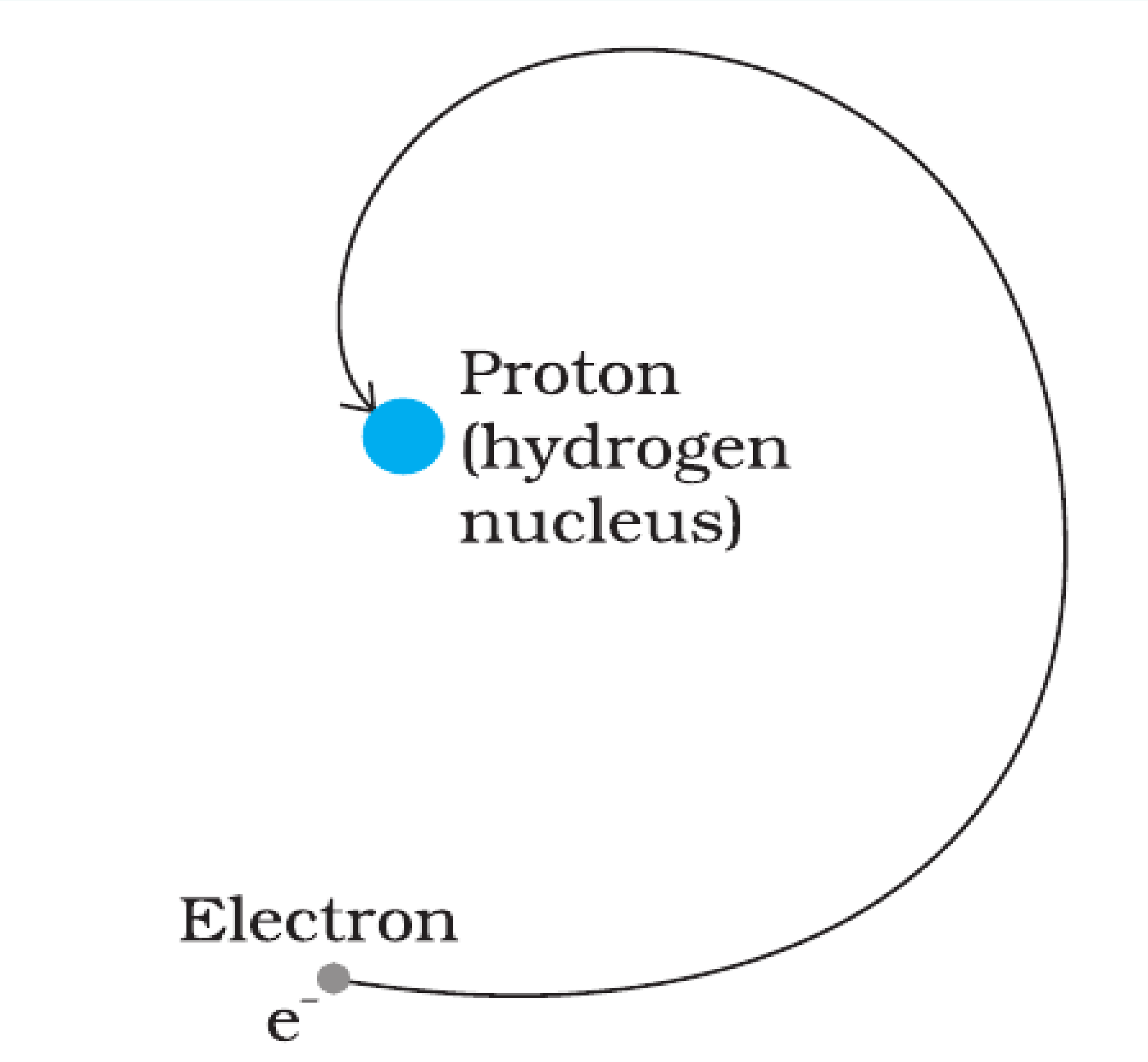

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- Therefore, the **frequency** of the **emitted light** would **also change continuously**.
- This means the atom should emit a **continuous spectrum**.
- But in reality, experiments show a **line spectrum** of discrete frequencies.

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Solution From Example 12.3 we know that velocity of electron moving around a proton in hydrogen atom in an orbit of radius 5.3×10^{-11} m is 2.2×10^{-6} m/s. Thus, the frequency of the electron moving around the proton is

$$\nu = \frac{v}{2\pi r} = \frac{2.2 \times 10^{6}\ \mathrm{m\ s^{-1}}}{2\pi\left(5.3 \times 10^{-11}\ \mathrm{m}\right)}$$

$$\approx 6.6 \times 10^{15}\ \mathrm{Hz}.$$

According to the classical electromagnetic theory we know that the frequency of the electromagnetic waves emitted by the revolving electrons is equal to the frequency of its revolution around the nucleus. Thus the initial frequency of the light emitted is 6.6×10^{15} Hz.

BOHR'S POSTULATES

1. **Stationary Orbits:** Electrons revolve in certain **permitted circular orbits** around the nucleus **without** the **emission of energy**. These orbits are called **stationary states** or **non-radiating orbits**. While moving in such an orbit, the electron does not radiate energy in spite of being in accelerated motion.

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2. **Quantisation of Angular Momentum:** Only those orbits are permitted for which the angular momentum of the electron is an integral multiple of $\frac{h}{2\pi}$:

$$\boldsymbol{L = mvr = n\frac{h}{2\pi}}, \quad n = 1, 2, 3, \ldots$$

Here, n is called the **principal quantum number**.

BOHR'S POSTULATES

3. **Emission and Absorption of Radiation:** When an electron **jumps from a higher orbit (n_i)** to a **lower orbit (n_f)**, energy is emitted in the form of a **photon** of **frequency** ν:

$$h\nu = E_{n_i} - E_{n_f}$$

Similarly, when the electron jumps from a lower to a higher orbit, it absorbs a photon of exactly this energy.

Derivation for Radius of nth Orbit Of Hydrogen like Atoms:

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$$\boxed{r_n = \frac{n^2}{Z}\frac{h^2\epsilon_0}{\pi m e^2}} \quad .....(3)$$

$$\boxed{r_n = \frac{n^2}{Z}a_0} \quad .....(4) \quad \text{Here, } a_0 = \frac{h^2\epsilon_0}{\pi m e^2} = 0.529 \text{ Å (Bohr's Radius)}$$

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- Substituting value of r_n from eq(3) to eq(2), we have,

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- For an electron revolving in an orbit of radius r_n with velocity v_n.
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Important Results/Formulas for H-Atom (Z=1)

- Radius of nth orbit : $\boxed{r_n = n^2 a_0}$ where, $a_0 = 0.529$ Å

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Example 12.5 A 10 kg satellite circles earth once every 2 h in an orbit having a radius of 8000 km. Assuming that Bohr's angular momentum postulate applies to satellites just as it does to an electron in the hydrogen atom, find the quantum number of the orbit of the satellite.

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Solution

From Eq. (12.13), we have

$m\,v_n r_n = nh/2\pi$

Here m = 10 kg and $r_n = 8 \times 10^6$ m. We have the time period T of the circling satellite as 2 h. That is T = 7200 s.

Thus the velocity $v_n = 2\pi\, r_n/T$.

The quantum number of the orbit of satellite

$n = (2\pi\, r_n)^2 \times m/(T \times h)$.

Substituting the values,

$n = (2\pi \times 8 \times 10^6 \text{ m})^2 \times 10/(7200 \text{ s} \times 6.64 \times 10^{-34} \text{ J s})$

$= 5.3 \times 10^{45}$

Note that the quantum number for the satellite motion is extremely large! In fact for such large quantum numbers the results of quantisation conditions tend to those of classical physics.

ENERGY LEVELS (Ground State)

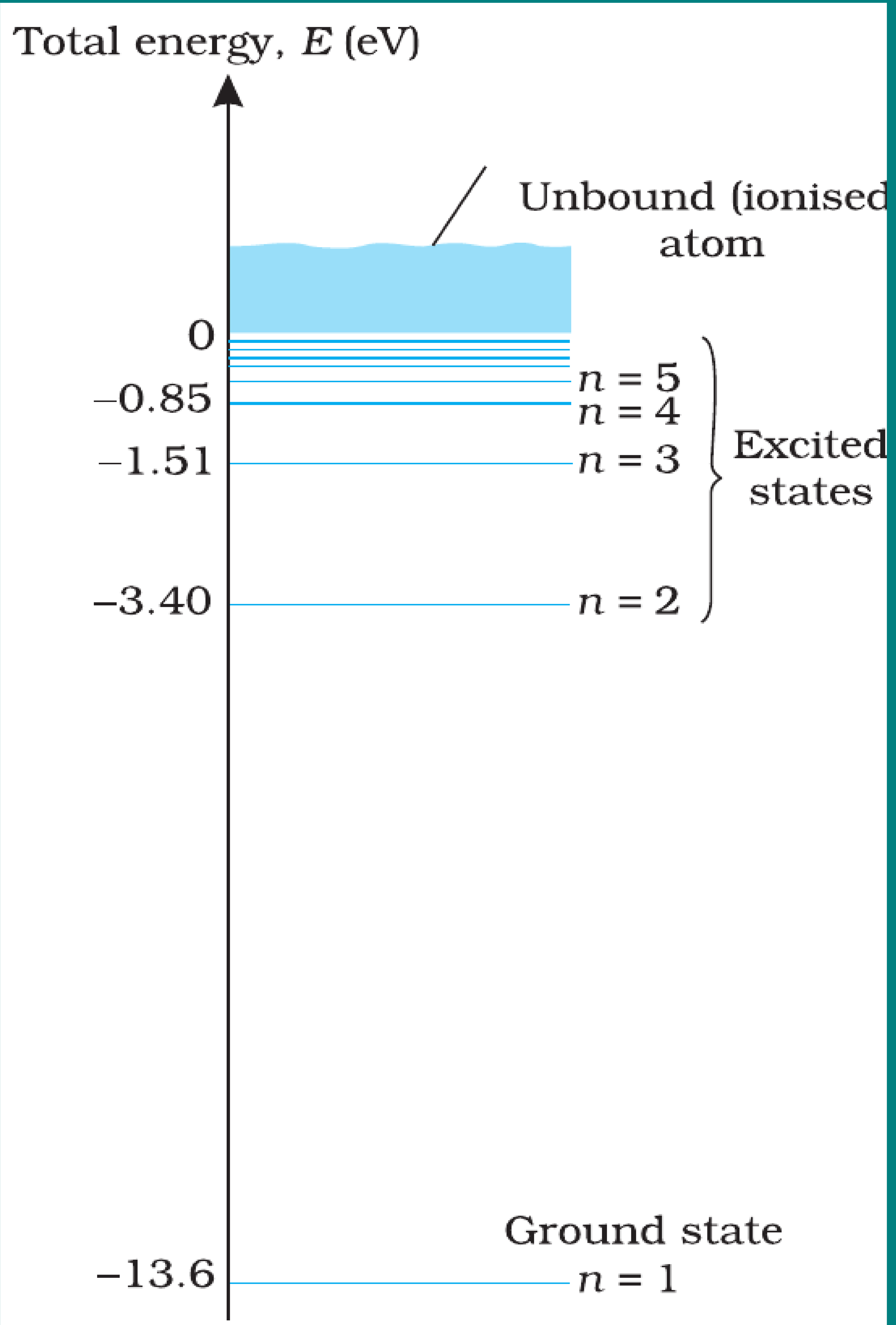

FIGURE 12.8 The energy level diagram for the hydrogen atom.

Ground State

- The energy of an atom is **least (largest negative value)** when its electron is in the orbit closest to the nucleus ($n = 1$).

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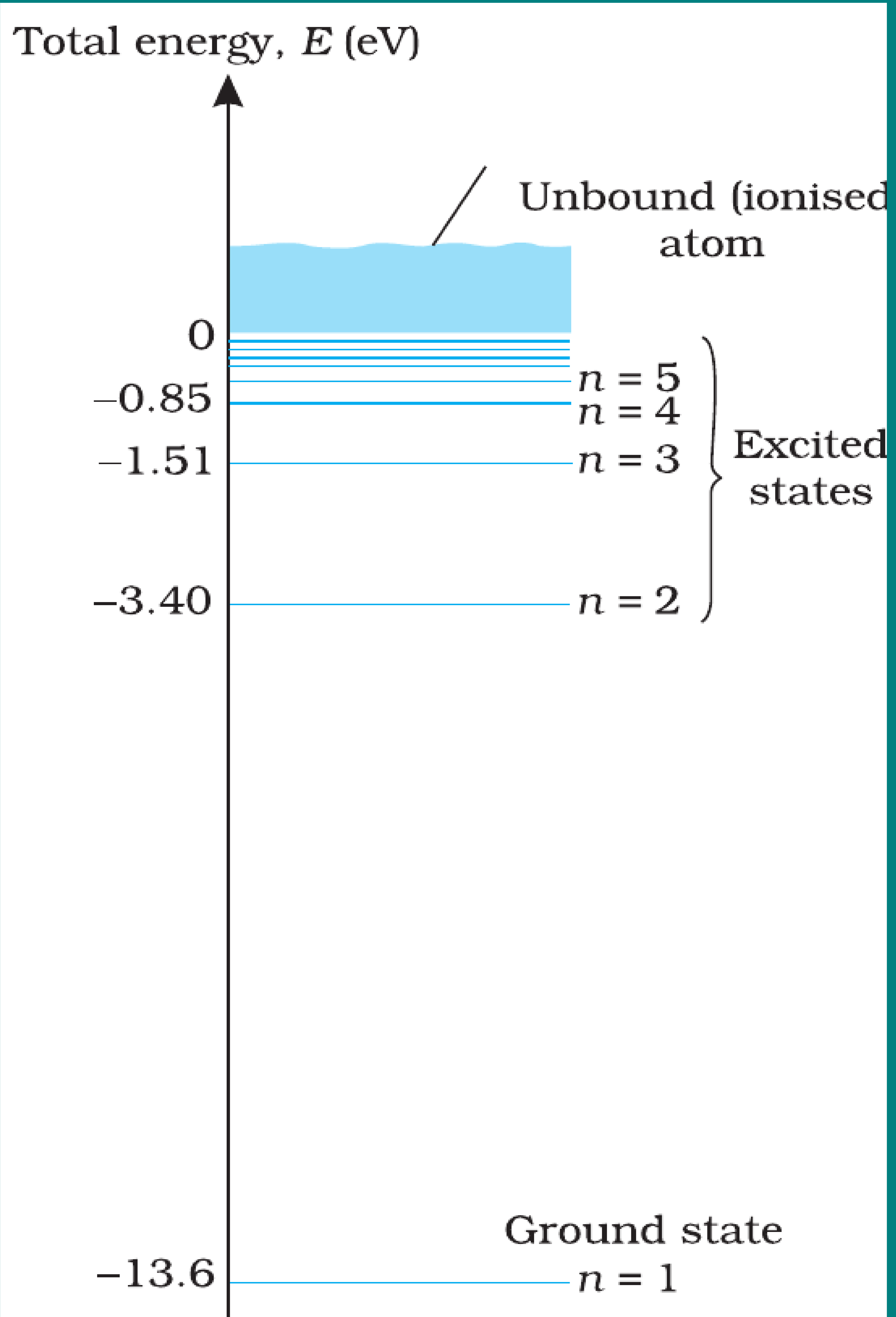

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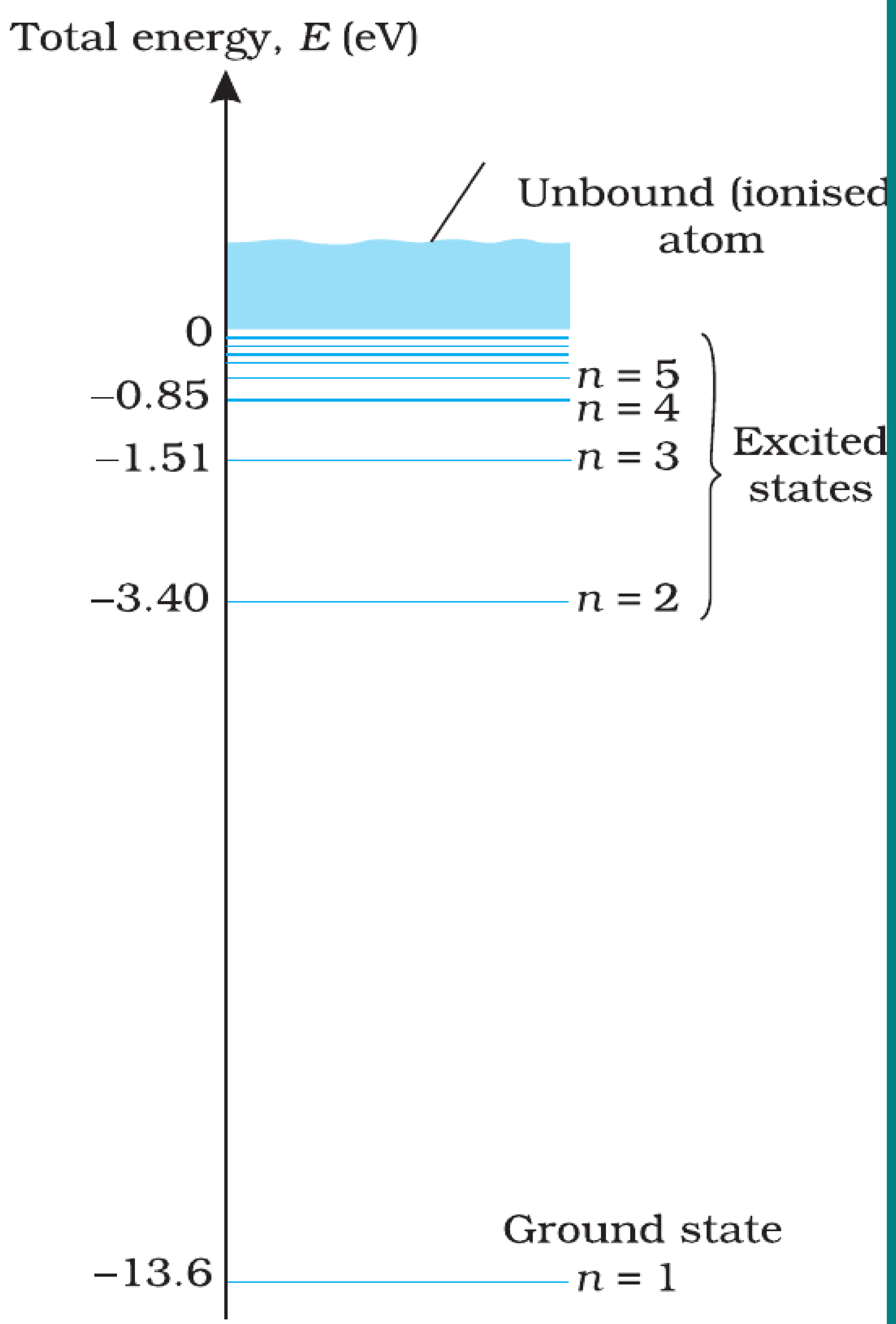

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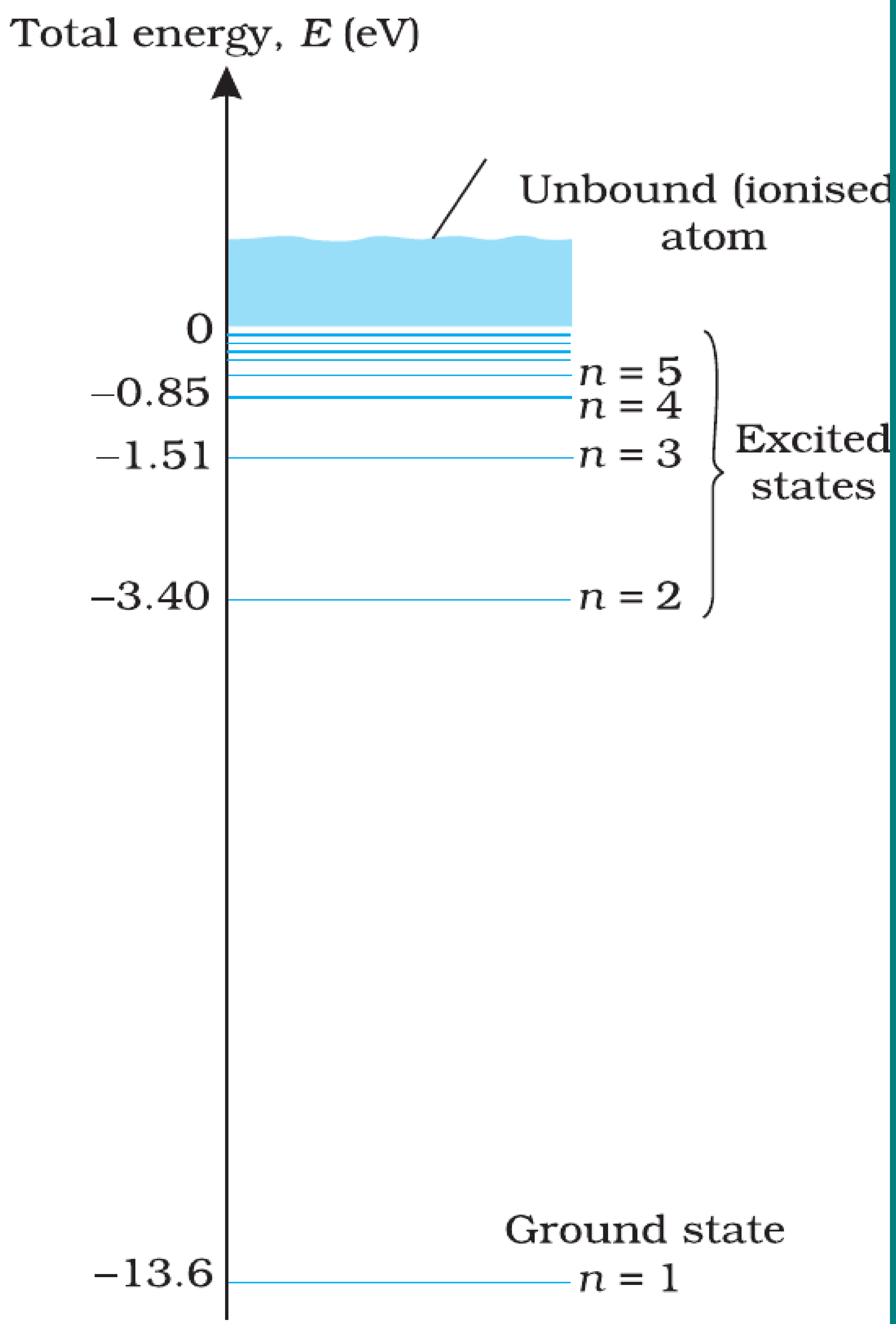

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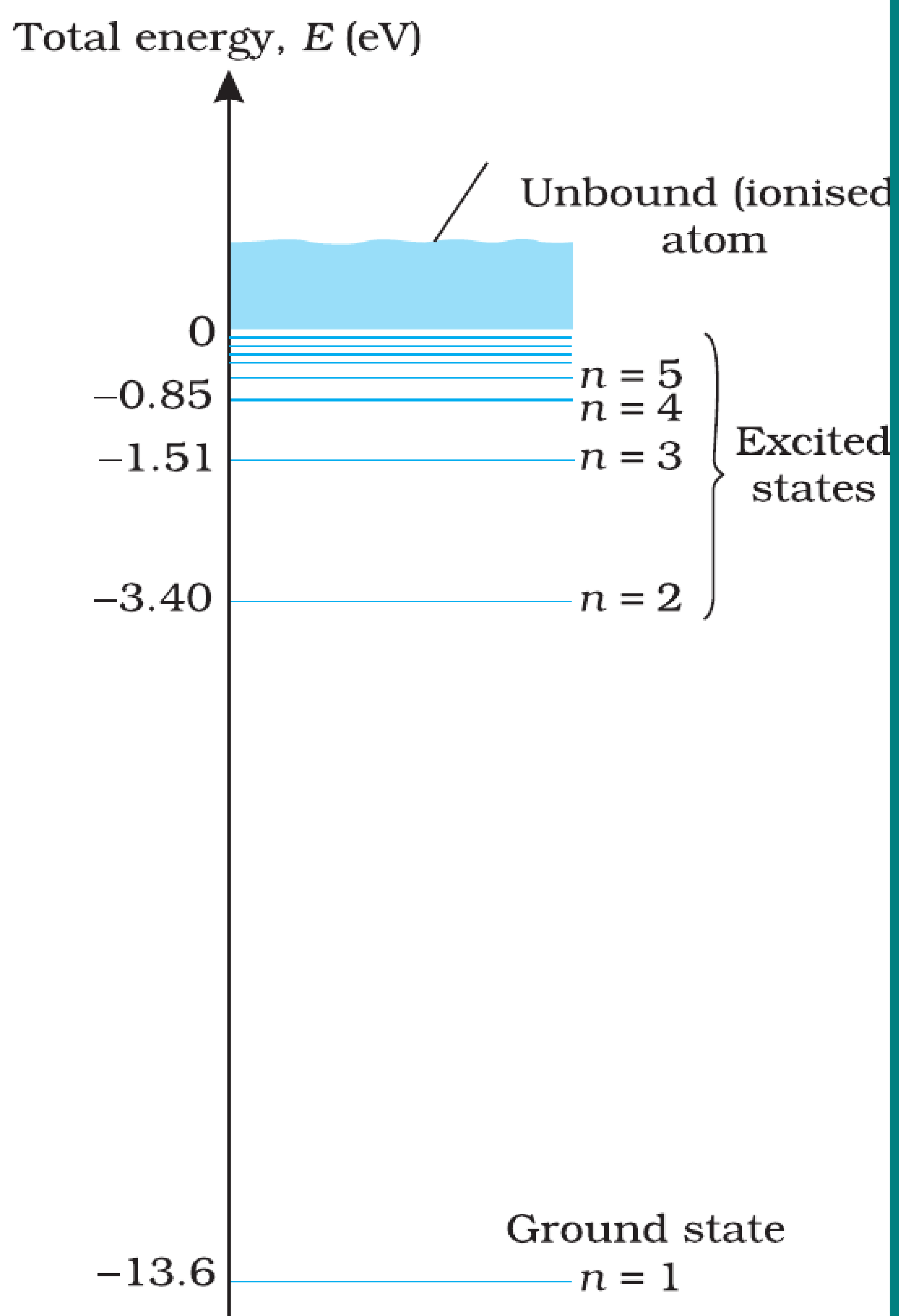

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- To free the electron from this state, the minimum energy required is $\mathbf{13.6}\,\text{eV}$ called the **ionisation energy of hydrogen**.

ENERGY LEVELS (Excited States)

Excited States

- For $n = 2$:

$$E_2 = -3.40\,\text{eV}, \quad \Delta E = E_2 - E_1 = 10.2\,\text{eV}$$

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This is the energy required to excite the atom to its second excited state.
- In general, higher n means **less negative energy** (electron is less tightly bound).

ENERGY LEVELS (Ionisation and Excitation)

Important Points

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- At $n \to \infty$, $E = 0$ eV: electron is **completely free** $\Rightarrow$ ionisation limit.

ENERGY LEVEL DIAGRAM

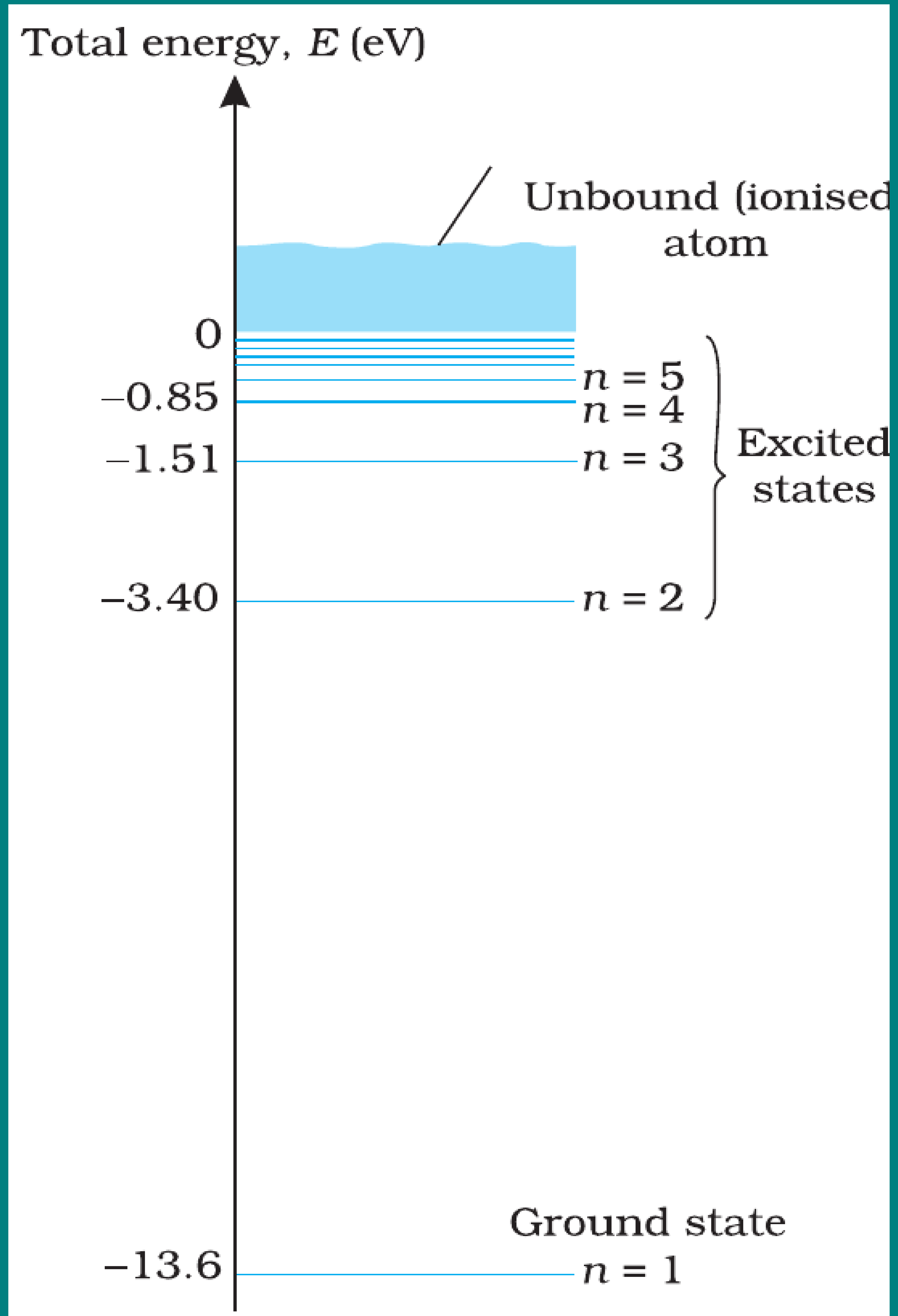

FIGURE 12.8 The energy level diagram for the hydrogen atom.

Features

- Horizontal lines represent **allowed stationary states**.

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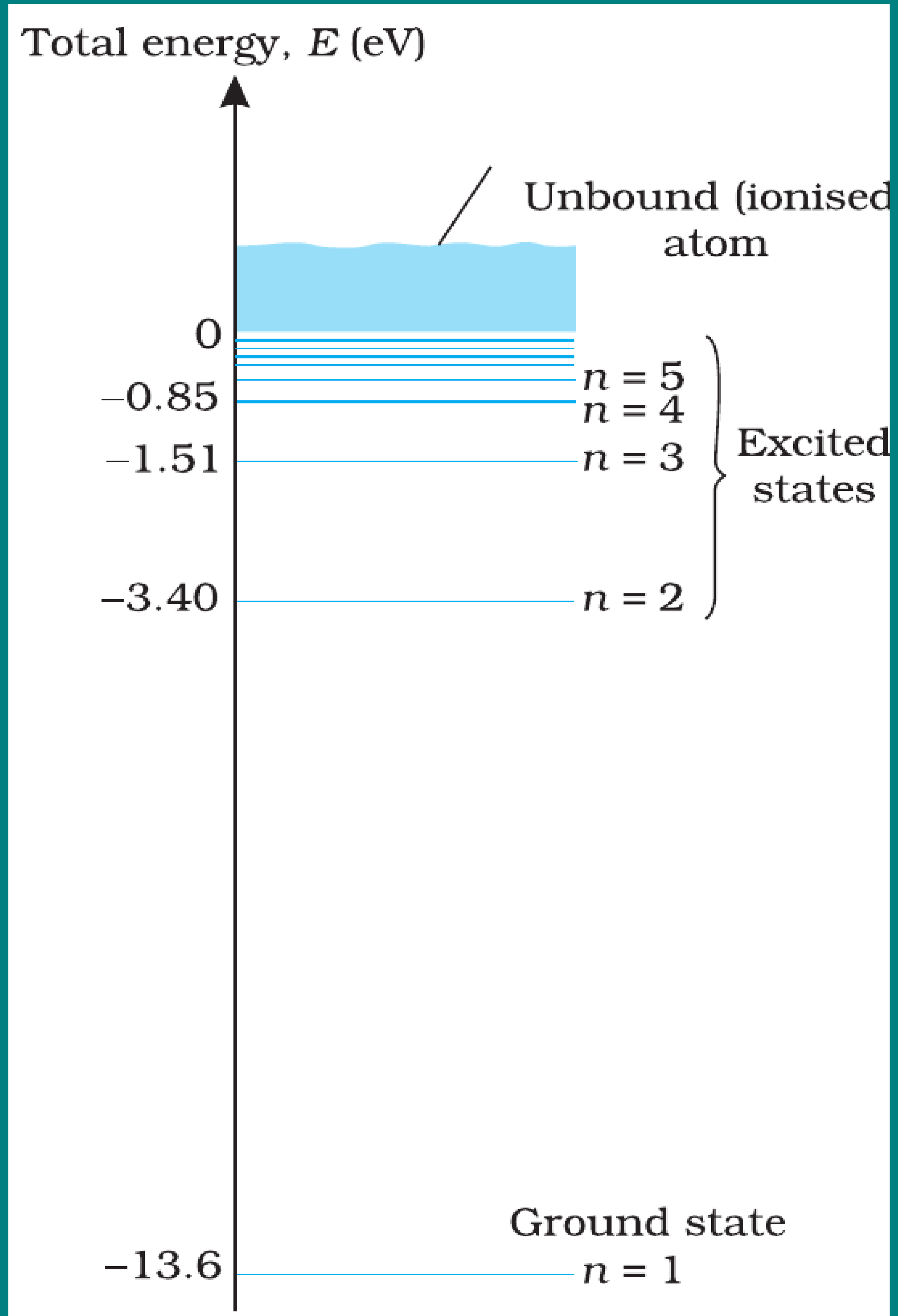

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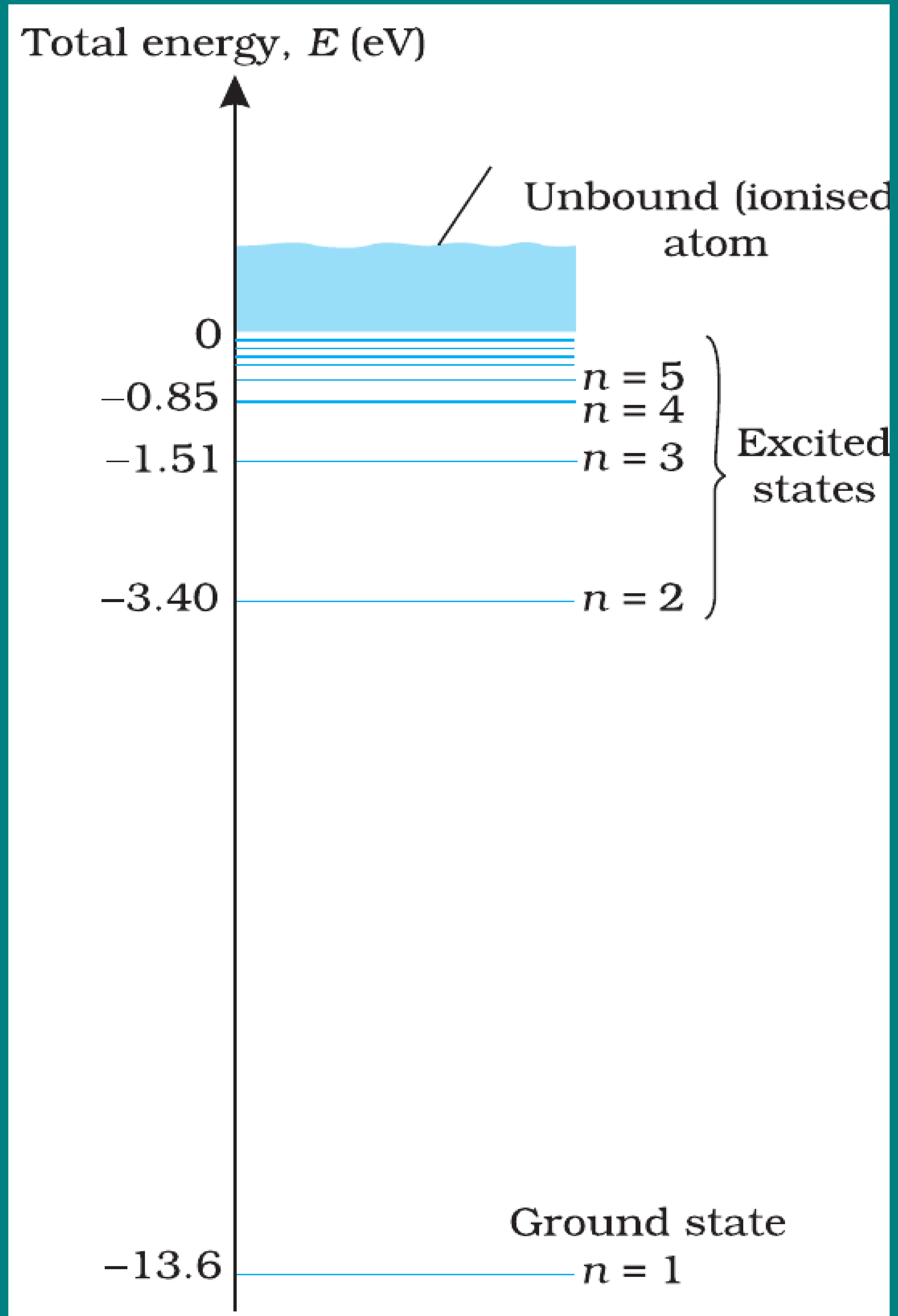

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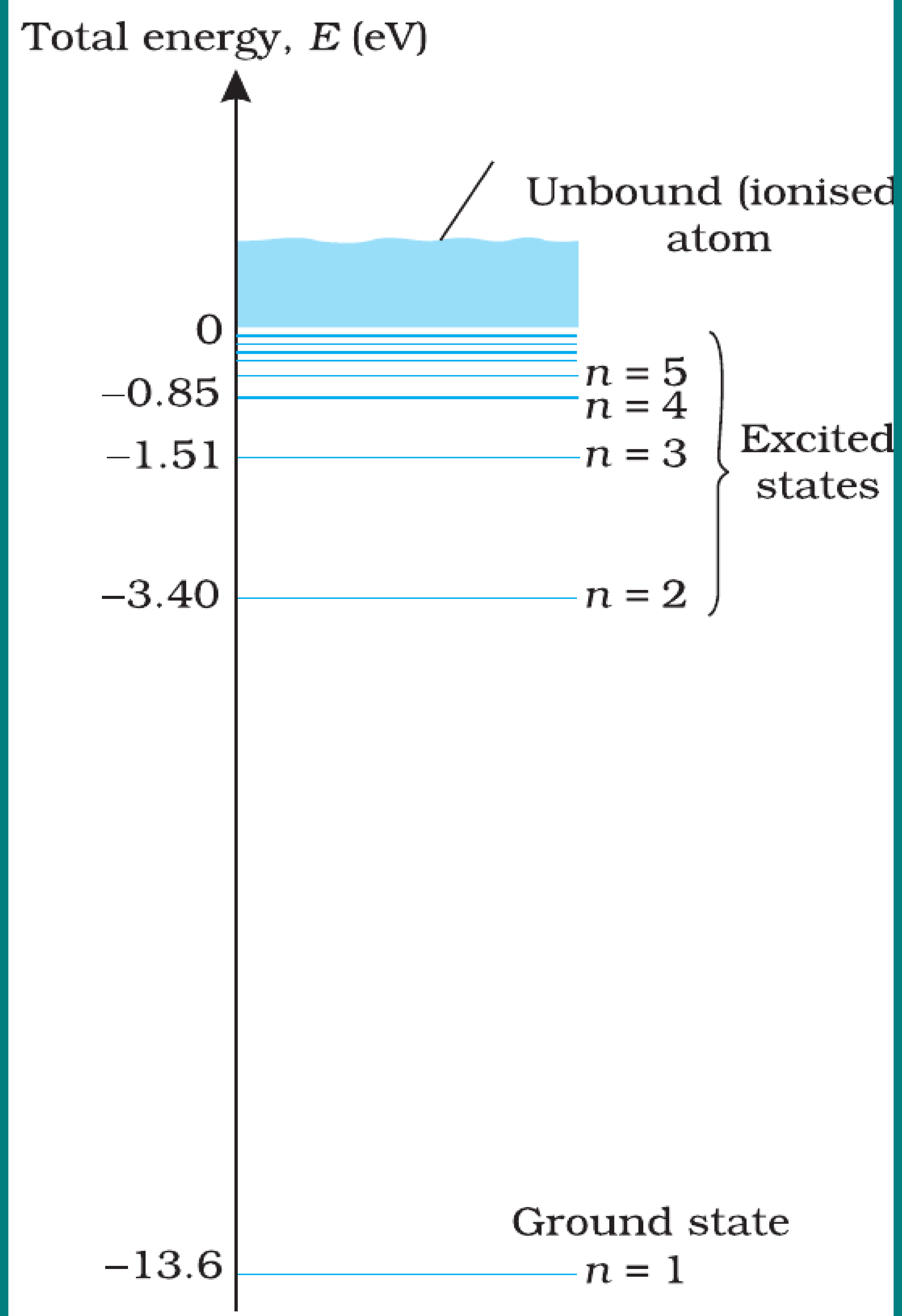

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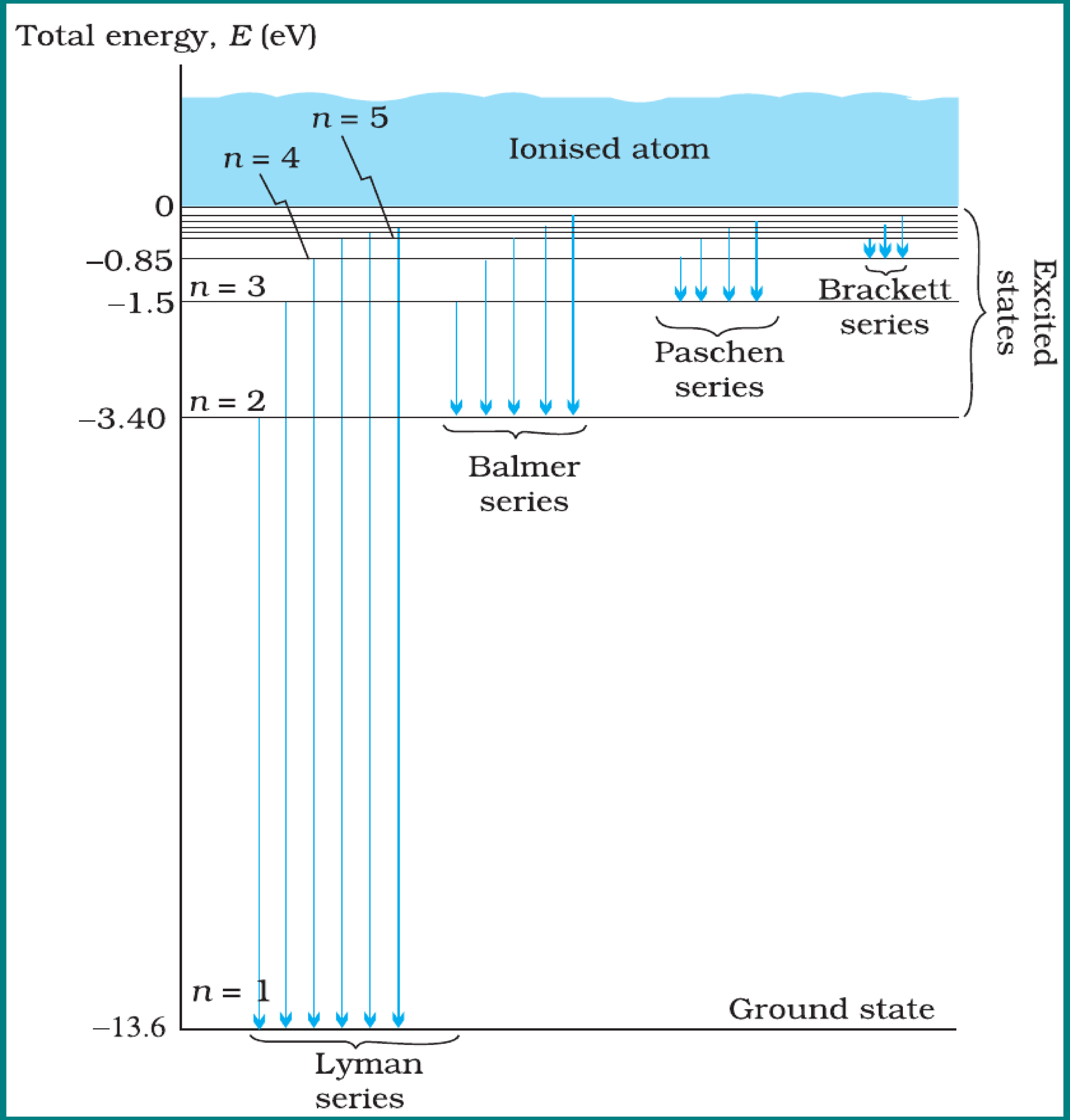
- Explains discrete line spectra of hydrogen.

THE LINE SPECTRA OF HYDROGEN ATOM



Introduction

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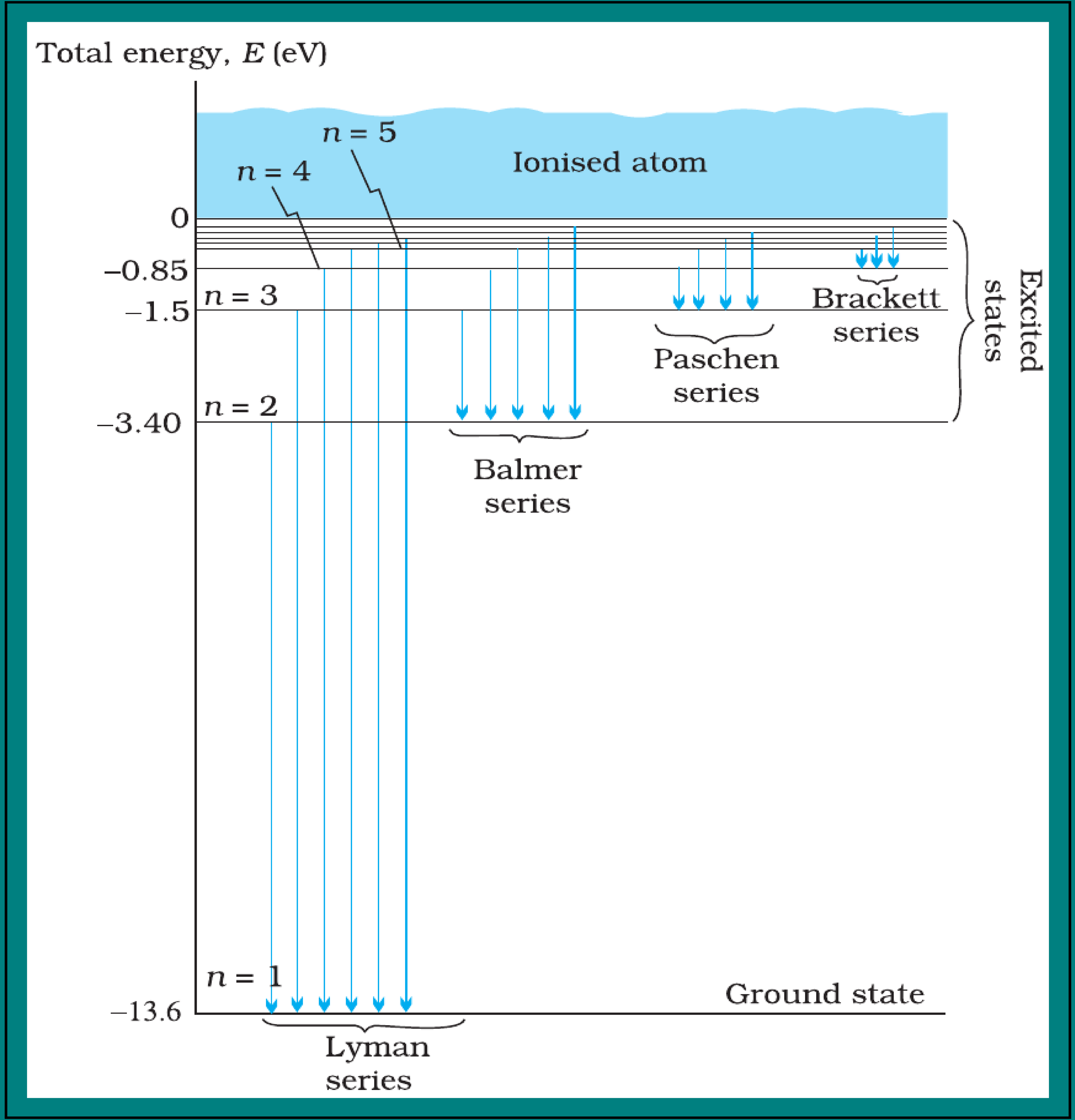

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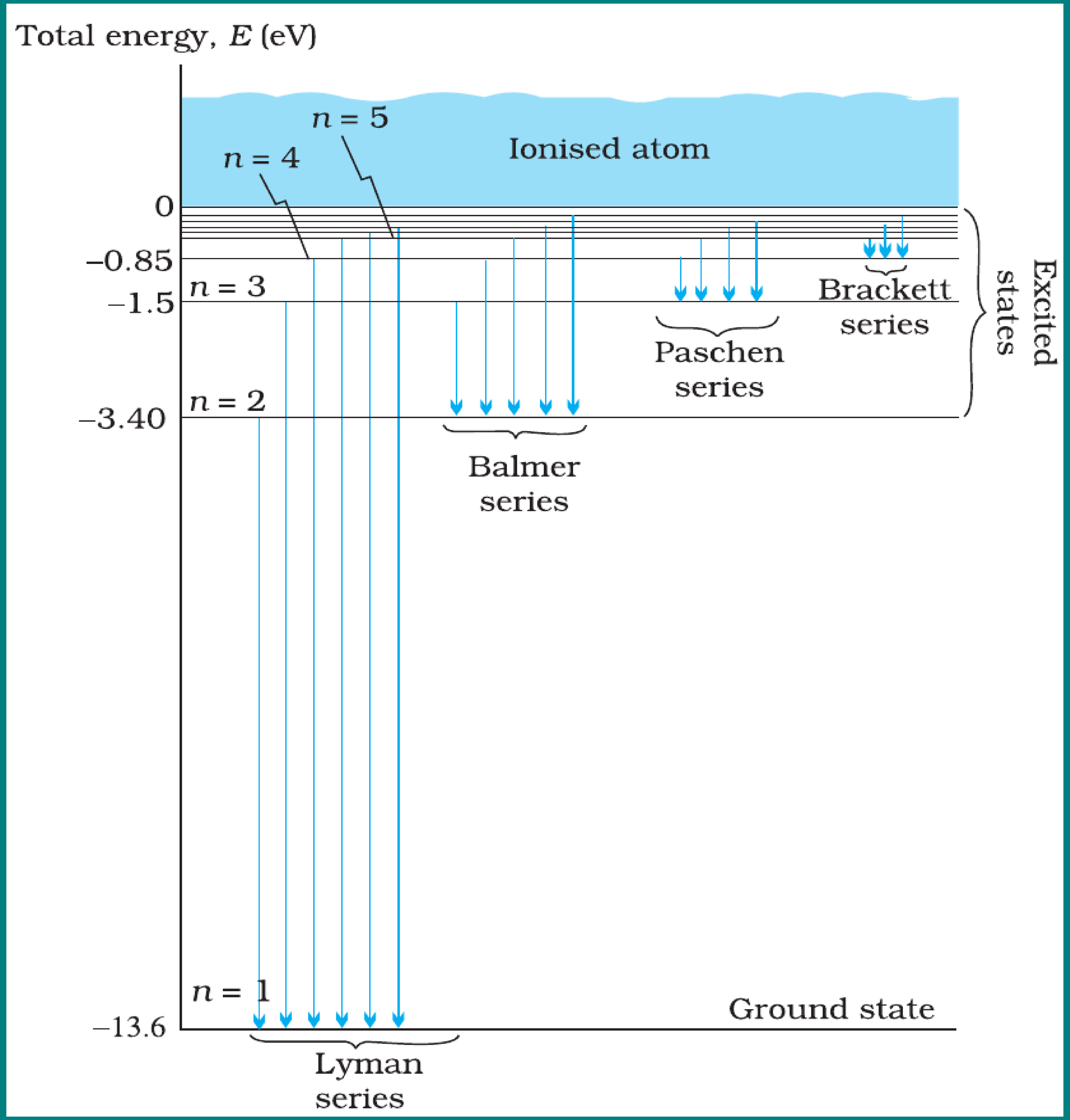

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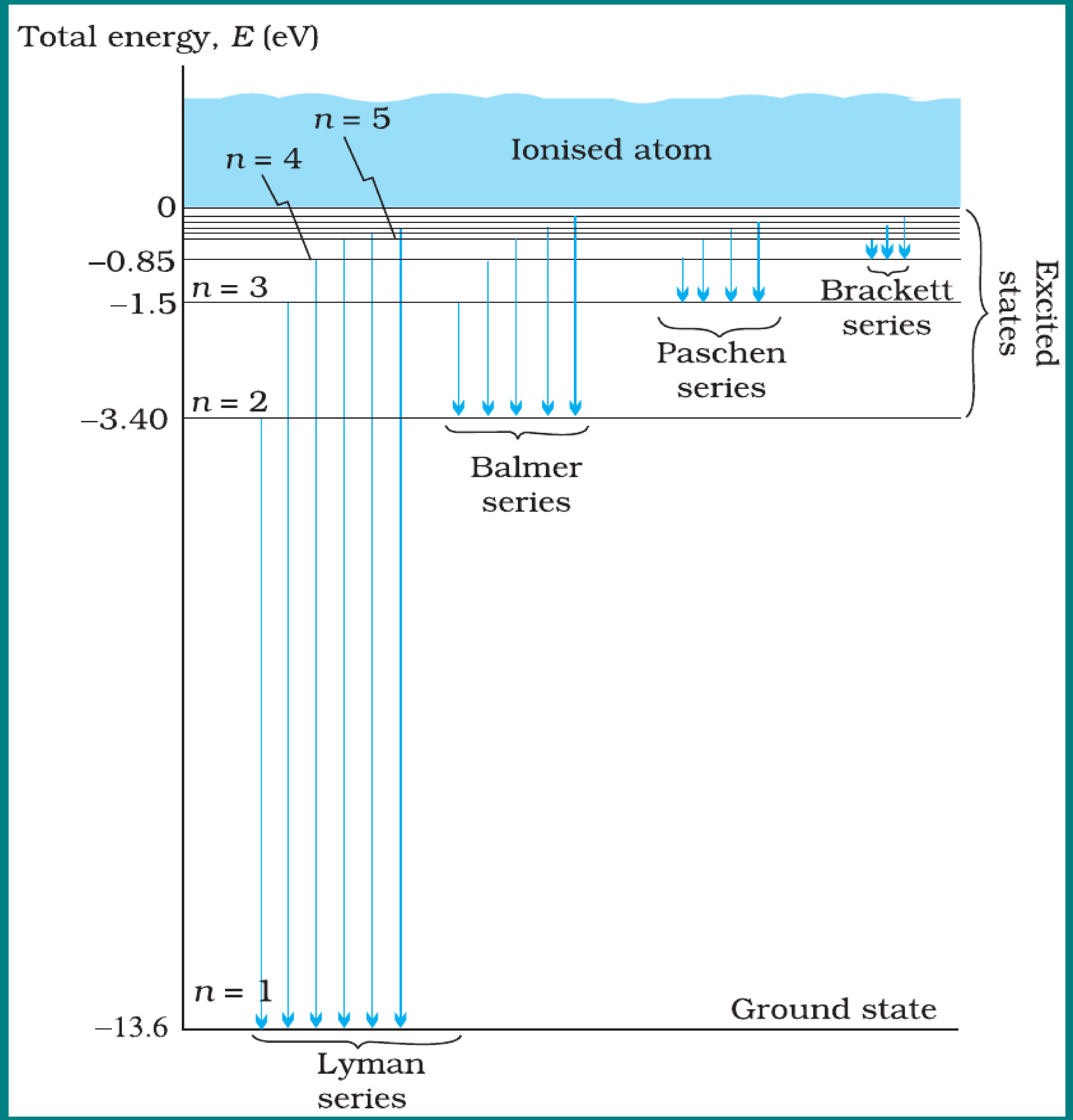

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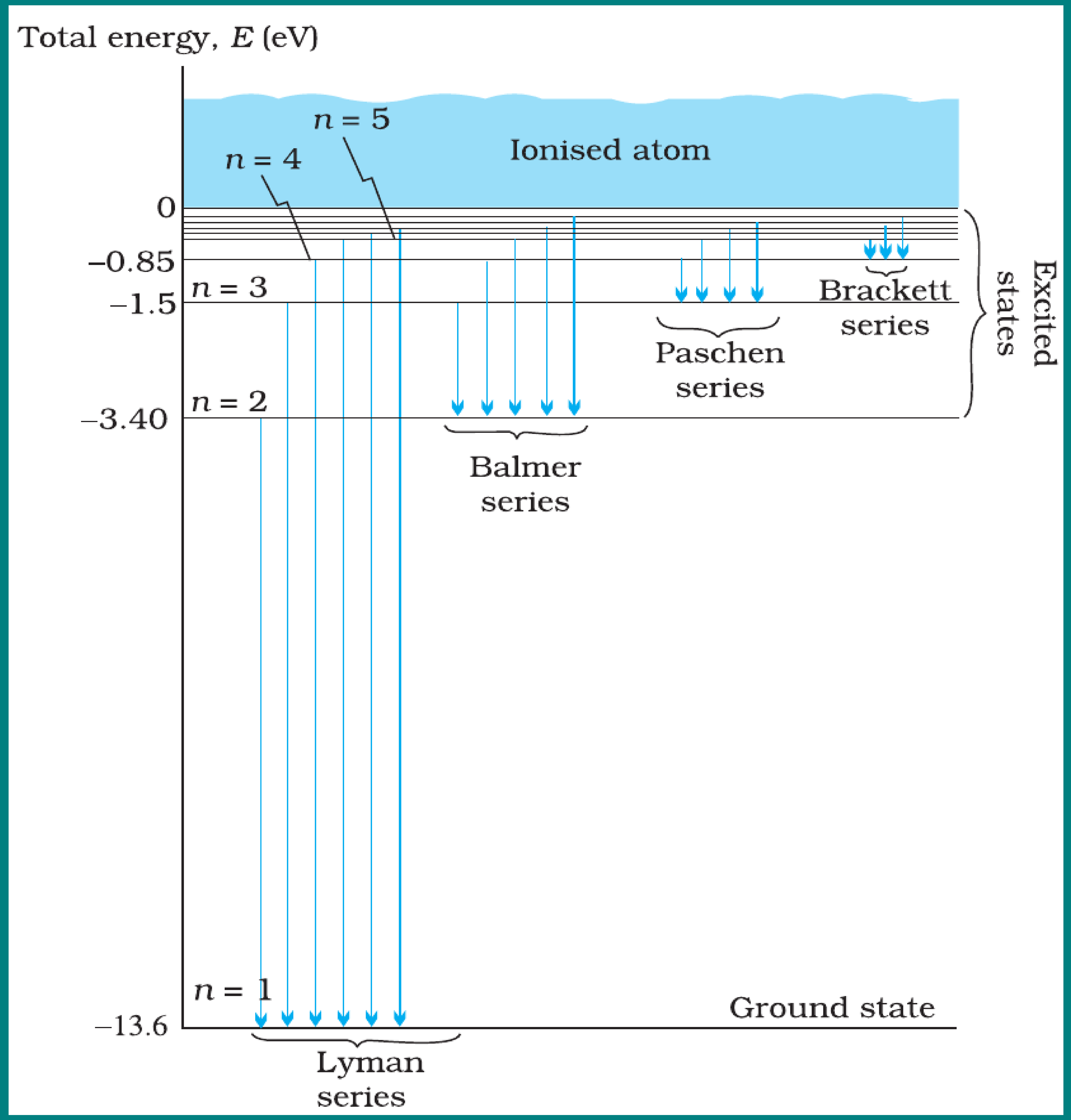
- The frequency (or wavelength) of emitted/absorbed radiation is given by Bohr's frequency condition.

Hydrogen Spectral Series



Spectral Series

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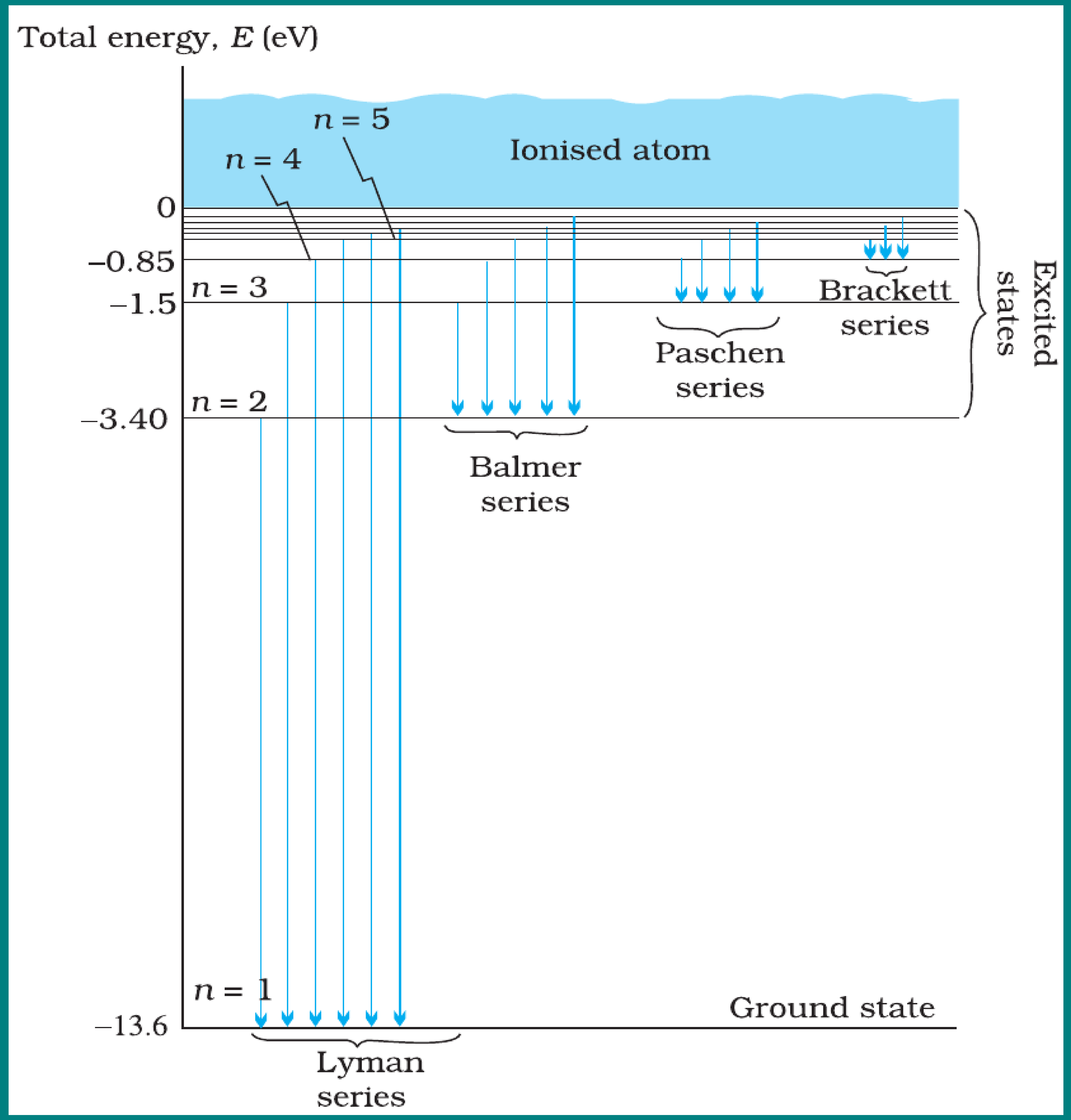

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$$\frac{\mathbf{1}}{\lambda} = \mathbf{R_H}\left(\frac{\mathbf{1}}{\mathbf{n_f^2}} - \frac{\mathbf{1}}{\mathbf{n_i^2}}\right)$$

where $R_H = 1.097 \times 10^7\ \mathrm{m}^{-1}$ is the Rydberg constant.

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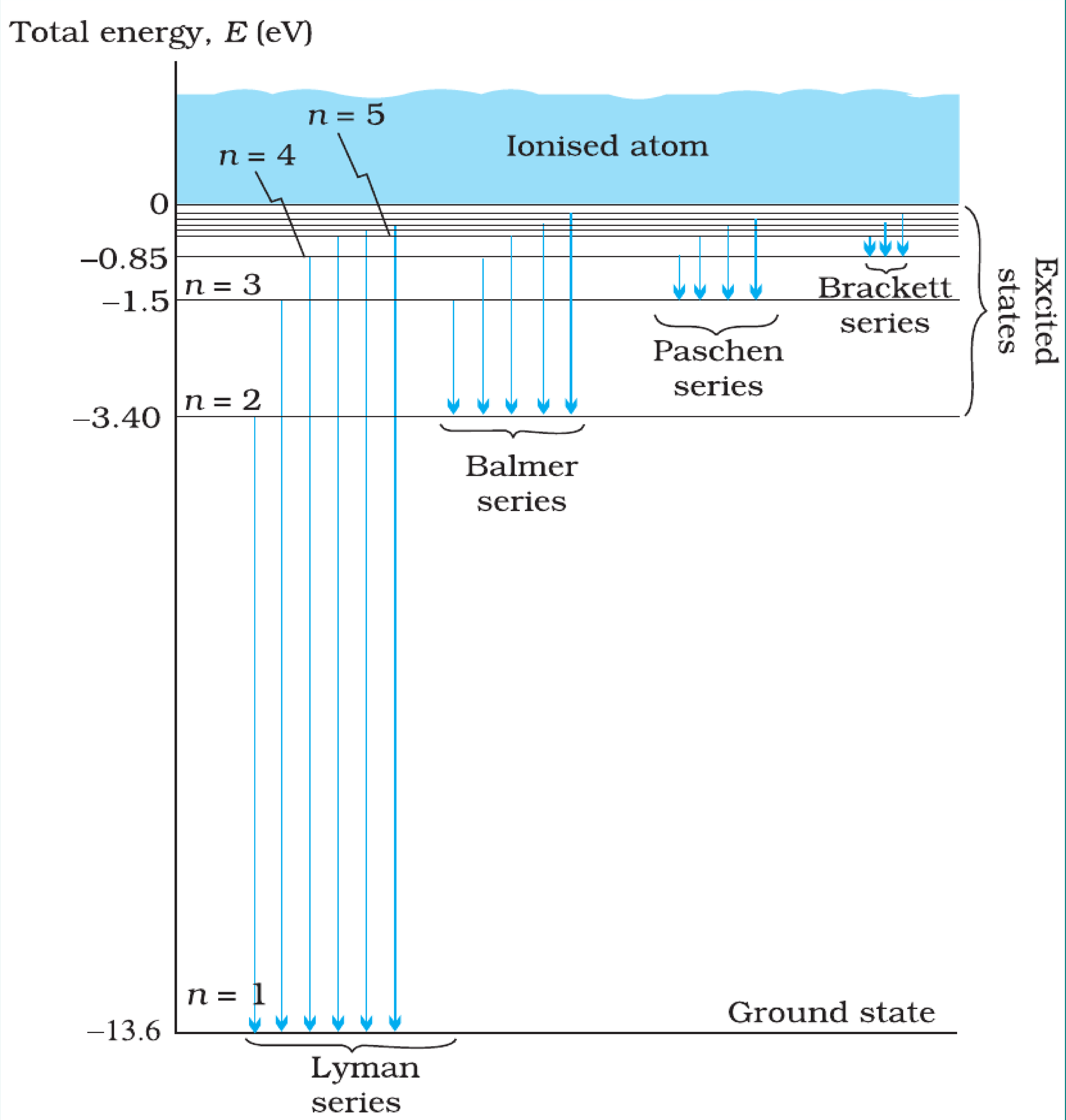

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- This is called the **Rydberg formula**.

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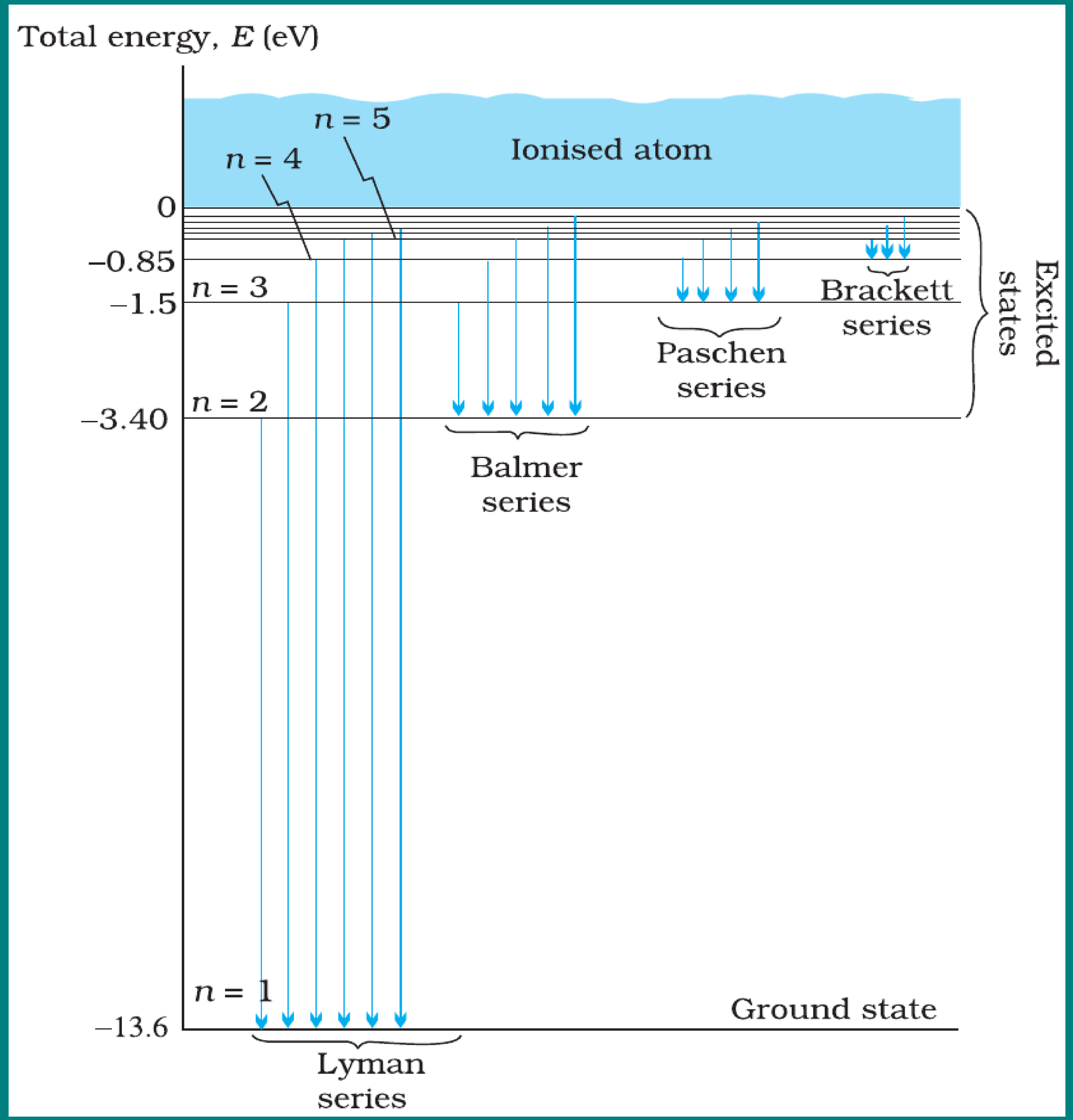

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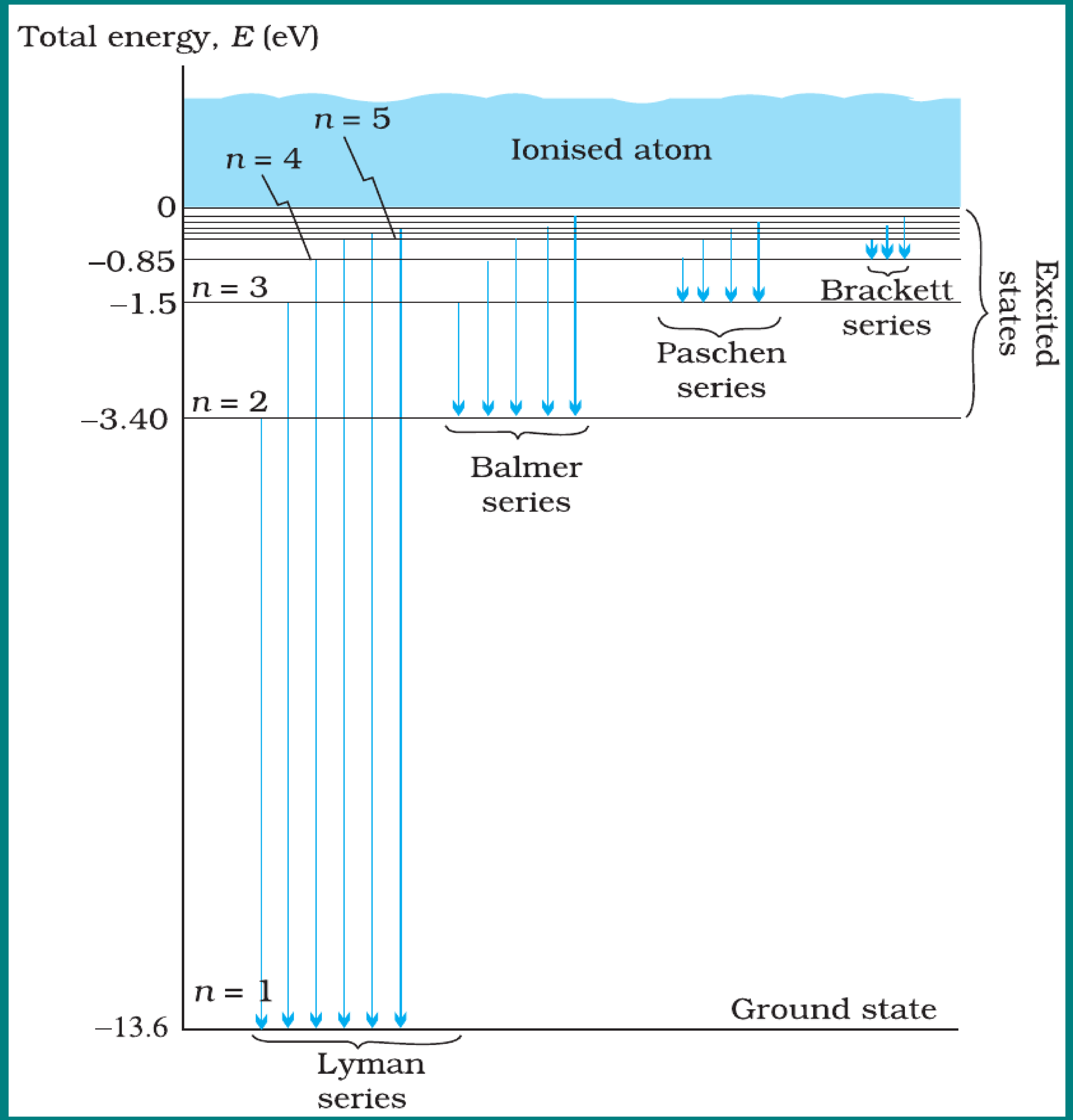

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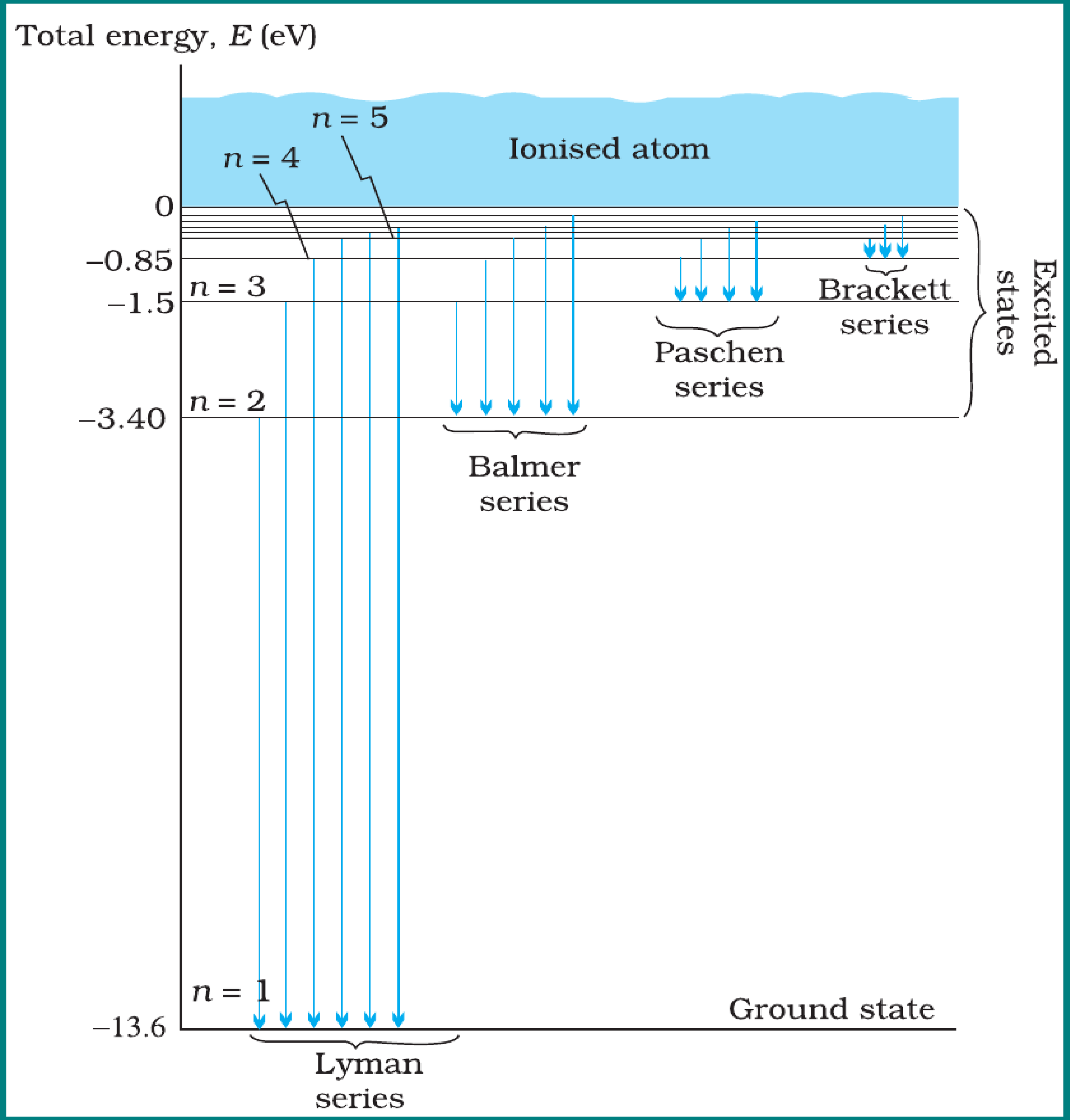

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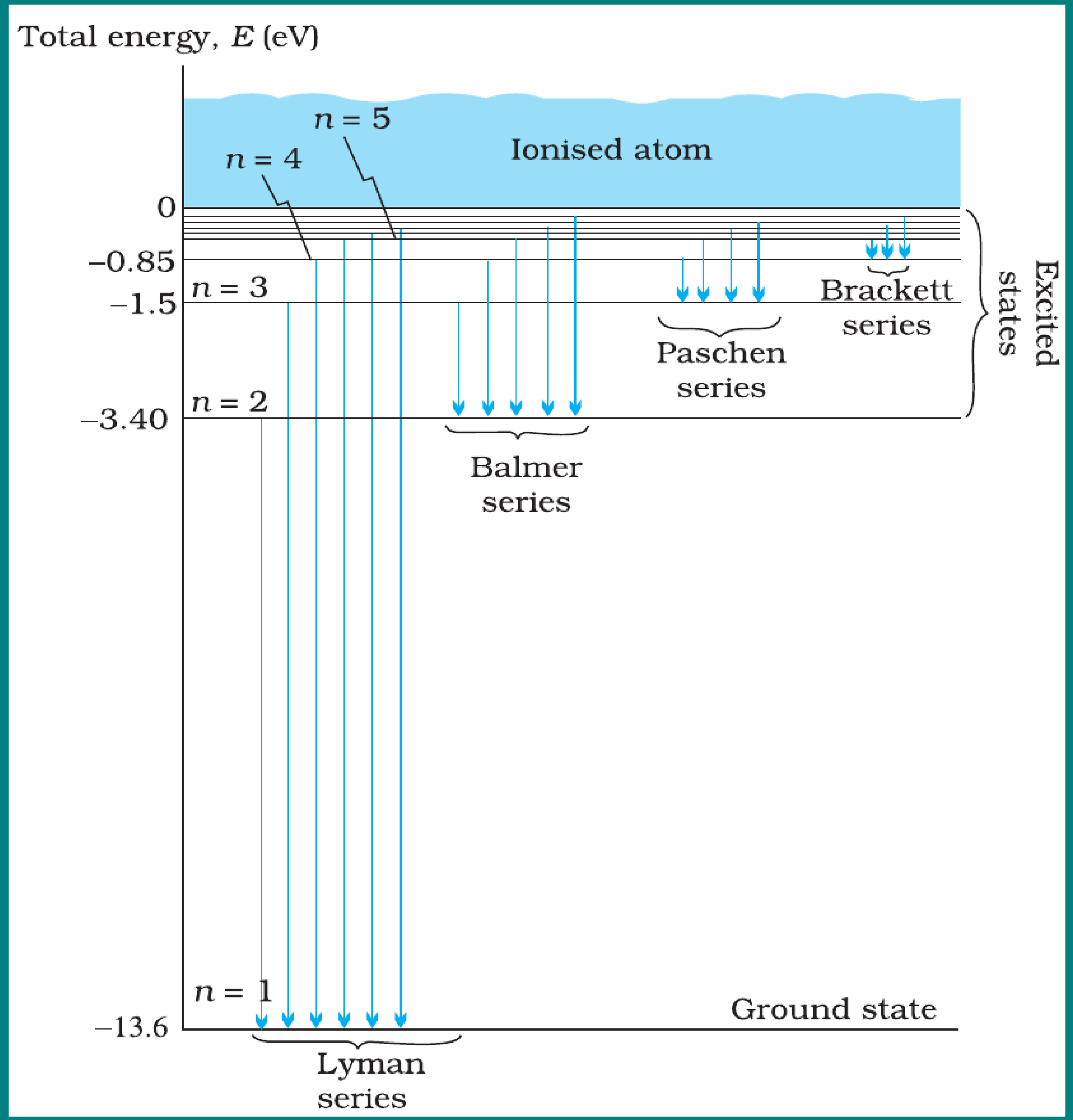

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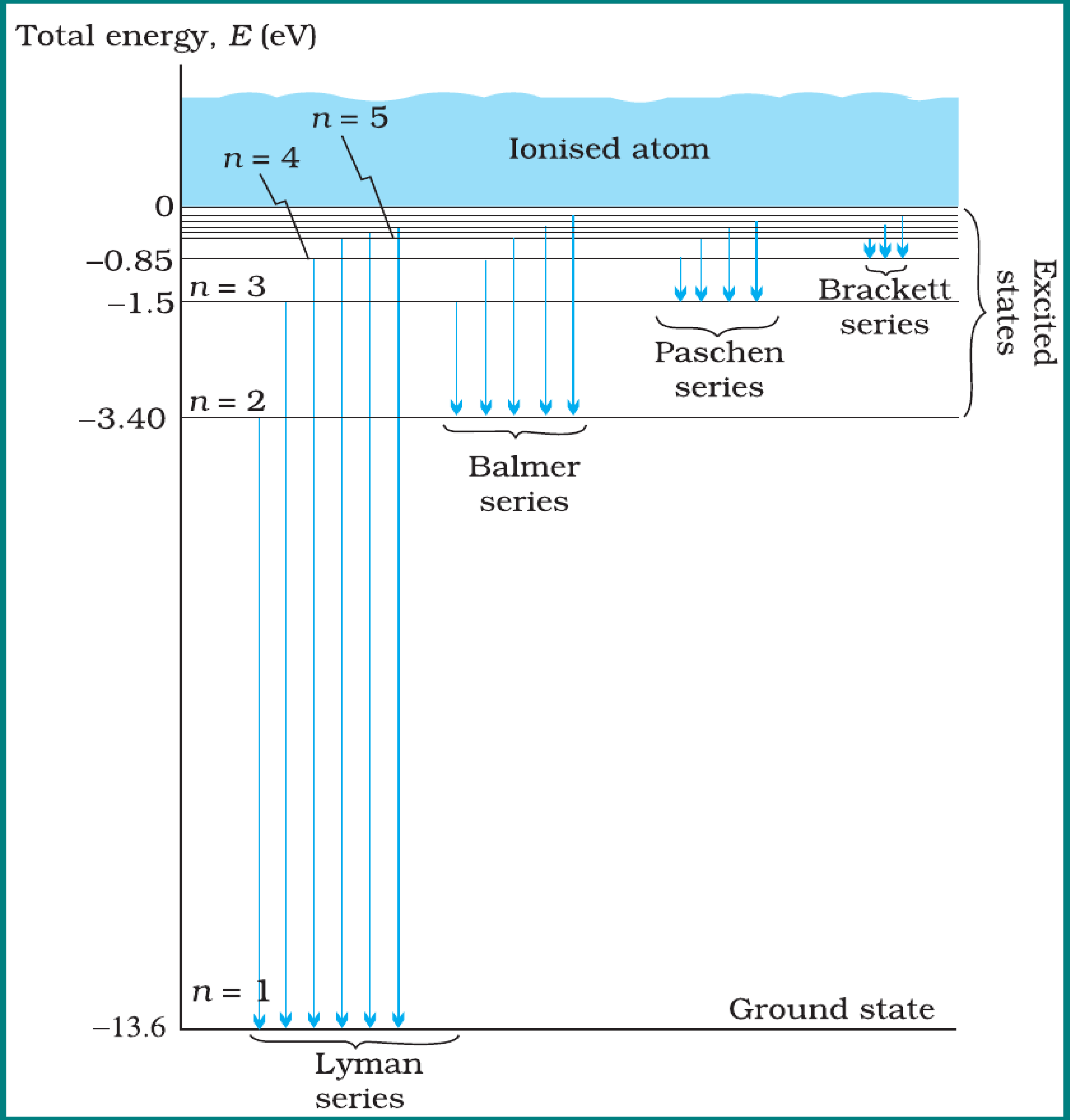
- **Brackett series:** $n_f = 4$ (infrared).

Hydrogen Spectral Series



Important Series

- **Lyman series:** $n_f = 1,\ n_i = 2, 3, 4, \ldots$ (ultraviolet region).
- **Balmer series:** $n_f = 2,\ n_i = 3, 4, 5, \ldots$ (visible region).
- **Paschen series:** $n_f = 3,\ n_i = 4, 5, 6, \ldots$ (infrared region).
- **Brackett series:** $n_f = 4$ (infrared).
- **Pfund series:** $n_f = 5$ (infrared).

Hydrogen Spectral Series

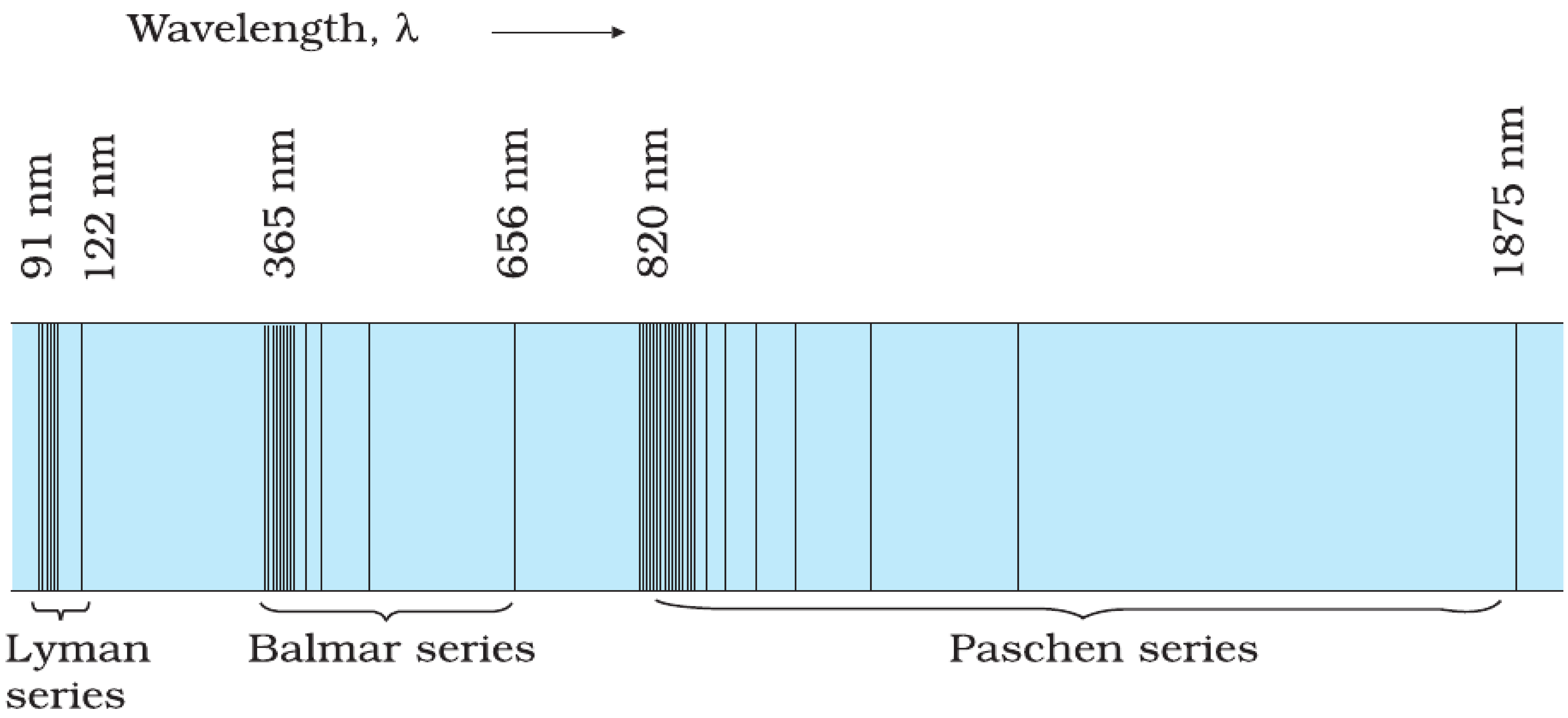
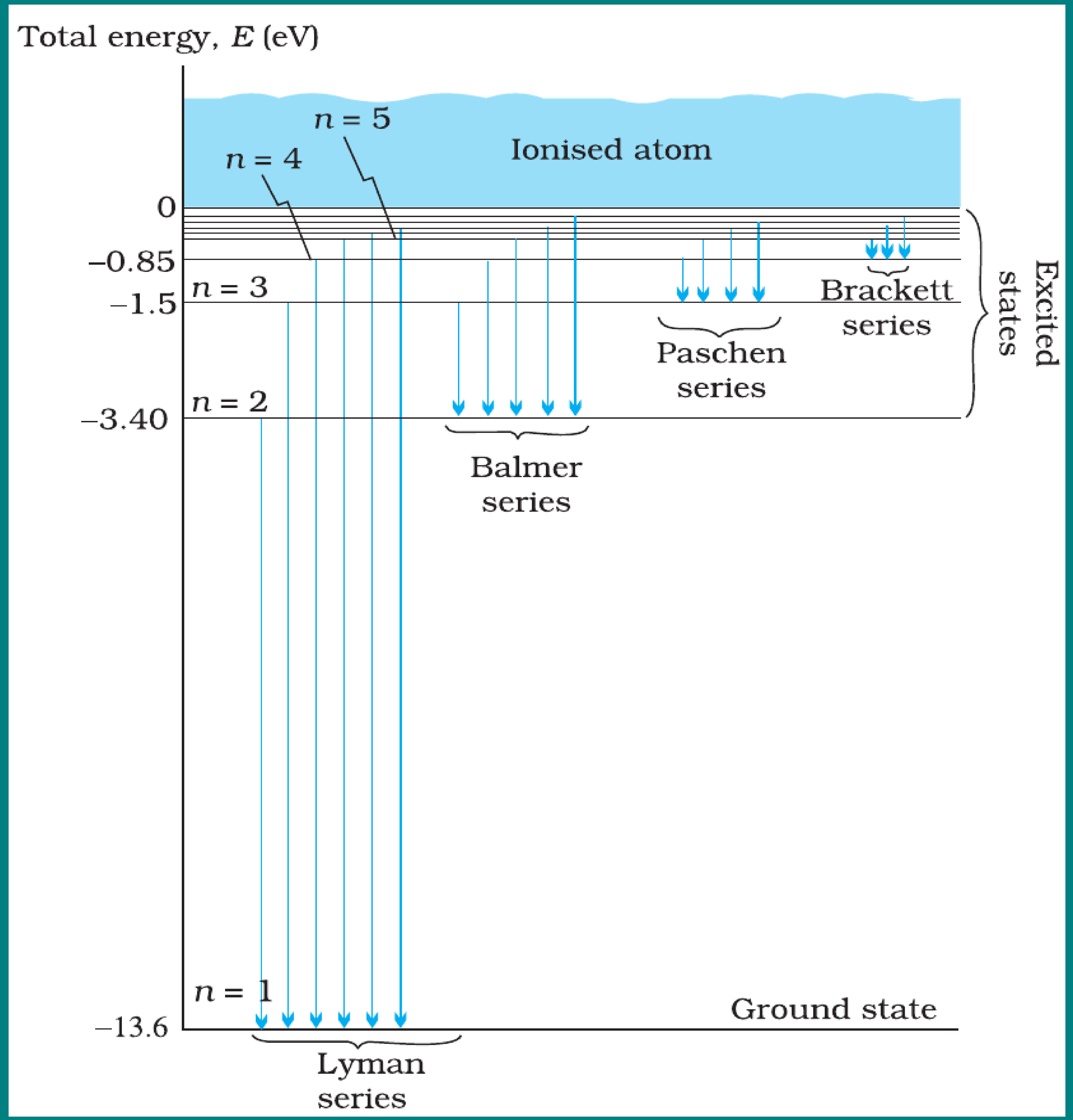


FIGURE 12.5 Emission lines in the spectrum of hydrogen.

Significance of Line Spectra



- Line spectra provided **direct experimental support** for Bohr's model.

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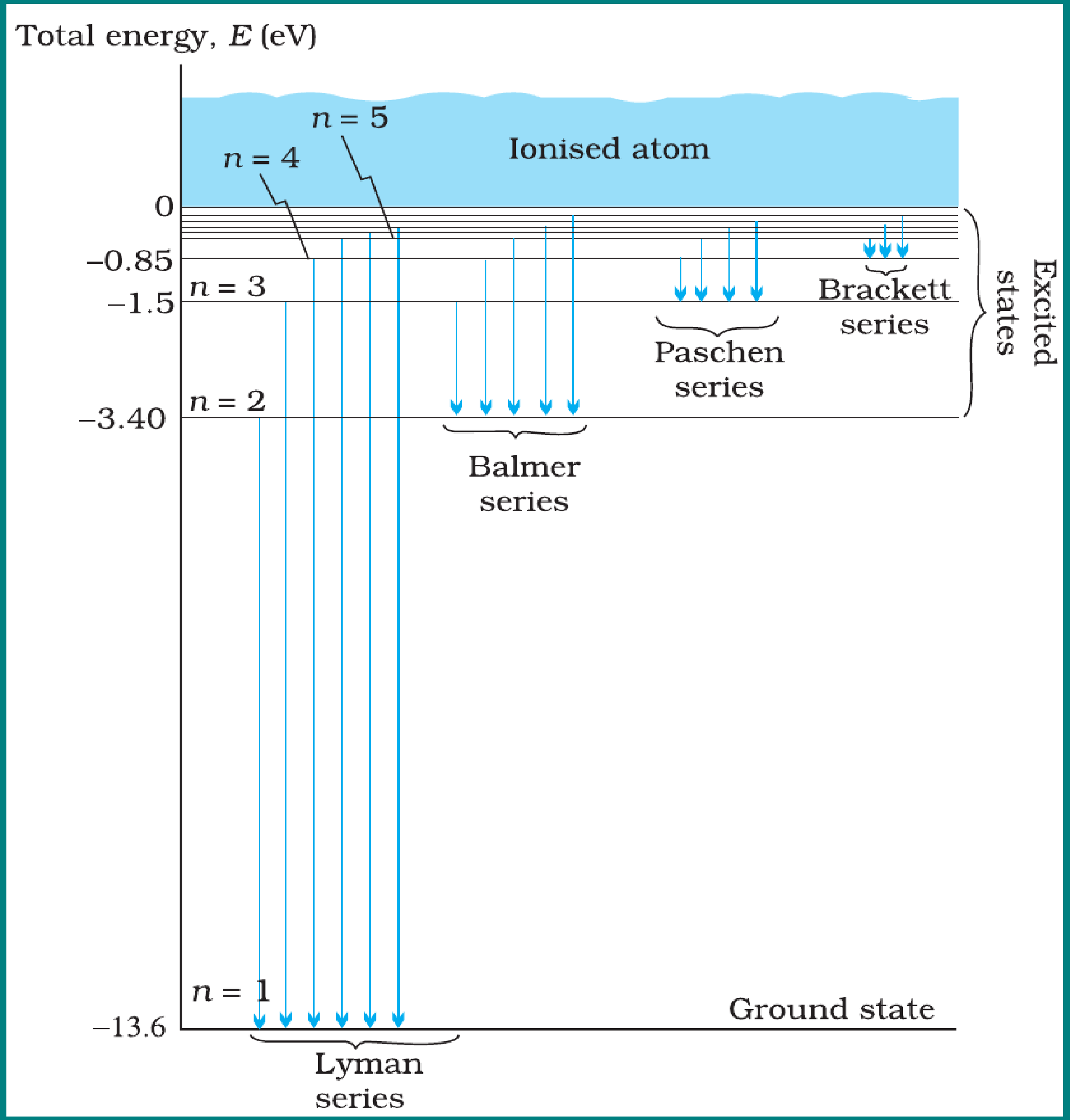

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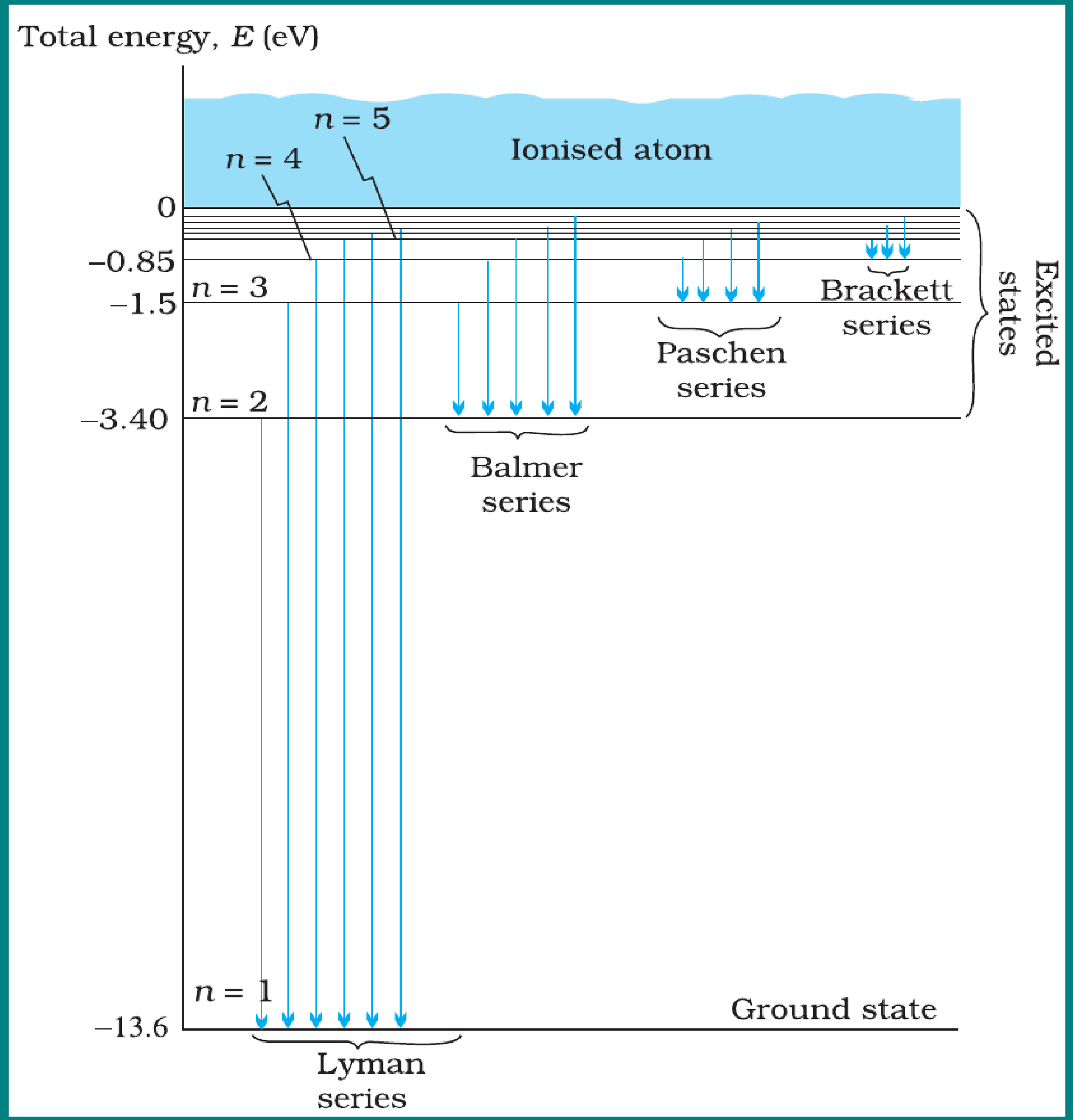

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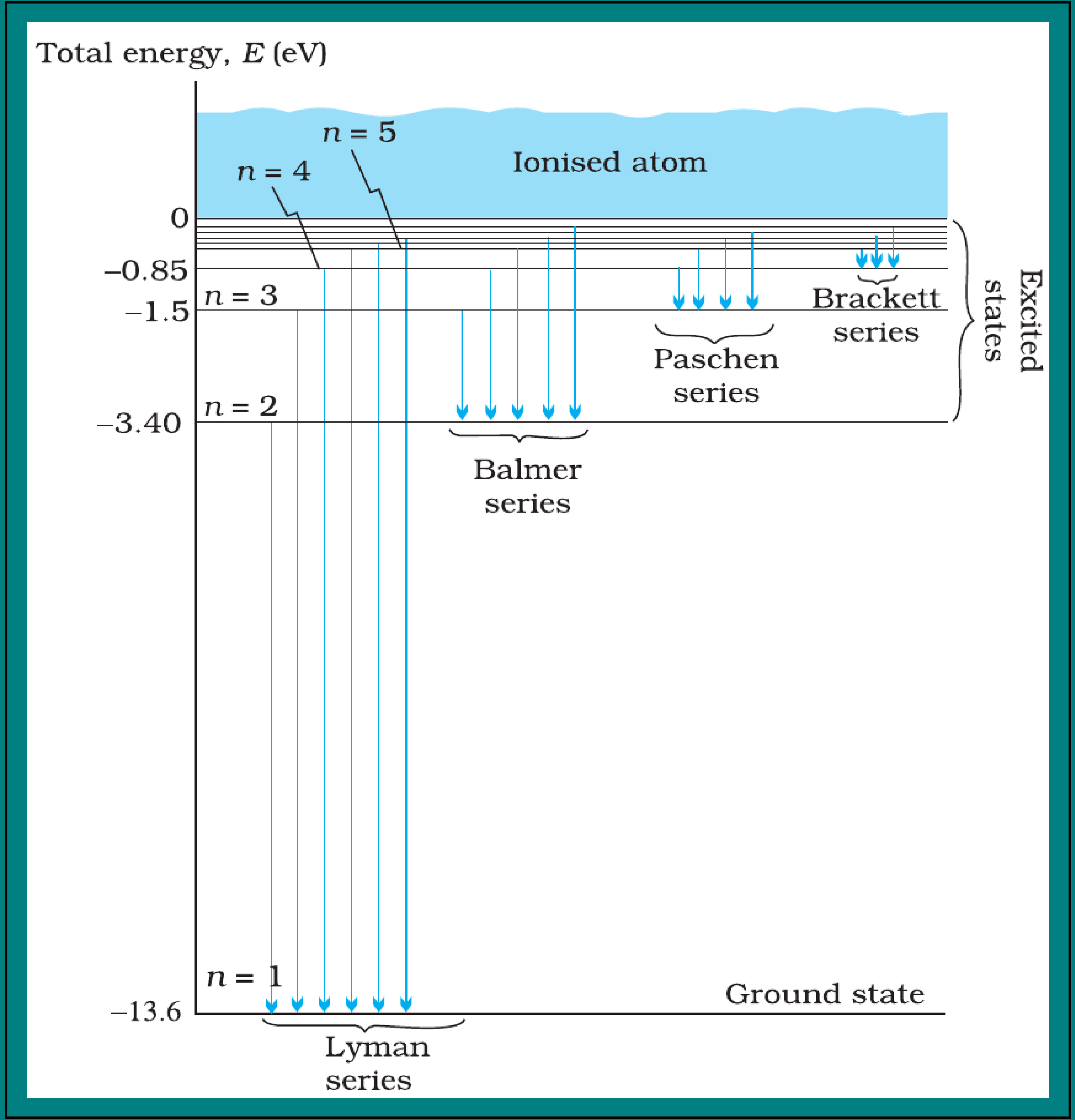

- Line spectra provided **direct experimental support** for Bohr's model.
- Each spectral line corresponds to a definite electronic transition.
- The agreement of observed spectral lines with calculated wavelengths was a major success of Bohr's theory.
- It also explained why atoms emit **discrete frequencies**, not a continuous spectrum.

De Broglie Explanation Bohr’s Second Postulate

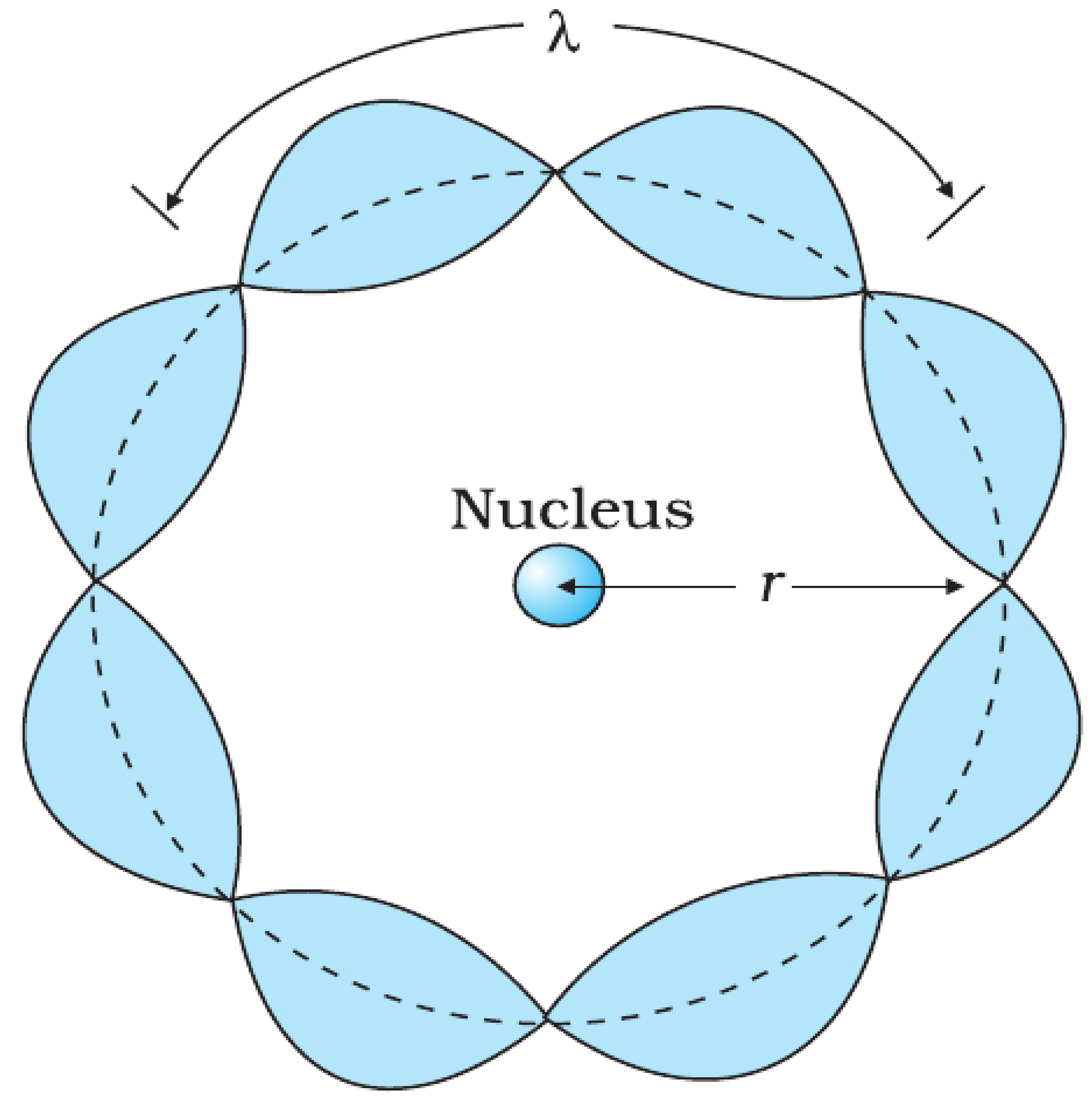

FIGURE 12.10 A standing wave is shown on a circular orbit where four de Broglie wavelengths fit into the circumference of the orbit.

- According to **de Broglie**, moving particles have an associated wavelength: $\lambda = \frac{h}{p} = \frac{h}{mv}$

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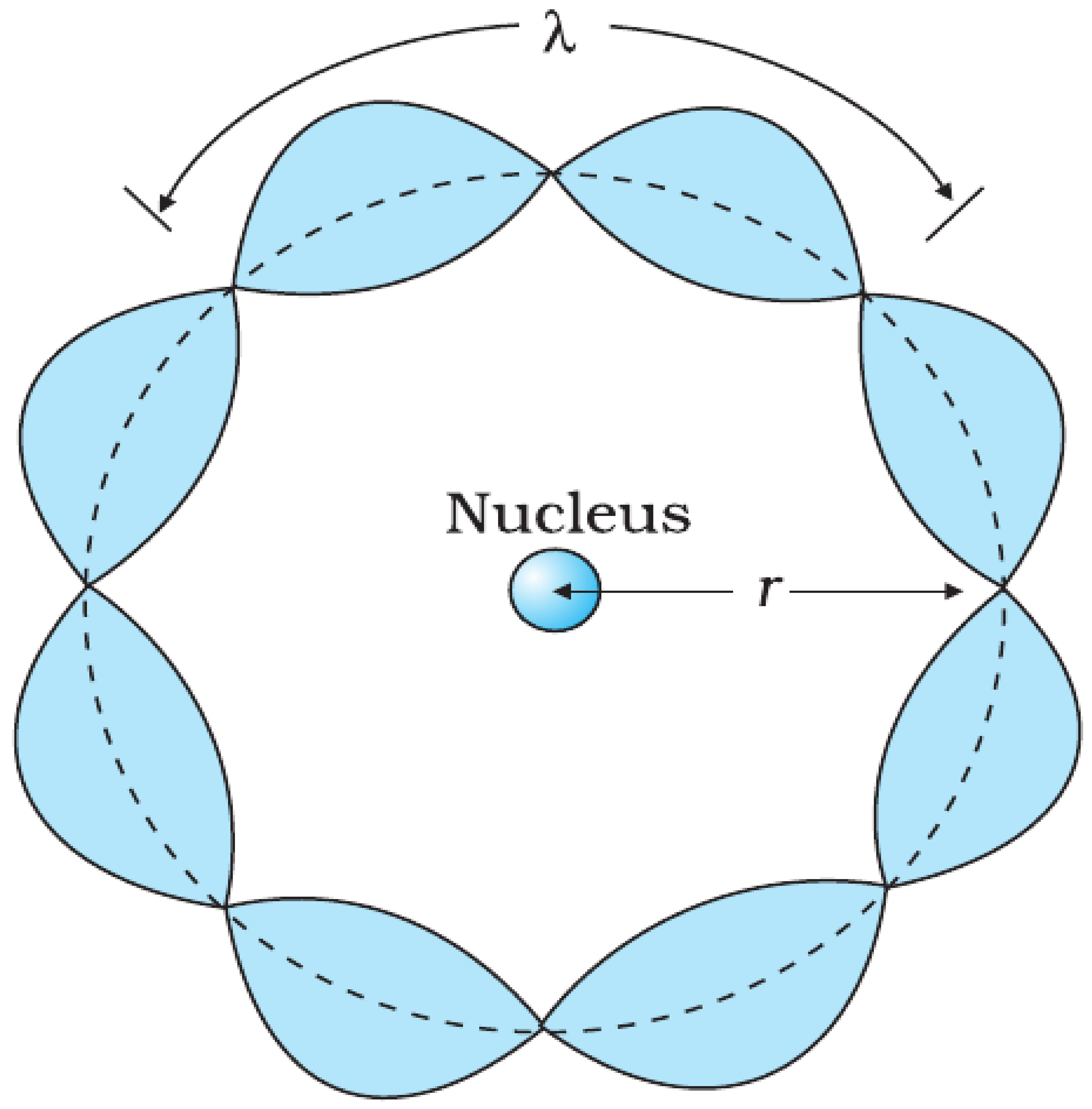

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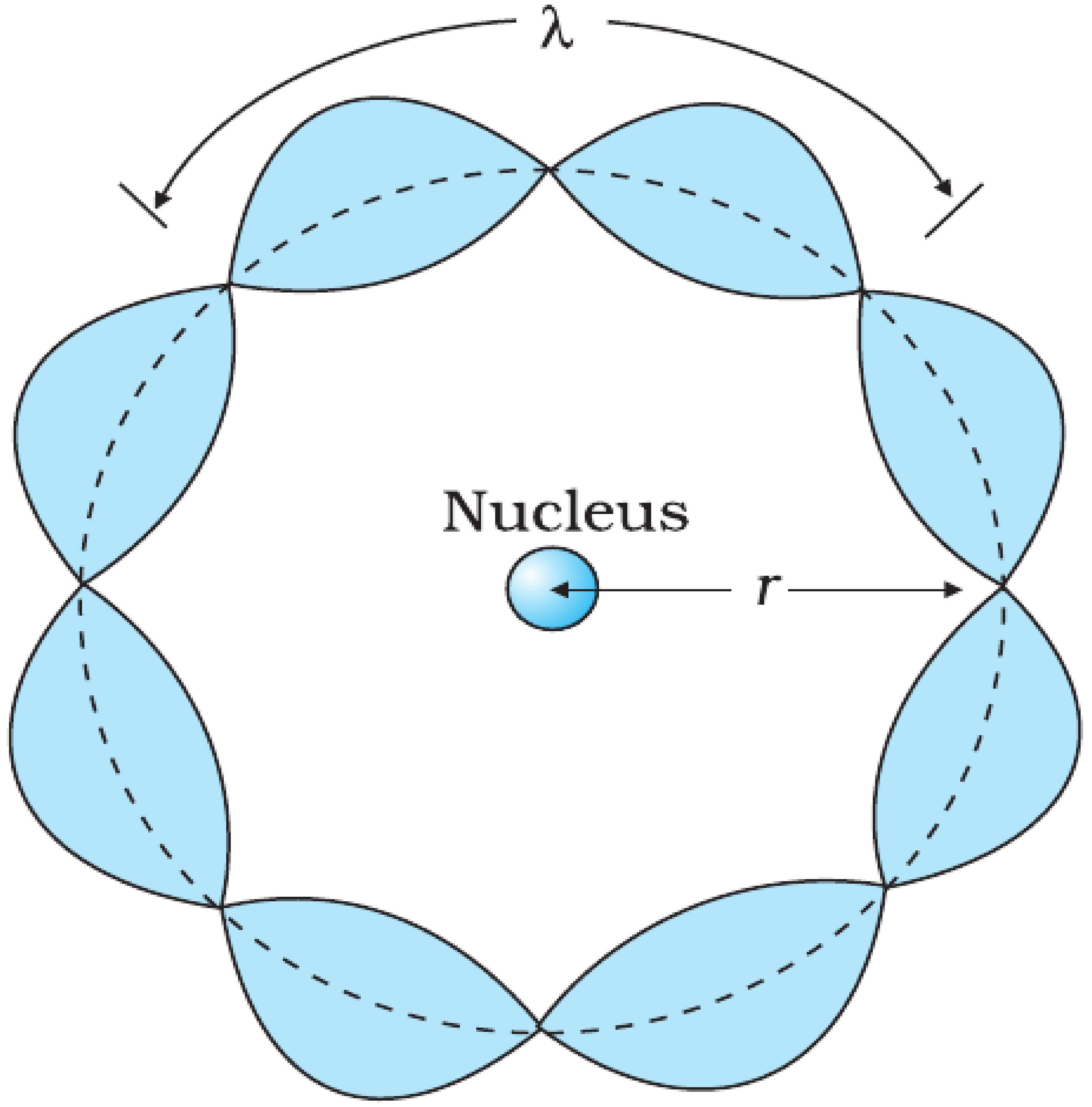

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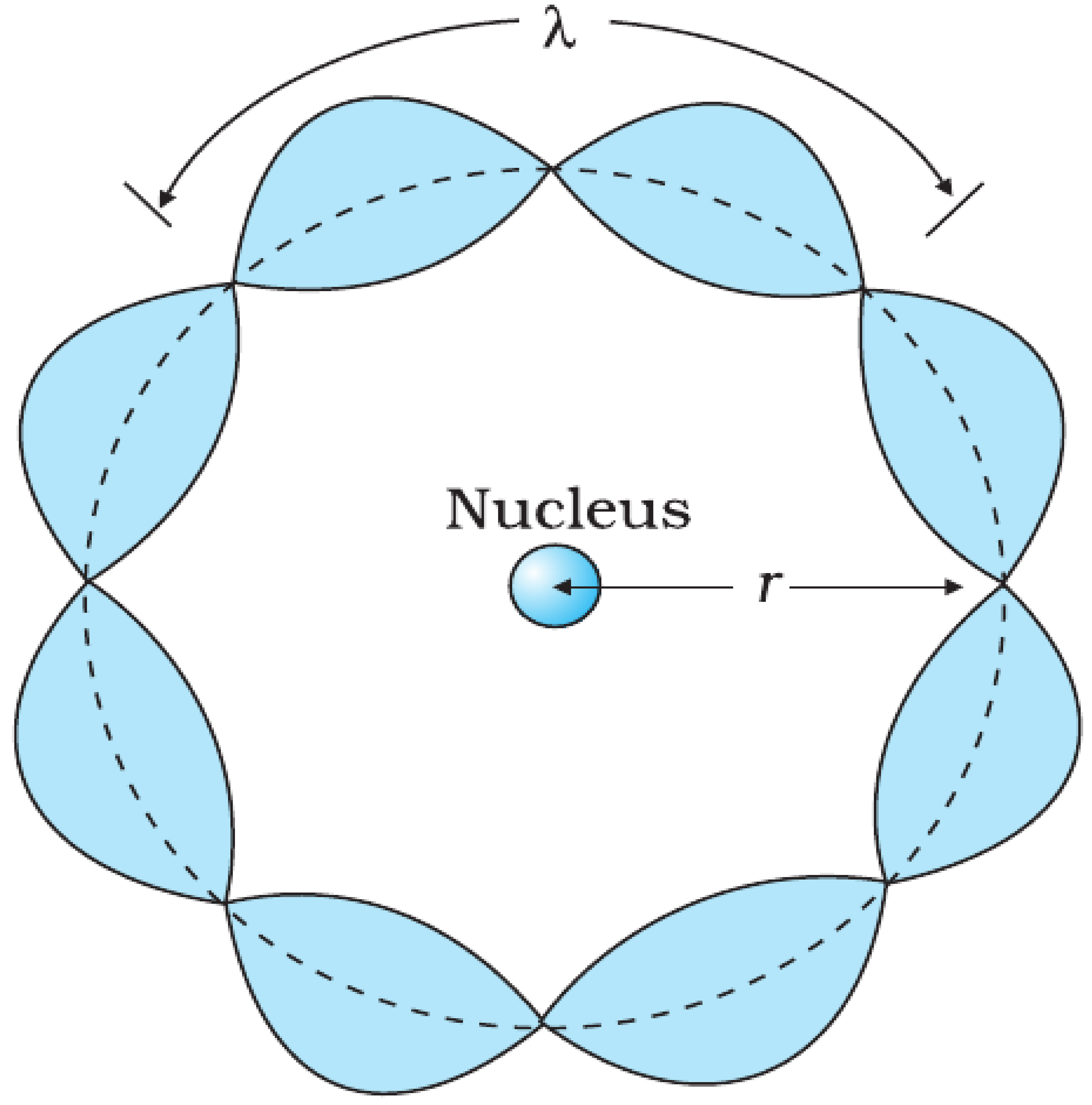
- For an electron in a circular orbit of radius r, this wave is associated with the electron's motion.
- Bohr's quantisation condition can be understood as a condition for forming a **standing wave**.

Condition for Standing Wave



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Derivation

- For a standing wave around the orbit, circumference must be an integer multiple of wavelength:

$$2\pi r = n\lambda, \quad n = 1, 2, 3, \ldots$$

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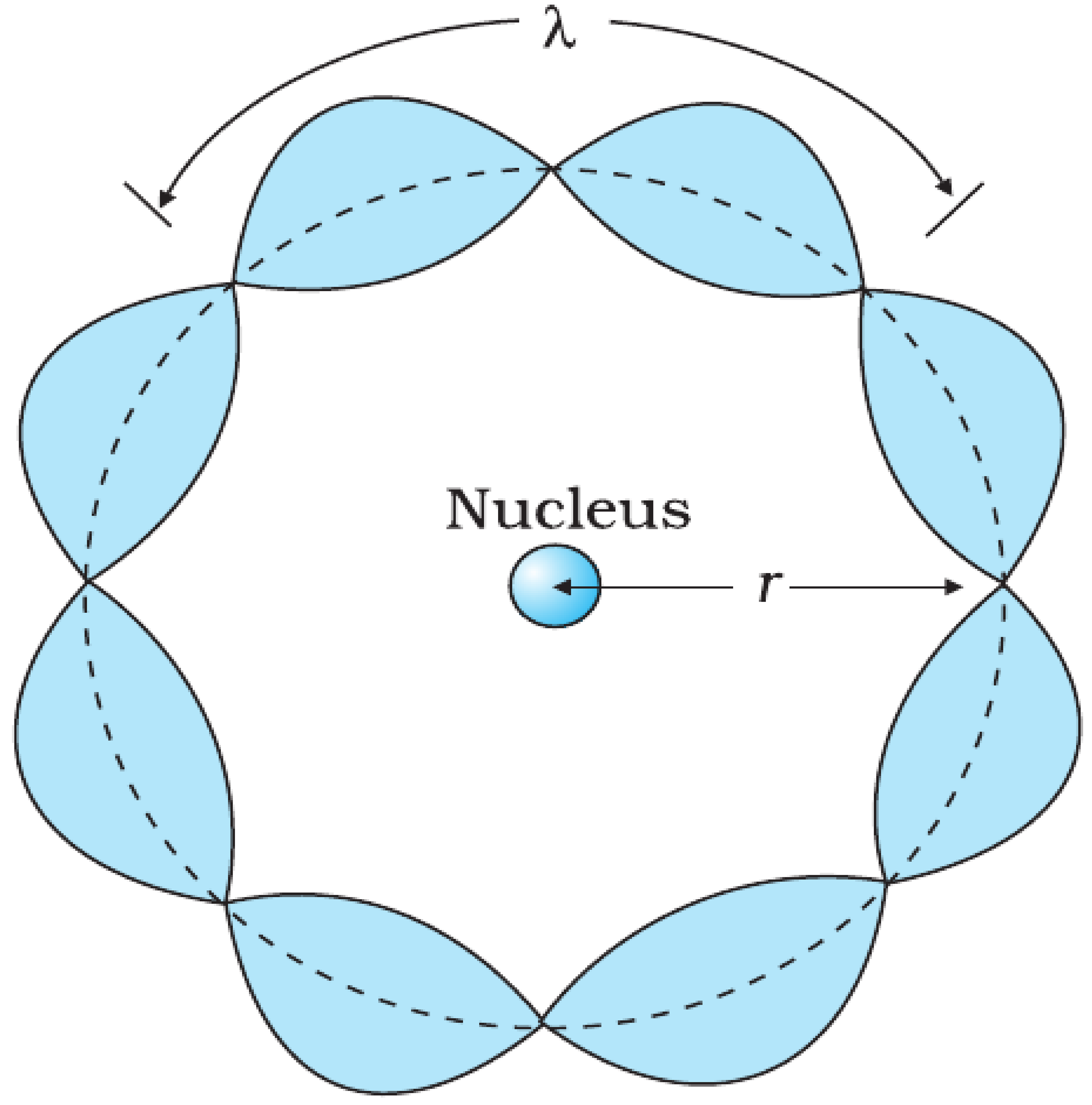

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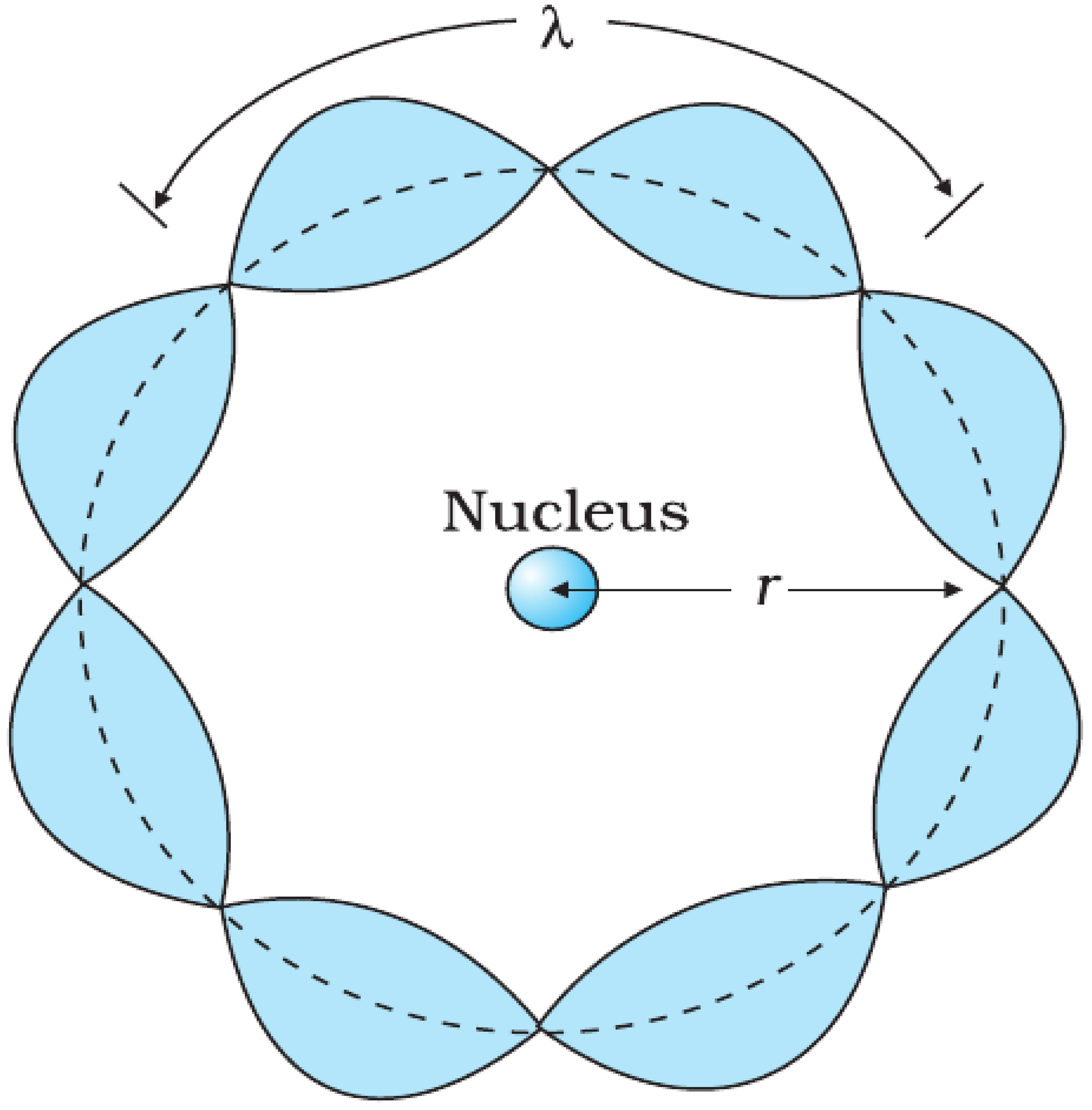

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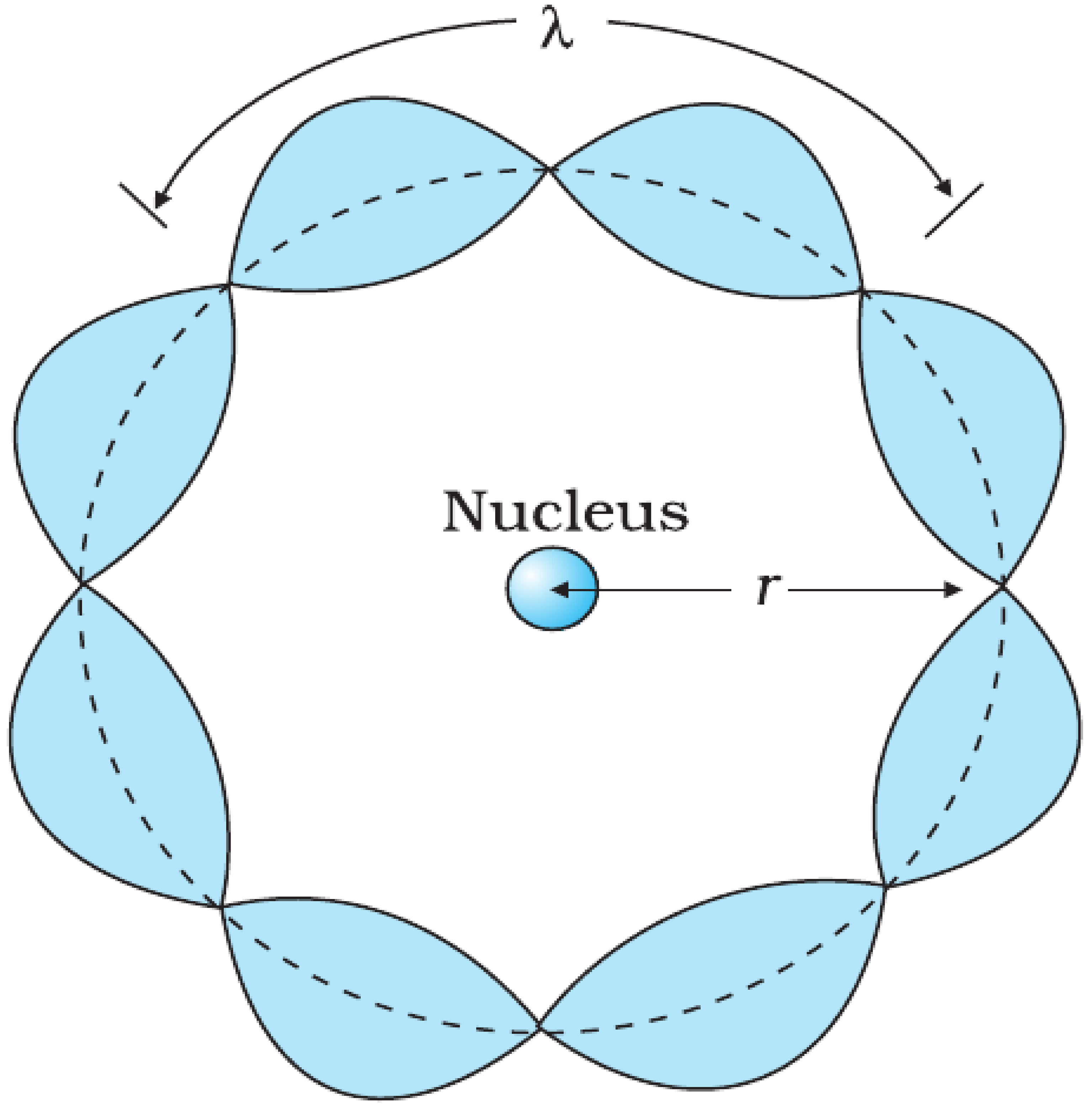
- Rearranging: $\boxed{mvr = \dfrac{nh}{2\pi}}$

Significance of de Broglie's Explanation



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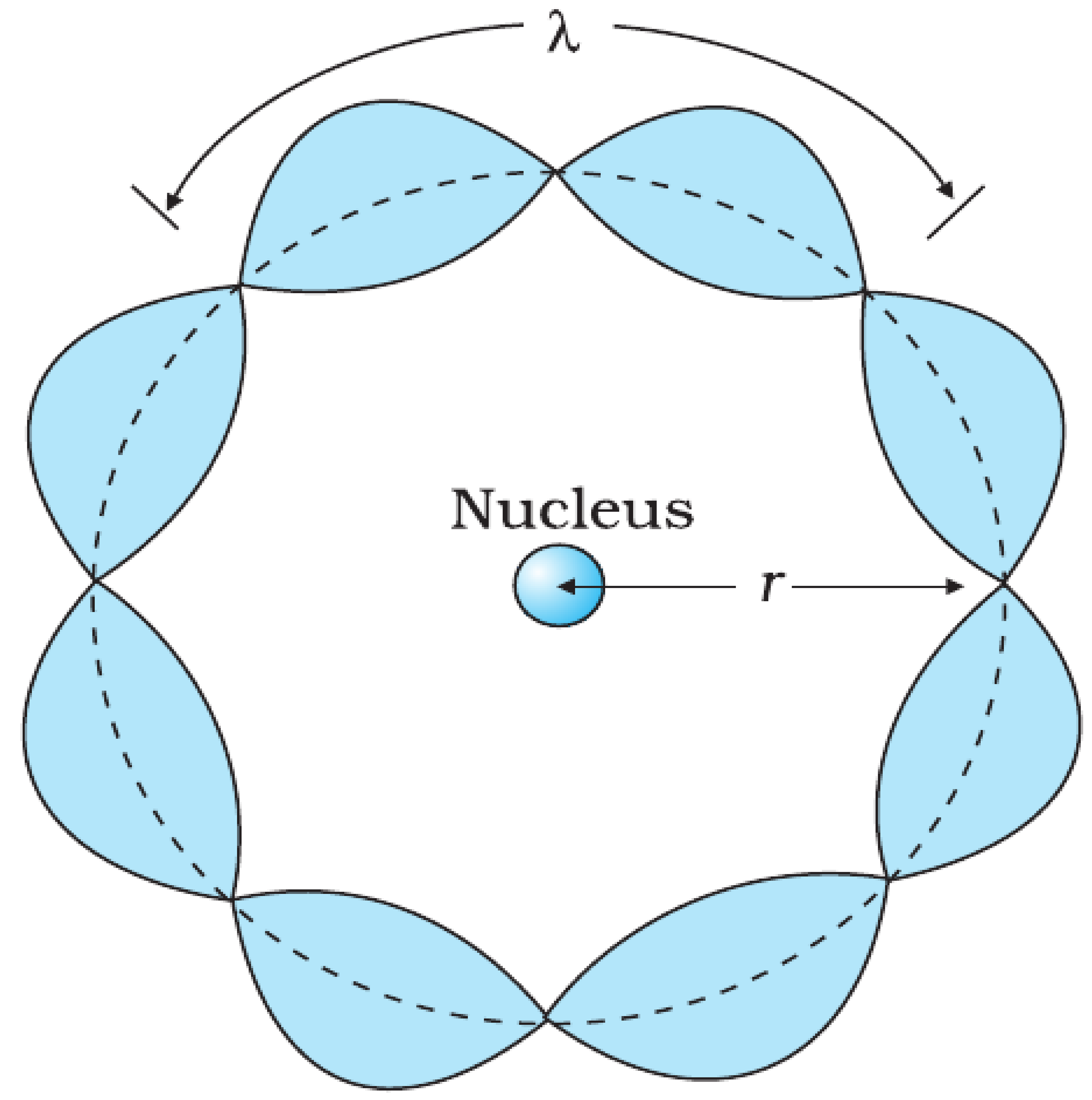

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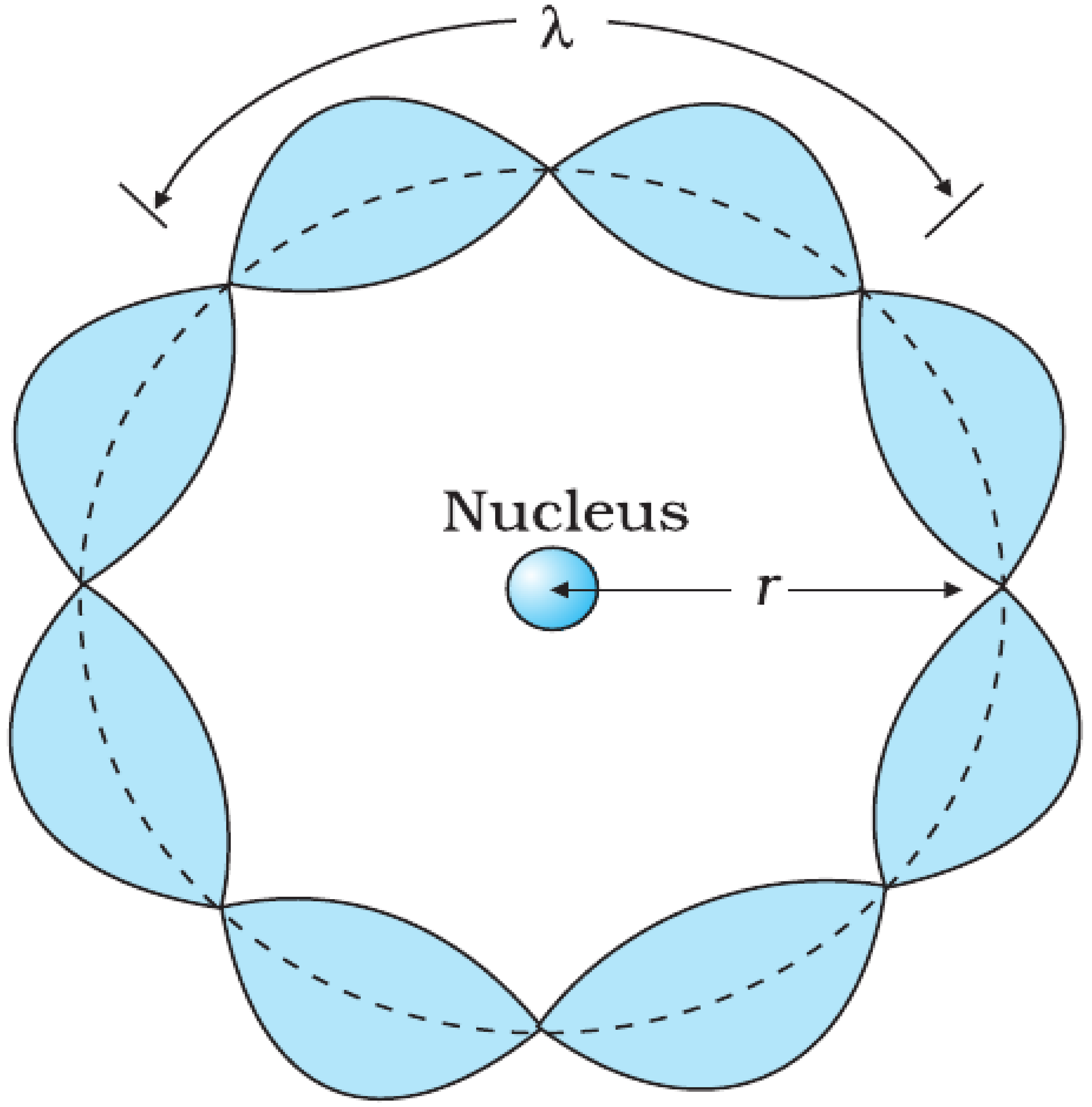

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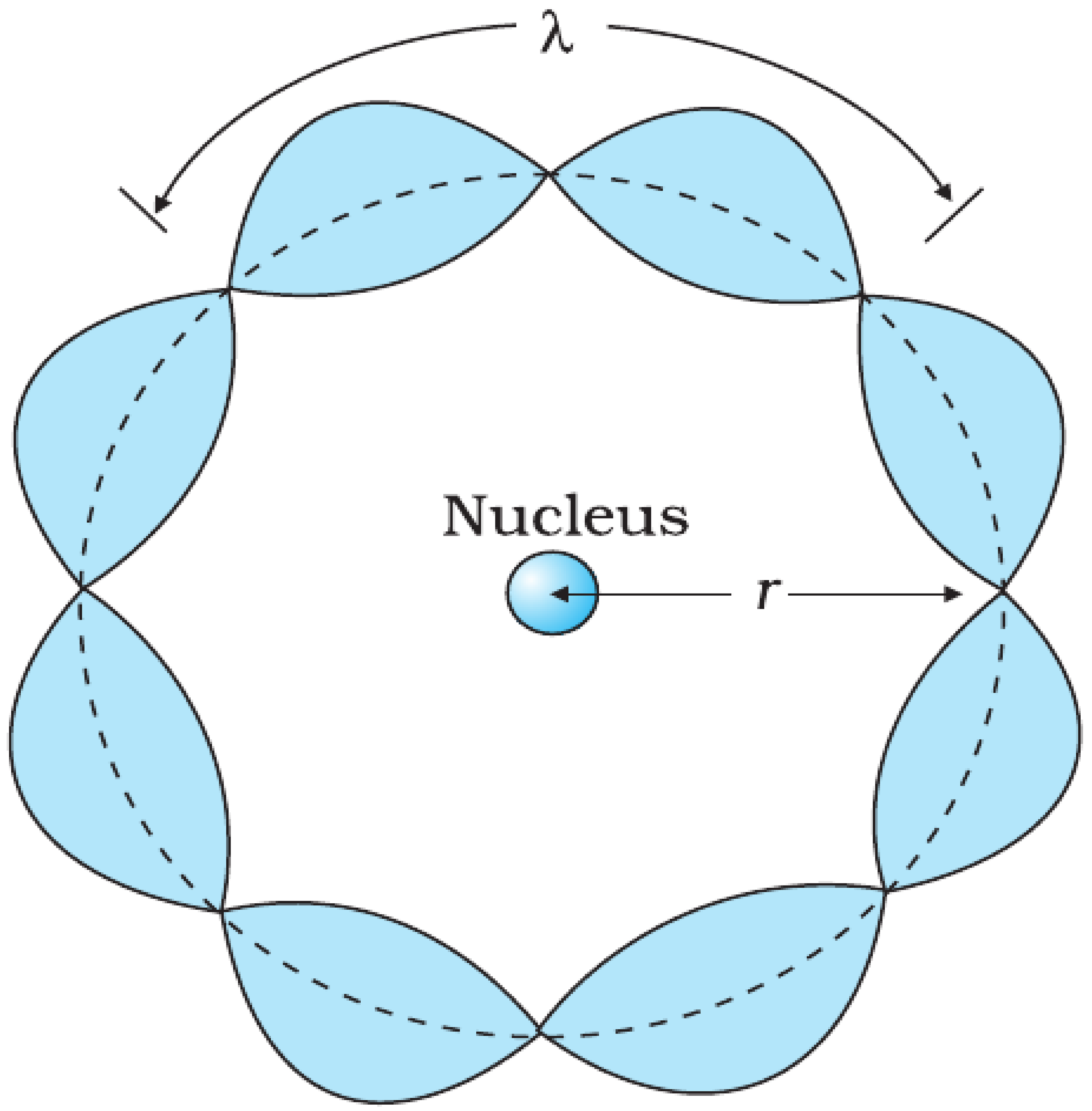

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- Bohr's quantisation rule is not arbitrary — it naturally follows from **wave nature of matter**.
- Only those orbits are stable where the electron wave makes a **standing wave pattern**.
- If not, destructive interference would occur and the orbit would not be stable.
- Thus, de Broglie's hypothesis provided a strong theoretical basis for Bohr's second postulate.

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